

ACID REFLUX COOKBOOK

Nurture Digestive Wellbeing and Long-Lasting Relief with 2000 Days' Worth of Fuss-free Delicious Recipes to Soothe GERD, LPR, & Heartburn | 30 Days Meal Plan Included

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Introduction

Have you ever experienced a burning sensation that rises from your stomach towards your throat after enjoying a hearty meal? If so, you might have encountered what is commonly known as acid reflux. This discomfort is more than just an occasional nuisance: for many, it's a recurring issue with significant impact on daily comfort and wellbeing. But there's good news—managing this condition doesn't have to be complicated. **"ACID REFLUX COOKBOOK"** is your guide to nurturing digestive health and securing long-lasting relief.

Our comprehensive collection serves as both educational resource and culinary inspiration, offering fuss-free delicious recipes specifically tailored to soothe symptoms of GERD (Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease), LPR (Laryngopharyngeal Reflux), and heartburn. This book caters to those who believe that mealtime should be a source of pleasure, not pain.

Understanding what triggers your acid reflux is the first step in taking control. Each individual's triggers can vary, but common irritants include spicy foods, certain fats, chocolate, caffeine, onion, garlic, and citrus fruits. A well-managed diet is key—eating the right foods while avoiding the wrong ones can dramatically improve your quality of life.

This cookbook introduces principles of an acid reflux-friendly diet, teaching you how to identify personal dietary triggers and make informed choices about the foods you consume. You'll learn about the importance of pH in foods and how balance can prevent flare-ups.

Our 2000 days' worth of recipes are meticulously planned to ensure they're gentle on the stomach without compromising on taste. We navigate you through starting your day right with gentle wake-up breakfasts like soothing oatmeal options and egg dishes designed for easy digestion. Light bites and snacks offer quick, appetizer-size remedies that are perfect for between meals, while lunches focus on salads, wraps, and soups that prevent discomfort before it begins.

Main courses provide an array of friendly dinner options—including lean poultry recipes and plant-based dishes—that won't leave you regretful post-meal. Our sides and accompaniments are flavorful yet safe choices designed to complement main dishes without provoking symptoms.

Yes, we even cover desserts! Enjoy fruit-based sweets and baked goods that cater to sensitive stomachs without igniting heartburn. And because hydration is crucial for digestion, our beverage section includes teas and infused waters that aid rather than exacerbate reflux.

We acknowledge that managing acid reflux extends beyond what's on your plate—it includes stress management techniques, proper physical activity choices, coping strategies for dining out and social situations—which we address to provide all-encompassing support.

Finally, we've included a practical 30-day meal plan to set you up efficiently on your journey towards digestive wellness. Embrace this expansive library of flavorful options with confidence; let food once again be one of life's simplest joys—without the discomfort that too often follows it.

Understanding Acid Reflux

Acid reflux is a common health issue that literally leaves a sour taste in your mouth. When we eat, food travels down a tube called the esophagus and into the stomach, where acids help break it down. Acid reflux occurs when these stomach acids make their way back up into the esophagus. It's like a traffic jam where cars (or in this case, stomach acids) end up going in the wrong direction, causing irritation and discomfort.

What this feels like? Imagine a burning sensation behind your breastbone that sometimes travels up your throat. Sounds unpleasant, right? This sensation is often known as heartburn. But besides heartburn, acid reflux can also prompt you to experience a sour or bitter taste in your mouth, trouble swallowing, a feeling like you've got a lump in your throat, and even an unwelcome case of the hiccups or a persistent dry cough.

These symptoms can be quite a nuisance, *but what exactly causes acid reflux?* Several factors might cause or contribute to acid reflux. These can range from lifestyle choices to physical conditions. Overeating, lying down immediately after eating, obesity, pregnancy, and consuming certain foods like citrus, tomato, chocolate, mint, garlic, onions, or spicy or fatty foods can trigger reflux.

Overview of Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD)

When acid reflux occurs more than twice a week or leads to inflammation in the esophagus, it is called **Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD)**. GERD is more serious than occasional acid reflux and requires medical attention to manage its symptoms and prevent complications such as esophageal damage.

Lifestyle modifications often form the first line of management for GERD patients. Changing eating habits by having smaller meals more frequently throughout the day instead of three large ones can significantly improve symptoms. Also recommended are elevating the head during sleep and avoiding eating close to bedtime.

In some cases where lifestyle changes do not sufficiently manage GERD symptoms, medications like antacids or H₂-receptor blockers might be prescribed by healthcare professionals.

COMMON TRIGGERS AND REMEDIES FOR ACID REFLUX	
COMMON TRIGGERS	POSSIBLE REMEDIES
<i>Overeating</i>	Eat smaller meals throughout the day
<i>Lying down post meals</i>	Wait at least 3 hours before lying down
<i>Certain foods & drinks</i>	Limit intake of trigger foods and beverages
<i>Smoking</i>	Quit smoking
<i>Stress</i>	Engage in stress reduction techniques
<i>Alcohol consumption</i>	Limit or avoid alcohol
<i>Caffeinated beverages</i>	Reduce intake of coffee and tea

Remember to take care of your digestive health by being attentive to how your body reacts after eating. If you suspect that you're frequently suffering from acid reflux or GERD symptoms, it's important to consult with a healthcare professional for proper diagnosis and treatment.

CHAPTER 1

The Importance of Diet Management

The Role of Food in Acid Reflux

Dealing with acid reflux is like walking a tightrope. It's all about balance: maintaining the right harmony between what you eat and how your body responds. Did you know that some foods can act as a green light for acid reflux to flare up? **It's true!** For example, fatty and fried foods tend to sit heavily in your stomach, which might tempt your body to bring back up some of that acidic content into your throat. Similarly, citrus fruits, spicy cuisines, chocolate, and even mint can relax the lower esophageal sphincter: that's the muscle that usually keeps what's in your stomach from going the wrong way up.

On top of which specific foods you eat, consider how much and when you consume them. Large meals can overwhelm your stomach and lead to that all-too-familiar heartburn sensation. Eating too close to bedtime pushes the odds against you as lying down soon after eating makes it easier for acid to sneak its way up.

Principles of an Acid Reflux-Friendly Diet

What makes a diet acid reflux-friendly? Imagine painting a picture where every stroke matters: that's how you should approach your plate.

The principle is simple: choose foods that soothe rather than soar. Put meals together that are high in Fiber: think whole grains, greens, and beans. These dietary heroes can help absorb stomach acids and provide a clear path through your digestive system.

Next up on your palette should be lean proteins: chicken breast sans skin and seafood are great starting points. These muscle-building blocks don't weigh heavily on your stomach or prompt excessive acid production like fattier cuts of meat might.

Another principle involves timing; waiting at least three hours before lying down after eating allows gravity to keep acid where it belongs: in your stomach.

Hydration also plays its part in an acid reflux diet. While gulping down water during meals can dilute stomach acids and lead to bloating, sipping it throughout the day assists digestion and keeps things moving forward gently.

Managing an acid reflux-friendly diet doesn't mean you have to eat blandly or forego flavor. It's about making smart swaps: using herbs instead of spices to add zest to dishes or roasting instead of frying for crunchy textures without triggering heartburn.

Diet management for acid reflux is about understanding the impact food has on your body's inner workings. It's creating a personalized eating plan that helps lessen symptoms without sacrificing enjoyment or nutrition. With attention to what you're putting on your plate: small adjustments and healthier choices: it's possible to manage acid reflux effectively.

Identifying Personal Triggers in Your Diet

Living with acid reflux means adjusting your diet to minimize symptoms and discomfort. Recognizing which foods and beverages trigger your reflux can make a significant difference to your daily comfort and overall health.

It's vital to understand that everyone's body reacts differently to foods. While some might experience a flare-up with onions or garlic, others might find citrus fruits are their main culprits. Your journey to identifying dietary triggers is personal and requires patience and attentiveness.

Keep a food diary. Write down everything you eat and drink, along with the timing. Note any symptoms you experience after each meal or snack—don't forget the minor ones. This can be tedious but stick with it for at least one to two weeks for clarity. To make it simple, look at the example below:

Time	Food/Beverage	Symptoms
8 AM	Oatmeal with bananas	None
11 AM	Coffee with cream	Heartburn within 30 mins
1 PM	Turkey sandwich	Mild bloating
3 PM	Orange juice	Severe heartburn

After recording data for a while, patterns will emerge. Maybe it's that mid-morning coffee or the glass of orange juice that seems to set off your symptoms consistently.

Once you've spotted possible trigger foods in your diary, it's time for the elimination phase. Eliminate one suspected trigger from your diet completely and see if there's an improvement in

your symptoms. Give this process about two weeks for each item because sometimes it takes a while for your body to adjust and show change.

If you notice improvement, you've identified a trigger! If not, put that food back into rotation and move on to the next suspect on your list. Remember, moderation is key, too—maybe small amounts of coffee are alright for you but having a big cup sends your digestive system into protest.

Now let's talk about common trigger foods for those with acid reflux:

- Citrus fruits
- Tomato-based products
- Spicy foods
- High-fat foods
- Chocolate
- Caffeinated beverages
- Carbonated drinks
- Garlic and onions

These are just starting points because there could be unexpected triggers like a certain brand of granola bar or even stress-related eating habits that contribute to flare-ups. Remember that lifestyle changes accompany dietary adjustments; eating smaller meals more frequently can help as can avoiding eating late at night or lying down immediately after meals. Identifying triggers is about learning what works for you personally—no two people with acid reflux will have the same dietary triggers or tolerances.

CHAPTER 2

Building Your Acid Reflux Diet

Foods to Include and Avoid

Living with acid reflux doesn't mean you have to say goodbye to flavor or the joy of eating. It's all about understanding what soothes your stomach and what stirs up those uncomfortable symptoms. Let's walk through some friendly foods to keep on your plate and others to pass up.

Foods to Include

1. **Vegetables:** Non-acidic vegetables are your new best friends. These include leafy greens like kale and spinach, as well as broccoli, cauliflower, cucumbers, and potatoes. Not only do they lack the acidity that can trigger reflux, but they're also packed full of nutrients.
2. **Oatmeal:** A hearty bowl of oatmeal is a great way to start your day if you have acid reflux. It's filling and doesn't cause any discomfort. Top it with sliced bananas for an extra digestive boost.
3. **Ginger:** This natural anti-inflammatory can be a cure for many ailments including acid reflux. Add ginger to your meals or sip on ginger tea to soothe your stomach.
4. **Lean proteins:** Incorporating lean proteins such as chicken breast, turkey, and fish into your diet can help maintain muscle without aggravating acid reflux symptoms.
5. **Complex carbohydrates:** Whole grains like brown rice, whole-wheat bread, and quinoa provide fiber that assists in digestion and prevents the buildup of acid in the stomach.
6. **Aloe Vera:** This isn't just for sunburns—it can also help soothe the GI tract.
7. **Bananas and Melons:** Most fruits can be risky with acid reflux because of their acidity, but bananas and melons offer a safer bet.
8. **Whole Grains:** Quinoa, rice, and couscous are excellent choices they are absorbent and low in fat.
9. **Healthy fats:** Avocados, walnuts, flaxseed, olive oil—these are all good fats that may help reduce acid production.

Foods to Avoid

1. **Citrus fruits:** Oranges, lemons, limes, and grapefruits are full of acid which can exacerbate your symptoms and should be limited in your diet.
2. **Spicy foods:** While they may tantalize your taste buds, spicy dishes can trigger heartburn for many people with GERD.

3. **Fatty foods:** Fried foods or meals heavy in butter or oil take longer to digest, increasing the chance that stomach acids will make their way back up the esophagus.
4. **Chocolate:** Much to the dismay of chocolate lovers with GERD, chocolate contains an ingredient called methylxanthine that has been shown to relax the smooth muscles of the esophagus and increase reflux.
5. **Coffee and alcohol:** These beverages can relax the esophageal sphincter allowing stomach acids to bubble up into the throat.
6. **Tomatoes:** Sadly, tomatoes are a no-go for many people with acid reflux because they're highly acidic.
7. **Onions/Garlic:** These flavorful ingredients can trigger heartburn in many individuals.
8. **Mint:** It might be surprising since mint is known for soothing tummies but it can actually cause an opposite effect for those with acid reflux.
9. **High-Fat Dairy Products:** Cheese, sour cream, ice cream—these things can all lead to troubles for those with sensitive stomachs.
10. **Carbonated Drinks:** The bubbles expand in your stomach, increasing pressure that could force stomach acid upwards into the esophagus.

Remember that personal triggers may vary. It's important to track what you eat and how it makes you feel so you can identify specific foods that may be problematic for you.

The Concept of pH in Foods and Its Impact on Acid Reflux

Did you know that the food we eat has a secret code that can either be a friend or foe to our stomach? This code is known as pH, which stands for the 'power of hydrogen.' It is a scale used to determine how acidic or alkaline a substance is. Everything we use to fuel our bodies has a place on this scale, and understanding it can make a world of difference for those who suffer from acid reflux.

The pH scale ranges from 0 to 14, with 7 being neutral. Anything below 7 is acidic, and above this point, substances are alkaline (or basic). *Now here's the curious part:* Our stomach naturally contains gastric acid, which is quite strong and leans towards the lower end of the pH scale (around 1.5 to 3.5) because it needs to break down food. But when we have acid reflux, this stomach acid travels back up into the esophagus, causing discomfort and potential damage due to its acidity.

Foods with different pH levels can impact this condition by either aggravating or soothing it. Generally speaking, acidic foods might trigger acid reflux in some individuals. These include citrus fruits like lemons and oranges, tomatoes, vinegar, and even some dairy products. On the other hand, alkaline foods might help balance out an overly acidic environment in your stomach — think bananas, melons, cauliflower, nuts, and oatmeal.

However, the body is complex and everyone reacts differently some people may not be affected much by acidic foods! Still important though is creating a diet that targets a good balance between these two extremes on the pH spectrum. This doesn't mean you should eat only alkaline foods; your body needs variety for different nutrients.

Now let's chat about **fermentation**. It's the process where microbes have their feast on the sugars in food and produce other compounds. This can either increase or decrease the food's acidity. For example, fermented milk products like yogurt can often be more tolerable for those with acid reflux compared to regular milk because the fermentation process reduces lactose (which some folks find troublesome) and can actually soothe your gut.

And what about **combining foods**? A mix-and-match approach might sometimes work in your favor. Pairing higher pH foods (base) with lower ones might help counteract some of the acidic punches before they start ramping up turmoil in your stomach.

Let's not forget **drinking water** is like sending in peacekeepers—it doesn't sway too far on either side of the pH scale and helps dilute excess stomach acids. *Keep this tip as your secret weapon:* moderation is key! Even if you adore tomatoes and they're sitting pretty at an unsettling pH of around 4, adding them into meals sparingly might guard against insurgence by upset acids looking to spoil your day.

Fancy chefs' advice? Use cooking techniques such as grilling or roasting veggies to bring out their natural sweetness – a delicious strategy to balance out meals without leaning too heavily on acidic ingredients.

Let's simplify it even more. If you imagine a seesaw with acidic foods on one side and alkaline foods on the other, your aim is to keep this seesaw as balanced as possible. Overloading on one side could tip your stomach into an unhappy state that sends acid traveling in the wrong direction – hello acid reflux!

FOOD	pH VALUE	IMPACT ON ACID REFLUX
<i>Lemon</i>	2	Potential Trigger
<i>Tomato</i>	4	Potential Trigger
<i>Banana</i>	5	Generally Safe
<i>Broccoli</i>	6	Generally Safe
<i>Cauliflower</i>	7	Generally Safe
<i>Water</i>	7	Neutral
<i>Eggs</i>	8	Generally Safe
<i>Spinach</i>	9	Usually Beneficial
<i>Baking Soda</i>	9	Usually Beneficial

When creating your own meals remember that although these guides are helpful for managing symptoms of acid reflux through diet change don't forget about flavor! Incorporating herbs like ginger which not only adds zest but can sooth digestive woes too.

But here's another twist: Not just acidity from food can cause trouble! Portion size plays a big role too – large meals tend to stay in your stomach longer creating pressure that might nudge that pesky acid up into your esophagus.

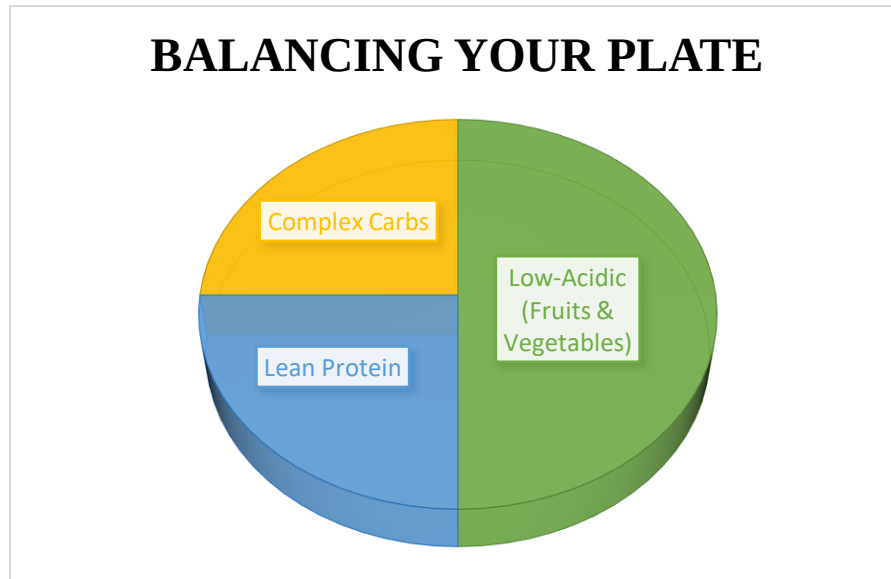
And did we think about stress? Stressful situations apparently increase stomach acid production; it's like they're telling your belly to brace itself hard for combat — and again making an opportunity for acid reflux flare ups.

Planning Balanced Meals and Proper Eating Patterns

Making the transition to an acid reflux-friendly diet requires not just knowing what foods to avoid, but also understanding how to structure your eating routine and plan balanced meals. The key is finding a harmonious blend of nutrients that satisfy the body's needs without aggravating your condition. Let's explore how you can achieve this balance and create a daily eating schedule that fosters digestive health.

Recognize that everyone's body reacts differently to certain foods. The recommendations provided here are general guidelines, and it would be best for you to listen to your body's signals and adjust accordingly.

Imagine dividing your plate into sections: half of it should consist of low-acidic fruits and vegetables; one quarter should include lean proteins like poultry, fish, or legumes; and the final quarter should be allocated to complex carbohydrates such as whole grains or starchy vegetables. Here's a simple illustration:



Make sure that you're not overwhelming your stomach with large portions. Smaller, more frequent meals can help prevent the overproduction of stomach acid.

When you eat is just as important as what you eat. To keep acid reflux at bay, plan your meals so that you're not eating right before physical activity or bedtime. This schedule keeps your digestion on track by allowing time for food to settle before going to bed or engaging in vigorous activities.

1. **Start With Breakfast:** A high-fiber breakfast helps control stomach acid. Think oatmeal with almond milk and berries or a spinach omelet with a slice of whole-grain toast.
2. **Hydrate Wisely:** Drink plenty of water throughout the day, but avoid drinking large amounts during meals, as this can dilute stomach acid and impede digestion.
3. **Mindful Snacking:** Choose snacks that are easy on your stomach, such as a small handful of almonds or rice cakes with avocado.
4. **Lunch Options:** For lunch, consider having grilled chicken salad with mixed greens or quinoa with steamed vegetables. Stay away from creamy dressings—opt for olive oil and lemon juice instead.

5. **Dinner Decisions:** Dinner should be light yet fulfilling — think broiled salmon with sautéed kale and sweet potato or turkey meatballs with zucchini noodles.
6. **Space It Out:** Allow at least three hours between dinner and bedtime.

By following these practical meal-planning tips, you'll reduce the risk of triggering acid reflux symptoms while enjoying a variety of delicious foods that promote your overall health.

CHAPTER 3

Customizing Recipes for Your Needs

Substituting Ingredients Wisely

Do you ever flip through a cookbook and think, *“That looks delicious, but what if I don't have an ingredient?”* or *“Can I make this dish work for my specific dietary needs?”* You're not alone! In the ‘Acid Reflux Diet Cookbook,’ we understand that everyone's digestive system and preferences are unique.

Customizing a recipe can be just as fun as cooking it. However, when dealing with acid reflux, it's important to ensure your swaps won't trigger symptoms. Here are some smart swaps you can rely on:

1. Replace tomatoes in any recipe with roasted red bell peppers to keep that bright flavor without the acidity.
2. Trade spicy chili peppers for sweet paprika – you will maintain the vibrant color and a touch of sweetness without the burn.
3. Use an equal amount of herbal blends like Mrs. Dash in place of garlic or onions to achieve great taste minus the potential discomfort.
4. Swap full-fat dairy products with their low-fat or plant-based alternatives, such as almond or oat milk instead of whole milk.

Remember, when substituting ingredients, consider their role in the recipe – are they providing moisture (like oil), binding elements (like eggs), or are they mainly for flavor (like spices)? Make sure your alternatives serve a similar purpose.

Portion Control Practices

Managing portions is crucial, particularly if you have acid reflux. Eating large meals can increase pressure on your stomach, which may lead to heartburn. Let's learn portion control:

1. **Use smaller plates:** Trick your brain into feeling full with a smaller amount of food simply by downsizing your dishware.
2. **Chew slowly:** Take time to chew each bite thoroughly; it aids digestion and allows you to gauge fullness better.
3. **Know serving sizes:** Familiarize yourself with standard serving sizes and use measuring cups where helpful.

Here's a simple guide to help you gauge portions without the need for scales or measurements:

FOOD GROUP	VISUAL CUE	APPROX SIZE & WEIGHT
<i>Vegetables</i>	Fist of your hand	1 cup
<i>Proteins</i>	Palm of your hand	3 oz.
<i>Grains</i>	Cupped hand	½ cup
<i>Fats</i>	Thumb tip	1 tbsp

NOTE: These are just guidelines; depending on individual needs and appetites, portions can be adjusted. Knowing when and how to substitute ingredients and control portion sizes can profoundly affect how you feel after enjoying a meal.

Meal Timing and Frequency Adjustments

Living with acid reflux doesn't only mean tweaking what you eat but also when and how often you eat. Smaller, frequent meals rather than three large ones can significantly minimize pressure on your esophageal sphincter, reducing the risk of acid splash-back. Consider the following tactics:

1. Aim for four to six small meals spread through the day rather than "square meals."
2. Plan your last meal at least 3 hours before bedtime to allow food to digest properly.
3. Chew food slowly and thoroughly because this not only aids digestion but also limits the amount of air swallowed, which contributes to reflux.

MEAL TIMING STRATEGY	
MEAL	IDEAL TIME
<i>Breakfast</i>	7:00-8:00 AM
<i>Mid-Morning Snack</i>	10:00-11:00 AM
<i>Lunch</i>	12:30-1:30 PM
<i>Afternoon Snack</i>	3:30-4:30 PM
<i>Dinner</i>	6:00-7:00 PM

Remember, consistency in meal timing is just as important as what you eat. By tailoring your meals carefully with these tips, you should see noticeable improvements in managing acid reflux symptoms while enjoying a variety of flavors present in our cookbook's recipes.

CHAPTER 4

Gentle Wake-Up Breakfast Recipes

Oatmeal Options for a Calming Start

1. Banana Almond Oatmeal

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 2 cups almond milk, unsweetened
- 1 ripe banana, mashed
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 tbsp almond butter
- 1 tbsp honey (optional)
- A pinch of salt

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, bring the almond milk to a low boil. Stir in the oats and a pinch of salt, then reduce heat to a simmer.
2. Cook for about 5 minutes until the oats are soft. Remove and stir in the mashed banana, cinnamon, and almond butter. Sweeten with honey if desired.

Tips: For added texture, top with sliced almonds and banana slices before serving.

Serving size: 1 cup of oatmeal

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 295; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 48g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 180mg; Sugar: 12g (without honey); Fiber: 7g

2. Ginger Pear Oatmeal

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 2 cups water
- 1 large pear, peeled and diced
- 1/2 tsp grated fresh ginger
- A pinch of salt & ground nutmeg
- 1 tbsp chopped walnuts (optional)

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, combine the rolled oats and water. Bring to a boil. Add the diced pear, fresh ginger, nutmeg, and a pinch of salt.
2. Reduce heat to low and simmer for 10 minutes till pears are soft and oatmeal is cooked. Remove. If desired, sprinkle with chopped walnuts before serving.

Tips: To enhance the flavor, lightly toast the walnuts before adding them to the oatmeal.

Serving size: 1 cup of oatmeal

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 235; Fat: 3g (without walnuts); Carbs: 45g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 80mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 6g

3. Honey Vanilla Overnight Oats

Preparation time: 10 minutes + chilling time

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 1 tbsp honey (preferably low-acidity, local honey)
- 1 cup almond milk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/4 cup Greek yogurt
- Pinch of salt
- 2 tbsp chia seeds

Directions:

1. In a large bowl, mix together the oats, chia seeds, and salt. Stir in the almond milk, vanilla extract, and honey until well combined.
2. Fold in the Greek yogurt until the mixture is smooth. Divide the mixture between two jars or containers with lids. Seal and refrigerate overnight before serving.

Tips: For a smoother texture, you can blend the mixture before refrigerating. Top with fresh fruit such as bananas or berries before serving if desired.

Serving size: 1/2 of the recipe

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 300; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 46g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 8g

4. Creamy Cashew & Berry Oatmeal

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 1 cup water
- 3/4 cup cashew milk
- 1/3 cup cashews (unsalted)
- 1 tbsp maple syrup
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon
- 1/2 cup mixed berries (strawberries, blueberries)

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, bring water to boil and then add oats. Reduce heat to low, cook for about five minutes until most of the water is absorbed.
2. Add in cashew milk, cashews, cinnamon, and maple syrup. Continue to cook on low heat for another ten minutes or until reaching desired consistency. Serve hot topped with mixed berries.

Tips: If fresh berries are not available or are too acidic for your reflux, you may use frozen berries as they are often less acidic.

Serving size: 1/2 of the recipe

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 315; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 44g; Protein: 9g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar: 7g; Fiber: 6g

5. Coconut Rice Oatmeal

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 1 cup coconut milk
- 1 cup water
- 1 tbsp shredded coconut
- 1 tsp honey (optional for sweetness)
- A pinch of salt

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, combine the rolled oats, coconut milk, water, and the pinch of salt. Bring the mixture to a boil and then reduce to a simmer, stirring occasionally.
2. Cook for 10-15 minutes or until the oats are soft and the mixture has thickened to your liking. Remove and stir in the shredded coconut. Sweeten with honey if desired.

Tips: For those with acid reflux, it is best to avoid too much sweetness. Adjust honey according to tolerance and preference.

Serving size: 1 bowl

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 280; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 34g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 40mg; Sugar: 4g (without honey); Fiber: 5g

6. Apple Walnut Creamy Oatmeal

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 1½ cups water
- 1 medium apple, peeled and diced
- 2 tbsp raw walnuts, chopped
- A pinch of cinnamon & salt

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, combine the rolled oats and water along with a pinch of salt. Cook on medium heat for 5 minutes.
2. Add the diced apple and cinnamon, then continue cooking for 10 minutes on low heat, until the oatmeal has a thick consistency. Garnish with raw chopped walnuts before serving.

Tips: Choose sweet varieties of apples such as Gala or Fuji to avoid acidity while still adding natural sweetness to your oatmeal.

Serving size: 1 bowl

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 260; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 39g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 10g; Fiber: 6g

7. Peachy Cinnamon Oatmeal

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 1 $\frac{3}{4}$ cups water
- 1 pinch salt
- $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp cinnamon
- 2 tbsp peach preserves, sugar-free
- $\frac{1}{2}$ cup fresh peaches, sliced
- Optional: 1 tbsp almond slivers (for garnish)

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, bring water to a boil and add a pinch of salt. Stir in the rolled oats and cinnamon, then reduce heat to medium.
2. Cook for 5 minutes or until the oats have absorbed the water and softened. Remove and let it sit 2 two minutes for the oats to thicken.
3. Divide the cooked oatmeal into bowls. Top each bowl with peach preserves and fresh peach slices.

Tips: Ensure the peach preserves are sugar-free to keep it acid reflux-friendly. Preferably choose ripe but firm peaches for a sweet taste without added sugars.

Serving size: 1 cup cooked oatmeal

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 29g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar: 7g (natural sugars); Fiber: 4g

8. Maple Blueberry Oatmeal

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 1¾ cups water
- Pinch of salt
- 2 tbsp pure maple syrup
- ½ cup blueberries
- sprinkle of ground flaxseeds (optional)

Directions:

1. Bring water with a pinch of salt to a boil in a saucepan. Add rolled oats and reduce the heat slightly to maintain a gentle boil.
2. Cook for 5 minutes, stirring occasionally until thickened. Remove and let it stand for 2 more minutes.
3. Stir in pure maple syrup until well mixed. Gently fold in blueberries so they warm up but do not burst.

Tips: Choose pure maple syrup and not "maple-flavored" syrup which can have additives and more acidity. Adding ground flaxseeds provides additional fiber without contributing to acid reflux symptoms.

Serving size: 1 cup of oatmeal

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 155; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 32g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar: 11g; Fiber: 5g

9. Golden Turmeric & Raisin Oatmeal

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 1 1/2 cups almond milk
- 1/2 tsp turmeric
- 1/4 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tbsp honey (or to taste)
- 1/3 cup raisins
- A pinch of salt

Directions:

1. In a small saucepan, bring the almond milk to a low boil. Stir in the rolled oats, turmeric, cinnamon, and salt.
2. Reduce heat and simmer for 10 minutes or until oatmeal reaches your desired consistency, stirring occasionally. Remove and stir in the honey and raisins. Divide into bowls and serve warm.

Tips: If you find the turmeric flavor too strong, start with less than suggested and adjust to taste. Add more almond milk when serving if you prefer a thinner consistency.

Serving size: 1/2 of the oatmeal

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 315; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 64g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 80mg; Sugar: 27g; Fiber: 7g

10. Carrot Cake Spiced Oatmeal

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 1 1/2 cups almond milk
- 1/2 cup grated carrots
- 1/4 tsp ground ginger
- 1/4 tsp nutmeg
- 1 tbsp maple syrup (or to taste)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla extract

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, bring almond milk to a gentle boil. Add rolled oats, grated carrots, ground ginger, and nutmeg.
2. Turn down the heat to a simmer, then cook for 10 minutes or until thickened as desired, stirring occasionally.
3. Turn off the heat, then stir in maple syrup and vanilla extract. Allow the oatmeal to cool slightly before serving.

Tips: Top with chopped walnuts or pecans for added texture and flavor if desired. Adjust sweetness with additional maple syrup to suit your palate.

Serving size: 1/2 of the oatmeal

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 320; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 65g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 95mg; Sugar: 22g; Fiber: 6g

Smoothies that Soothe the Stomach

11. Banana Almond Oat Smoothie

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 ripe banana
- 1/2 cup rolled oats
- 2 tbsp almond butter
- 2 cups almond milk, unsweetened
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon

Directions:

1. Place the banana, rolled oats, almond butter, almond milk, and ground cinnamon into a blender.
2. Blend on high speed until smooth and creamy. Serve.

Tips: For a thinner smoothie, add more almond milk as needed. Ensure your bananas are ripe for natural sweetness.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 345; Fat: 15g; Carbs: 45g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 190mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 7g

12. Ginger Pear Flaxseed Smoothie

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 ripe pears, cored and sliced
- 1 tbsp flaxseeds
- 1/2 tsp ginger, freshly grated
- 1 cup spinach leaves
- 2 cups coconut water

Directions:

1. Combine the pears, flaxseeds, fresh ginger, spinach leaves, and coconut water in a blender.
2. Blend until the mixture is smooth. Serve.

Tips: If the smoothie is too thick for your liking, you can add extra coconut water to adjust the consistency.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 38g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 60mg; Sugar: 25g; Fiber: 8g

13. Cucumber Melon Soothe Smoothie Bowl

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup honeydew melon, cubed
- 3/4 cup cucumber, peeled and sliced

- 1/2 cup Greek yogurt, unsweetened
- 1 tbsp honey (optional)
- 1/2 cup ice cubes
- 1/4 cup almond milk

Directions:

1. In a blender, combine the honeydew melon, cucumber, Greek yogurt, honey if using, and ice cubes. Blend on high until smooth.
2. While blending, gradually add the almond milk to achieve a smooth and creamy consistency. Pour the mixture into two bowls. Serve.

Tips: For those sensitive to honey or trying to reduce sugar intake, omit the honey; the natural sweetness of the melon should suffice.

Serving size: 1 1/2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 24g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 18g; Fiber: 2g

14. Apple Carrot Ginger Smoothie Bowl

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup apples, cored and sliced (preferably Fuji or Gala)
- 3/4 cup carrots, peeled and sliced
- 1 tsp fresh ginger root, grated
- 1/2 cup Greek yogurt, unsweetened
- 1 tbsp almond butter
- 1/2 cup ice cubes

Directions:

1. Place apples, carrots, grated ginger, Greek yogurt and almond butter into a blender. Add ice cubes to the mixture.
2. Blend on high until all ingredients are fully combined and the mixture is smooth. Divide between two bowls. Serve.

Tips: Use organic ingredients whenever possible to avoid pesticide exposure. The proportion of ginger can be adjusted according to taste and tolerance.

Serving size: 1 1/2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 160; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 27g; Protein:5g; Sodium:40mg; Sugar:18g; Fiber:4g

15. Avocado Spinach Coconut Smoothie

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 ripe avocado, peeled and pitted
- 1 cup fresh spinach leaves
- 1 cup coconut milk
- 1/2 cup ice cubes
- 1 tbsp honey (optional, for sweetness)

Directions:

1. In a blender, combine the avocado, spinach, coconut milk, ice cubes, and honey (if using).
2. Blend on high until the mixture is smooth and creamy. Divide the smoothie into glasses and serve immediately.

Tips: For a thinner consistency, add more coconut milk.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 230; Fat: 19g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 7g

16. Peach Basil Bliss Smoothie

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 fresh peaches, pitted and sliced
- 1 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1/2 cup Greek yogurt (low-fat)
- A handful of fresh basil leaves
- 1/2 cup ice cubes
- 1 tbsp honey (optional for sweetness)

Directions:

1. In a blender, combine peaches, almond milk, Greek yogurt, basil leaves, ice cubes and honey if desired.
2. Blend on high speed until smooth and well combined. Pour into glasses and serve immediately.

Tips: If you find the basil flavor too intense, start with a few leaves and adjust according to taste.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 2.5g; Carbs: 27g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 45mg; Sugar: 24g; Fiber: 3g

17. Berry Papaya Digestive Smoothie

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup papaya, diced
- 1/2 cup mixed berries (strawberries, blueberries, raspberries)
- 1 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1 tbsp honey (optional)
- 1/2 tsp ground ginger
- 2 tbsp rolled oats
- Ice cubes (optional for a cooler drink)

Directions:

1. In a blender, combine papaya, mixed berries, almond milk, honey (if using), ground ginger, and rolled oats.
2. Blend until smooth. If desired, add ice cubes and blend again to chill the smoothie. Pour into glasses and serve immediately.

Tips: Choose ripe papayas; they are gentler on the stomach. If berry seeds are a concern, you can strain the smoothie before serving.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 1.5g; Carbs: 32g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 95mg; Sugar: 20g; Fiber: 6g

18. Mango Spinach Lassi Smoothie

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup mango, diced
- 1 cup baby spinach leaves
- 1 cup low-fat Greek yogurt
- 1/4 tsp cardamom powder
- 1 tbsp honey (optional)
- Ice cubes (optional for a cooler drink)

Directions:

1. Place mango, spinach leaves, Greek yogurt, cardamom powder, and honey if using in a blender.
2. Blend until smooth and creamy. Add ice cubes if preferred and blend until you achieve the desired consistency.
3. Divide the lassi smoothly between glasses and enjoy it fresh.

Tips: For a smoother texture, you can blend the spinach with a bit of yogurt first before adding the rest of the ingredients.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 155; Fat: 1.5g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 55mg; Sugar: 22g; Fiber: 2g

19. Kiwi Honeydew Harmony Smoothie

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup honeydew, cubed
- 2 kiwis, peeled and sliced
- 1/2 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1 tbsp honey (optional)
- 1/2 tsp fresh ginger, grated
- A handful of ice cubes

Directions:

1. Combine honeydew, kiwis, almond milk, honey if using, and grated ginger in a blender.
2. Add ice cubes and blend on high speed until smooth. Pour into glasses and serve.

Tips: If the smoothie is too thick, add a little more almond milk to reach the desired consistency.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 120; Fat 0.5g; Carbs 29g; Protein 2g; Sodium 40mg; Sugar 20g; Fiber 3g

20. Cantaloupe Cream Smoothie Bowl

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 cups cantaloupe, cubed
- 1/2 cup Greek yogurt, plain

- 1/4 cup coconut water
- 1 tbsp chia seeds
- A pinch of ground cinnamon
- A sprinkle of unsweetened shredded coconut for topping (optional)

Directions:

1. Place cantaloupe cubes in the freezer for an hour before making the bowl to chill.
2. Blend frozen cantaloupe cubes with Greek yogurt, coconut water, chia seeds, and cinnamon until smooth. Pour mixture into bowls.
3. Top with shredded coconut if desired before serving.

Tips: For a creamier texture, use full-fat Greek yogurt. Freeze your serving bowl beforehand to keep the smoothie bowl chilled longer.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 135; Fat 3g; Carbs 24g; Protein 5g; Sodium 45mg; Sugar 18g; Fiber 2g

Egg Dishes for an Easy-to-Digest Morning

21. Low-Acid Scrambled Eggs with Spinach

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 4 large eggs
- 1 cup fresh spinach, chopped
- 2 tbsp low-fat milk
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tsp olive oil

Directions:

1. In a bowl, whisk together eggs, milk, salt, and pepper. Heat a non-stick pan over medium heat and add olive oil.
2. Add the spinach to the pan and sauté for 1 minute. Pour in the egg mixture and let it sit until edges begin to set.
3. Gently stir the mixture until eggs are fully cooked but remain moist.

Tips: Use a silicone spatula for gently stirring to avoid breaking down the eggs too much.

Serving size: 1/2 of the total recipe

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 190; Fat 14g; Carbs 2g; Protein 13g; Sodium 390mg; Sugar 1g; Fiber 0.5g

22. Zucchini and Basil Frittata

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 6 large eggs
- 1 cup zucchini, thinly sliced
- 1 tbsp fresh basil, chopped
- 1/4 cup low-fat cheese, shredded
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper
- 2 tsp olive oil

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. In a bowl, beat the eggs with basil, salt, and pepper.
2. Heat an oven-safe skillet over medium heat with olive oil. Sauté zucchini until tender. Spread zucchini evenly in skillet, pour egg mixture over it, sprinkle with cheese.
3. Cook without stirring for 2 minutes until edges set. Transfer skillet to oven and bake for 20 minutes until frittata is set. Serve.

Tips: Let the frittata sit for a few minutes before cutting for clean slices.

Serving size: 1/4 of frittata

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 13g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 340mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 0.7g

23. Sweet Potato Egg Bake

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups sweet potatoes, peeled and diced
- 4 large eggs
- 1/2 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp sea salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1/4 cup grated low-fat cheddar cheese

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F. Toss diced sweet potatoes with olive oil, salt, and pepper, then spread out on a baking dish. Bake for 20 minutes or until tender.
2. Whisk together eggs and almond milk. Once potatoes are tender, pour egg mixture over them and sprinkle grated cheese on top.
3. Return to the oven for 10 minutes or until eggs are set. Let it cool slightly before serving.

Tips: To avoid acid reflux, make sure not to overeat. Serve with a side of greens for added fiber.

Serving size: 1/4 of the bake

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 11g; Sodium: 410mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 3g

24. Oatmeal Egg Pancake

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 2 large eggs
- 1/2 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1 tbsp ground flaxseed
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- A pinch of sea salt

Directions:

1. Blend oats in a food processor until they reach a flour-like consistency.
2. Mix blended oats with eggs, almond milk, ground flaxseed, baking powder, and salt to form a batter.
3. Heat a non-stick skillet over medium heat and pour half the batter in, cooking until bubbles form on the surface.
4. Flip and cook the other side until golden brown. Repeat with remaining batter. Serve.

Tips: Serve warm with a dollop of Greek yogurt to keep it acid reflux-friendly.

Serving size: 1/2 of total pancakes made

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 290; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 34g; Protein: 14g; Sodium: 310mg; Sugar: Less than 1g; Fiber: 5g

25. Butternut Squash and Kale Omelet

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup butternut squash, diced
- 1 cup kale, chopped
- 4 large eggs
- 2 tbsp water
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper (optional)
- 1 tbsp olive oil

Directions:

1. Heat olive oil in a non-stick skillet over medium heat. Add the butternut squash and cook for 5 minutes until tender. Add the kale and cook for 2-3 minutes until wilted.
2. In a bowl, whisk together the eggs, water, salt, and black pepper. Pour egg mixture over the butternut squash and kale in the skillet.
3. Cook without stirring for 5 minutes or until the eggs are set. Carefully flip one half of the omelet over the other to form a semi-circle.
4. Cook for an additional minute or until fully set, then slide onto a plate. Serve.

Tips: Make sure to dice the butternut squash into small cubes so that it cooks quickly and evenly. Avoid browning the omelet as high heat can induce acidity.

Serving size: 1/2 of the total recipe

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 10g; Sodium: 400mg; Sugar: <1g; Fiber: 2g

26. Cottage Cheese Egg Scramble

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 4 large eggs
- 1/2 cup cottage cheese (low fat)
- 1 tbsp fresh chives, chopped
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- A pinch of salt

Directions:

1. Heat olive oil in a non-stick pan over medium-low heat. In a bowl, beat the eggs lightly and add to the pan.
2. Add a pinch of salt and stir gently until they begin to set. Before the eggs are completely done, add cottage cheese and chives.
3. Continue cooking while gently folding them in for another minute or two until fully cooked but still moist.

Tips: Do not overcook to avoid drying out as both dishes should be moist to help minimize irritation from acid reflux.

Serving size: 1/2 of the total scramble

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 215; Fat: 15g; Carbs: 2g; Protein: 19g; Sodium: 320mg; Sugar: <1g; Fiber: 0g

27. Carrot and Ginger Egg Muffins

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 6 muffins

Ingredients:

- 4 large eggs
- 1/2 cup grated carrots
- 1 tbsp grated ginger
- 1/4 cup almond flour
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp olive oil

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F and grease a 6-cup muffin tin with olive oil. In a large bowl, whisk together the eggs, grated carrots, and grated ginger.
2. Mix the almond flour, baking powder, and salt in a separate bowl, then fold into the egg mixture until just combined.
3. Pour the mixture evenly into the prepared muffin cups. Bake for 20 minutes or until the muffins are set and lightly golden on top.

Tips: You can add a teaspoon of chopped fresh herbs like parsley or chives for an extra flavor boost.

Serving size: 1 muffin

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 100; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 170mg; Sugar: 1g; Fiber: >1g

28. Alkaline Avocado with Poached Eggs

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 large eggs
- 1 ripe avocado
- Pinch of sea salt, black pepper & turmeric

Directions:

1. Fill a medium-sized pot with water and bring to a gentle simmer. Crack one egg into a small bowl or cup and carefully slide it into the simmering water, repeat with the other egg.
2. Poach for 4 minutes for soft eggs or longer for firmer ones. Meanwhile, halve the avocado, remove the pit, and scoop out each half onto a plate.
3. Once eggs are poached to your liking, remove with a slotted spoon, draining excess water, and place on top of each avocado half.
4. Season with sea salt, black pepper, and turmeric. Serve.

Tips: Use fresh eggs as they poach better than older eggs because their whites hold together more firmly.

Serving size: 1/2 an avocado with 1 poached egg

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 225; Fat: 17g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: less than 1g; Fiber: 7g

29. Quinoa Egg Puff with Fresh Herbs

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup quinoa
- 4 large eggs
- 1/2 cup low-fat milk
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 cup fresh herbs (parsley and chives), chopped
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp ground black pepper

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. Rinse quinoa under cold water and cook according to package instructions.
2. In a bowl, whisk together the eggs, milk, olive oil, salt, and pepper. Stir the cooked quinoa and fresh herbs into the egg mixture.
3. Pour mixture into a greased muffin tin or baking dish. Bake for 20 minutes or until the egg is set and the top is lightly golden.
4. Allow to cool for a few minutes before serving.

Tips: This recipe can be easily customized by adding different herbs.

Serving size: ¼ of the recipe

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 260; Fat: 10 g; Carbs: 30 g; Protein: 13g; Sodium: 320 mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 3g

30. Cauliflower Rice Egg Bowls

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 cups cauliflower rice
- 4 large eggs
- 1 tbsp coconut oil
- 1/2 tsp turmeric
- Pinch of salt & black pepper
- Fresh cilantro for garnish (optional)

Directions:

1. Heat coconut oil in a non-stick skillet over medium heat. Add cauliflower rice to skillet and cook for 5 minutes until tender.
2. Create two wells in the cauliflower rice and crack two eggs into each well. Sprinkle turmeric, salt, and pepper evenly over the mixture.
3. Cover skillet with a lid and cook until eggs are done to your liking. Garnish with fresh cilantro if desired before serving.

Tips: For added flavor without acid reflux triggers, consider adding a pinch of cumin or garlic powder.

Serving size: 1 bowl

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 220; Fat: 15g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 14g; Sodium: 280mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 3g

CHAPTER 5

Light Bites and Snacks

Quick Light Appetizer Bites

31. Cucumber Hummus Canapés

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 6

Ingredients:

- 2 large cucumbers, peeled & sliced into 1/2-inch thick rounds
- 1 cup hummus (store-bought or homemade)
- 1 tbsp chopped parsley
- 1 tsp olive oil (optional)
- Pinch of paprika (optional)
- Salt to taste (if needed, use sparingly)

Directions:

1. Spoon about a teaspoon of hummus on top of each cucumber round. If desired, lightly drizzle with olive oil and sprinkle with a pinch of paprika.
2. Garnish each canapé with chopped parsley. Serve immediately or chill until serving.

Tips: For the best texture, serve these canapés shortly after assembling.

Serving size: 4 canapés

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 50; Fat 2.5g; Carbs 6g; Protein 3g; Sodium 120mg; Sugar 1g; Fiber 1g

32. Carrot & Ginger Soup Sips

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 35 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 cups chopped carrots
- 2 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 3 cups low-sodium vegetable broth
- 1/4 tsp ground black pepper
- 1/2 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Salt to taste (optional)

Directions:

1. In a large pot, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add carrots and ginger and sauté for 5 minutes. Pour in vegetable broth, bring mixture to a boil then reduce heat to simmer.
2. Cook for 25–30 minutes until carrots are tender. Blend the soup in batches or use an immersion blender until smooth.
3. Stir in almond milk and season with black pepper (and salt if desired). Warm through before serving.

Tips: Serve in small cups or shot glasses as a fun appetizer.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 95; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 14g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 186mg; Sugar: 7g; Fiber: 4g

33. Rice Paper Veggie Rolls

Preparation time: 30 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 6

Ingredients:

- 12 rice paper wrappers
- 1 cup thinly sliced red cabbage
- 1 cup shredded carrots
- 1 lb. firm tofu, drained and cut into strips
- 1 cucumber, seeded and julienned
- A handful of fresh cilantro leaves

Directions:

1. Dip each rice paper wrapper into warm water to soften for about 15–20 seconds.
2. Place on a clean damp cloth, arranging some red cabbage, shredded carrots, tofu strips, cucumber juliennes, and cilantro evenly in the middle of each wrapper.
3. Fold the sides of the wrapper over the filling tightly rolling it up like a burrito. Repeat with remaining ingredients.

Tips: Keep rolls under damp paper towels to stay moist if not serving immediately. Pair with a mild acid reflux-friendly dip based on yogurt or soy sauce if desired.

Serving size: 1 roll

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 2.5g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 200mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 2g

34. Avocado Toast Bites

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 ripe avocados, peeled and pitted
- 1 tbsp fresh lemon juice (substitute for citric acid to avoid citrus)
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper, ground
- 4 slices whole-grain bread, toasted and quartered
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Fresh parsley, chopped (for garnish)

Directions:

1. In a medium bowl, mash the avocados with lemon juice, salt, and pepper until smooth. Lightly brush each toast quarter with olive oil.
2. Spread the avocado mixture onto toast quarters. Garnish with chopped parsley before serving.

Tips: For best results, use avocados that yield to gentle pressure for a creamy spread.

Serving size: 4 toast bites

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 230; Fat: 15g; Carbs: 21g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 7g

35. Chilled Strawberry Soup Shots

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups strawberries, hulled and halved
- 1 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1 tbsp honey (optional for sweetness)
- A pinch of ground cardamom

Directions:

1. Combine strawberries and almond milk in a blender. Blend until smooth. Chill the mixture in the refrigerator for at least one hour.
2. Pour soup into shot glasses. Sprinkle with cardamom to taste.

Tips: Ensure the soup is thoroughly chilled before serving to enhance its refreshing quality.

Serving size: 1 shot glass

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 55; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 40mg; Sugar: 6g (without honey); Fiber: 3g

36. Baked Pear and Cheese Crostini

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 baguette, sliced into 1/2-inch pieces
- 2 ripe pears, cored and thinly sliced
- 1 cup shredded mozzarella cheese

- 1/2 tsp dried thyme

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F. Place baguette slices on a baking sheet. Top each slice with pear slices and shredded mozzarella cheese.
2. Sprinkle dried thyme evenly over the crostini. Bake for 10 minutes or until cheese is melted and slightly golden.

Tips: Choose ripe but firm pears for the best texture after baking. For added flavor, toast baguette slices lightly before adding toppings.

Serving size: 3 crostini

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 30g; Protein: 8g; Sodium: 240mg; Sugar: 8g; Fiber: 3g

37. Ginger Sesame Glazed Chicken Skewers

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. of chicken breast, cut into cubes
- 2 tbsp low-sodium soy sauce
- 1 tbsp sesame oil
- 1 tsp grated fresh ginger
- 1/4 tsp black pepper

Directions:

1. In a mixing bowl, combine low-sodium soy sauce, sesame oil, fresh ginger, and black pepper. Add chicken cubes to the marinade and let sit for at least 15 minutes.
2. Preheat your grill or grill pan over medium heat. Thread marinated chicken cubes onto skewers.

3. Grill for about 5 minutes per side or until chicken is cooked through and has nice grill marks.

Tips: Soak wooden skewers in water for at least an hour to prevent burning on the grill.

Serving size: 2 skewers

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 2g; Protein: 26g; Sodium: 330mg; Sugar: <1g; Fiber: <1g

38. Smoked Salmon Bagel with Avocado

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 0 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 whole-grain bagels
- 4 tbsp low-fat cream cheese
- 4 oz smoked salmon
- ½ avocado, thinly sliced
- 1 tbsp capers
- 1 tbsp dill, freshly chopped
- 1 cucumber, thinly sliced

Directions:

1. Toast the whole-grain bagels to your desired level of crispiness. Spread each half with a tablespoon of low-fat cream cheese.
2. Place an ounce of smoked salmon on each bagel half. Top the smoked salmon with slices of cucumber and avocado evenly between the bagel halves.
3. Garnish each with capers and fresh dill. Serve immediately.

Tips: Ensuring the smoked salmon is labeled 'low sodium' can help manage salt intake. For a gluten-free option, use gluten-free bagels.

Serving size: 1 bagel half

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 290; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 33g; Protein: 19g; Sodium: 710mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 5g

39. Poached Salmon Salad on Endive Leaves

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 (6-oz) salmon fillets
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp pepper
- 8 endive leaves, rinsed and patted dry
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- 1 cucumber, thinly sliced into half-moons
- 1 avocado, cubed

Directions:

1. Fill a skillet with about an inch of water, add salt and bring to a gentle simmer.
2. Place the salmon fillets in the skillet and cover. Poach the salmon for about 15 minutes until cooked through.
3. Remove the salmon from the skillet, let it cool slightly, then flake it with a fork.
4. In a large bowl, mix together the olive oil and pepper. Add the flaked salmon, dill, cucumber, and avocado, tossing gently to combine.
5. Arrange the endive leaves on plates and spoon the salmon mixture onto each leaf.

Tips: To ensure gentle poaching, keep the water at a bare simmer just enough to see small bubbles. Overcooking can make salmon tough; watch for when it becomes opaque as a sign it's done.

Serving size: 2 endive leaves filled with salmon mixture

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 367, Fat: 22g, Carbs: 8g, Protein: 34g, Sodium: 404mg, Sugar: 2g, Fiber: 4g

40. Cucumber Avocado Roll-Ups

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 large cucumber
- 1 ripe avocado, peeled and pitted
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh dill
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Spinach leaves (optional) for filling

Directions:

1. Using a vegetable peeler or mandolin set to a very thin setting, slice the cucumber into long, wide strips.
2. In a bowl, mash the avocado and mix in chopped dill. Season with salt and pepper to taste.
3. Lay cucumber slices flat on a clean surface. Put a spoonful of avocado mixture at one end of each strip.
4. If using, add a few spinach leaves over the avocado mixture. Carefully roll up the cucumber strips with the filling inside and arrange them on a plate.

Tips: Use toothpicks to secure the roll-ups if they have trouble staying closed.

Serving size: 2 roll-ups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 4g

Alkalizing Snacks for Between Meals

41. Baked Zucchini Chips

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 large zucchinis, thinly sliced
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp ground black pepper

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 450°F.
2. In a bowl, toss the zucchini slices with olive oil, salt, and pepper. Arrange slices on a lined baking sheet.
3. Bake for 10 minutes, then flip each slice and continue baking for another 10 minutes or until crisp and golden. Remove and let it cool before serving.

Tips: For crispier chips, slice zucchini as thin as possible. Do not overcrowd the baking sheet to ensure even cooking.

Serving size: 1/2 cup of zucchini chips

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 76; Fat: 3.5g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 3g

42. Almond-Stuffed Dates

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 16 Medjool dates, pitted
- 1/3 cup almonds

Directions:

1. Carefully open up each date where it was pitted.
2. Insert two almonds into each date where the pit was removed. Press the dates closed as much as possible. Place them in your serving plate, then serve.

Tips: Choose plump and moist Medjool dates for easier filling. Keep refrigerated until ready to serve to maintain freshness.

Serving size: 4 stuffed dates

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 228; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 46g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 38g; Fiber: 6g

43. Cucumber Hummus Bites

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 large cucumbers, sliced into 1/2 inch rounds
- 1 cup hummus (store-bought or homemade, without garlic or lemon juice)
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp paprika (optional for garnish)

- Fresh parsley leaves (for garnish)

Directions:

1. Arrange cucumber slices on a serving platter. In each cucumber round, spoon approximately 1 tablespoon of hummus.
2. Drizzle with olive oil and sprinkle paprika lightly for color if desired. Garnish each bite with a parsley leaf. Serve.

Tips: Choose firm, bright green cucumbers for best results and avoid overripe ones as they might be too watery. If making hummus from scratch, use ingredients that are less likely to trigger acid reflux, like chickpeas, tahini, and a small amount of olive oil instead of traditional additions like garlic and lemon.

Serving size: 5 cucumber bites

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 115; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 210mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 3g

44. Chilled Quinoa Fruit Salad

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup quinoa, washed
- 2 cups water
- 1 cup diced strawberries
- 1 cup diced mango
- 1 cup blueberries
- 2 tbsp honey (optional)

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, bring quinoa and water to a boil. Reduce to simmer, cover, and cook for 15 minutes until all water is absorbed.
2. Fluff the cooked quinoa with a fork and allow it to cool completely.
3. In a large bowl, combine the chilled quinoa, strawberries, mango, and blueberries.
4. Drizzle with honey if desired and gently toss to combine. Refrigerate until ready to serve.

Tips: For best flavor, allow salad to chill for at least one hour before serving. Substitute any berries or fruits according to availability or taste preference.

Serving size: Approximately 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 170; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 35g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 13mg; Sugar: 10g (without honey); Fiber: 4g

45. Coconut Yogurt & Berry Parfait

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups plain coconut yogurt
- 1 cup granola (without chocolate or citrus)
- 1/2 cup raspberries
- 1/2 cup blackberries
- 1/2 tsp vanilla extract

Directions:

1. In a small bowl, mix the vanilla extract into the coconut yogurt until well combined. Prepare four glasses or parfait cups.
2. Spoon a layer of coconut yogurt into each glass followed by a layer of granola. Add a layer of raspberries and blackberries on top of the granola.
3. Repeat the layers until all ingredients are used up, finishing with a layer of berries on top. Serve.

Tips: For added texture and taste, sprinkle some toasted unsweetened coconut flakes on top of each parfait. Ensure your granola is free from high acid ingredients such as dried fruit or chocolate chips.

Serving size: ¾ cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 35mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 3g

46. Baked Kale Chips

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. kale leaves, washed and torn into bite-size pieces
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Pinch of salt (optional)

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F.
2. In a large bowl, gently toss kale pieces in olive oil until evenly coated. If desired, sprinkle with a pinch of salt.
3. Arrange the kale on a lined baking sheet. Bake for 10 minutes or until the edges are brown but not burnt.
4. Remove and let the kale chips cool slightly on the baking sheet for crispy texture.

Tips: Make sure kale is thoroughly dried after washing to avoid steaming while baking. Consume within a few hours of baking for maximum crispiness.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 50mg; Sugar: <1g; Fiber: >1g

47. Alkaline Energy Balls

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 12 balls

Ingredients:

- 1 cup raw almonds
- 3/4 cup dates, pitted
- 2 tbsp shredded coconut, unsweetened
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tbsp chia seeds
- A pinch of salt

Directions:

1. Place the almonds in a food processor and pulse until finely ground.
2. Add the dates, shredded coconut, cinnamon, chia seeds, and salt to the processor and blend until the mixture sticks together.
3. Take small amounts of the mixture and roll into balls, about 1 inch in diameter. Place the energy balls on a tray and refrigerate for at least an hour to set.

Tips: You can substitute chia seeds with flax seeds or use a mix of both for additional nutrients.

Serving size: 1 ball

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 95; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 6g; Fiber: 2g

48. Baked Apple Cinnamon Slices

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 large apples, cored and sliced into thin rounds
- 1 tbsp cinnamon
- 1 tbsp coconut oil, melted

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 325°F. In a large bowl, toss the apple slices with cinnamon and melted coconut oil until evenly coated.
2. Arrange the slices on a lined baking sheet. Bake for about 20 minutes or until the edges of the slices are dried and crispy.
3. Remove from the oven and allow to cool before serving.

Tips: Choose firm apples like Granny Smith or Honeycrisp for best results.

Serving size: about 1 apple's worth of slices

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 95; Fat: 3.5g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 0.5g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 13g; Fiber: 3g

49. Roasted Chickpeas with Rosemary

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 40 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups chickpeas, cooked or canned, drained and rinsed
- 1 tbsp olive oil

- 1 tsp dried rosemary, crushed
- 1/4 tsp salt (optional)

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F. Pat the chickpeas dry with paper towels. Removing as much moisture as possible will help them crisp up while baking.
2. Toss the chickpeas with olive oil, rosemary, and salt (if using) until evenly coated. Spread the chickpeas in an even layer on a lined baking sheet.
3. Roast for 40 minutes, or until golden brown and crispy, stirring occasionally to ensure even cooking. Remove from the oven and let it cool slightly before serving.

Tips: For added zing, you can sprinkle freshly squeezed lemon juice over the roasted chickpeas before serving.

Serving size: about 1/2 cup of roasted chickpeas

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 146; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 200mg; Sugar: 4g; Fiber: 6g

50. Cauliflower Popcorn with Herbs

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. cauliflower florets
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- Salt (optional), to taste

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 425°F. In a large bowl, toss cauliflower florets with olive oil, oregano, thyme, and salt if using.
2. Spread out on a baking sheet, then bake for about 20 minutes or until golden brown and crispy.

Tips: Stir halfway through cooking to ensure even browning. Serve immediately for the best texture.

Serving size: Half of the total recipe

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 150; Fat 14g; Carbs 6g; Protein 2g; Sodium 30mg; Sugar 3g; Fiber 3g

Dips, Spreads, and Toppings for Reflux Prevention

51. Roasted Beetroot Hummus

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 45 minutes

Servings: 2 cups

Ingredients:

- 4 medium beetroots (about 1 lb.)
- 1 cup cooked chickpeas
- 3 tbsp tahini
- A pinch of salt & ground cumin
- Water to desired consistency

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F. Wrap each beetroot in foil and place on a baking sheet. Roast in the oven for 45 minutes or until tender. Let it cool before peeling.
2. Combine roasted beets, chickpeas, tahini, salt, and cumin in a food processor.
3. Process until smooth and add water as needed until the hummus reaches your desired consistency. Serve chilled or at room temperature.

Tips: For a smoother texture, peel your chickpeas by gently pinching them to slip off their skins.

Serving size: Roughly two tablespoons

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 35; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 55mg; Sugar: less than 1g; Fiber: 1g

52. Avocado and Greek Yogurt Dip

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 ripe avocado, peeled and pitted
- 1 cup plain Greek yogurt
- 1/2 tsp sea salt
- 1/4 tsp ground black pepper
- 1/4 cup finely chopped cilantro
- 2 tsp olive oil

Directions:

1. In a medium bowl, mash the peeled and pitted avocado with a fork until smooth. Add the plain Greek yogurt, and stir until well combined.
2. Season with sea salt and ground black pepper. Gently fold in the finely chopped cilantro for a fresh touch. Drizzle olive oil over the mixture and give it a final stir.

Tips: Serve this dip with acid reflux-friendly options like carrot sticks, cucumber slices or whole-grain pita bread.

Serving size: 1/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 140; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 4g

53. Ginger-Pear Chutney

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 6

Ingredients:

- 2 ripe pears, peeled, cored, and diced
- 1 tbsp freshly grated ginger root
- 3 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- 1/4 tsp ground cinnamon
- A pinch of sea salt & ground black pepper
- 1/4 cup water

Directions:

1. Combine diced pears, grated ginger root, apple cider vinegar, ground cinnamon, sea salt, black pepper, and water in a medium saucepan over low heat.
2. Cook gently for 25 minutes or until pears are soft and the mixture has thickened. Allow to cool slightly before transferring to a serving bowl.

Tips: This chutney pairs wonderfully with grilled chicken or as a spread on acid reflux-friendly toast. Make sure to cook on low heat to prevent any potential aggravation from higher acidic ingredients when heated too rapidly.

Serving size: 2 tablespoons

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 45; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 50mg; Sugar: 8g; Fiber: 2g

54. Herbed Cottage Cheese Spread

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup cottage cheese (low fat)
- 2 tbsp chives, finely chopped
- 1 tbsp parsley, finely chopped
- 1 tsp dill, dried
- 1/4 tsp garlic powder
- 1/8 tsp sea salt
- A pinch of black pepper

Directions:

1. In a medium bowl, combine all the ingredients. Mix until well blended.
2. Refrigerate for at least an hour before serving to allow flavors to meld.

Tips: Serve with sliced cucumber or carrot sticks for a refreshing and stomach-friendly snack.

Serving size: 1/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 81; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 14g; Sodium: 500mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 0g

55. Roasted Red Pepper Tapenade

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup roasted red peppers, skin removed (jarred in water), chopped

- 2 tbsp capers, drained & chopped
- 1 tbsp fresh basil leaves, chopped
- 2 tsp olive oil
- 1/4 tsp sea salt
- A pinch of black pepper

Directions:

1. In a bowl, combine the red peppers, capers, basil leaves, olive oil, sea salt, and black pepper. Mix well.
2. Let sit for at least half an hour to allow flavors to develop.

Tips: This tapenade can be used as a topping for whole-grain crackers ensure they are low in fat and fiber for better acid reflux compatibility.

Serving size: 3 tablespoons

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 32; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: <1g; Sodium: 600mg; Sugar: <1g; Fiber: <1g

56. Banana Walnut Butter

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 8

Ingredients:

- 2 ripe bananas
- 1/2 cup walnuts
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- A pinch of salt
- Optional for additional creaminess: 2 tbsp of rolled oats

Directions:

1. Place all ingredients in a food processor.

2. Process until smooth and creamy, scraping down the sides as needed. Serve.

Tips: This butter is perfect for spreading on whole-grain toast or adding to oatmeal.

Serving size: 2 tbsp

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 95; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 5mg; Sugar: 7g; Fiber: 2g

57. Ginger Pear Applesauce

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 3 ripe pears, peeled, cored, and chopped
- 1 tbsp fresh ginger, grated
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ¼ cup water

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, combine pears, ginger, cinnamon, and water. Bring the mixture to a simmer over medium heat.
2. Cover and reduce the heat to low. Cook for 25 minutes or until pears are soft. Mash the mixture to your desired consistency.

Tips: For smoother applesauce, blend with an immersion blender. Add more ginger if a stronger flavor is desired.

Serving size: ½ cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 100; Fat 0g; Carbs 27g; Protein 0.5g; Sodium 2mg; Sugar 20g; Fiber 6g

58. Watermelon Feta Salsa

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups diced seedless watermelon
- 1/2 cup crumbled feta cheese
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp lime zest
- 1/2 tsp freshly ground black pepper

Directions:

1. In a medium bowl, gently mix the diced watermelon, and feta cheese. Drizzle with olive oil and lime zest, then season with black pepper.
2. Toss everything gently until well combined. Chill in the refrigerator for about 10 minutes before serving if desired.

Tips: For the best flavor, use fresh, ripe watermelon. You can adjust the amount of feta cheese according to your taste preferences.

Serving size: 1/2 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 80; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 7g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 180mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 0.5g

59. Tomato-Free Guacamole

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 0 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 ripe avocados, peeled and pitted
- 1/4 cup finely chopped cilantro
- 1/4 cup finely chopped bell peppers
- 2 tbsp diced cucumber
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp ground cumin
- 2 tbsp olive oil

Directions:

1. In a medium bowl, mash the avocados using a fork or potato masher. Stir in cilantro, bell peppers, cucumber, salt, cumin, and olive oil until well combined.
2. Adjust seasoning if necessary and serve immediately or chill until ready to serve.

Tips: For a smoother consistency, use a food processor. Keep pit in the bowl to prevent browning.

Serving size: 1/2 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 13g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: <1g; Fiber: 7g

60. Smoked Almond and Chickpea Pâté

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup canned chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 1/2 cup smoked almonds, unsalted
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- 1/2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1/4 tsp sea salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper

Directions:

1. In a food processor, blend together smoked almonds until finely ground. Add in the chickpeas, olive oil, apple cider, paprika, sea salt, and black pepper.
2. Process until smooth, scraping down the sides as necessary. Serve chilled or at room temperature.

Tips: For a smoother pâté, add a tablespoon of water at a time until desired consistency is reached. Can be served with vegetable sticks or gluten-free crackers.

Serving size: 1/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 210; Fat: 15g; Carbs: 15g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 320mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 4g

CHAPTER 6

Lunches to Prevent Flare-Ups

Salads That Love Your Gut

61. Lean Turkey Cobb Salad

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. turkey breast, cooked and diced
- 4 cups romaine lettuce, chopped
- 2 medium avocados, diced
- 1/2 cup cucumber, diced
- 4 tbsp chives, finely chopped
- 4 hard-boiled eggs, quartered (optional)
- 1/2 cup almond milk
- 1 tbsp dairy-free mayonnaise

Directions:

1. In a large bowl, combine romaine lettuce, diced turkey breast, avocados, cucumber, and chives.
2. In a separate bowl, whisk together almond milk and dairy-free mayonnaise until smooth to create the dairy-free ranch dressing.
3. Drizzle the dairy-free ranch over the salad and toss gently to combine. Divide the salad among four plates and garnish with hard-boiled eggs if desired.

Tips: Ensure turkey breast is cooked thoroughly before dicing. For a creamier dressing, you can blend the dairy-free mayonnaise and almond milk in a blender until smooth.

Serving size: 2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 320; Fat: 18g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 32g; Sodium: 170mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 6g

62. Mild Lentil Tabouleh Salad with Grapes

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings:4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup dried green lentils
- 2 cups water (for cooking lentils)
- 3 cups parsley, finely chopped
- 1 cup grapes, halved
- Finely grated zest of 1 small lemon (ensuring no white pith to avoid bitterness)
- Salt & black pepper to taste (optional)

Directions:

1. Rinse lentils and then combine with water in a medium saucepan. Let it boil, reduce heat and simmer for ten minutes until tender. Drain well and let it cool.
2. In a large bowl mix together cooked lentils, parsley, grapes, and lemon zest. Season with salt and black pepper if you wish.

Tips: If the acid from even the lemon zest is too much for your reflux condition, feel free to exclude it or swap it with another non-citrus zest such as mango or pear peel. Make sure that lentils are cooled before mixing them with the other ingredients to maintain freshness of the salad

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 240; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 40g; Protein: 18g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 4g; Fiber: 21g

63. Dill Salmon with Mixed Greens Salad

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 (6 oz) salmon fillets
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp dill, fresh or dried
- 4 cups mixed greens
- 1/2 cucumber, sliced
- 1 tbsp balsamic vinegar

Directions:

1. Brush each salmon fillet with olive oil and sprinkle with dill.
2. Heat a non-stick skillet over medium heat. Place salmon fillets skin side down and cook for about 5 minutes. Flip carefully and cook for another 5-7 minutes or until desired doneness.
3. In a large bowl, toss mixed greens and cucumber slices with balsamic vinegar. Divide the salad onto plates and top each with a cooked salmon fillet.

Tips: For an even more acid reflux-friendly dish, ensure your balsamic vinegar is low in acidity. Choose fresh dill when possible for more flavor.

Serving size: 1 salmon fillet with salad

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 367; Fat: 21g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 34g; Sodium: 104mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 2g

64. Balsamic Honey Chicken Garden Salad

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 (6 oz) chicken breasts, boneless and skinless
- 1 tbsp honey (preferably low-glycemic index)
- 1 tbsp balsamic vinegar
- 4 cups garden salad mix
- 1/2 cup cherry tomatoes, halved

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F. In a small bowl, whisk together honey and balsamic vinegar.
2. Place chicken in a baking dish and pour the honey balsamic mixture over it. Bake for 20 minutes or until chicken is thoroughly cooked.
3. Slice the cooked chicken and allow it to cool slightly. Combine garden salad mix and cherry tomatoes in a bowl. Top salad with sliced chicken breast. Serve.

Tips: Cook the chicken ahead of time to let it cool before adding it to the salad if preferred cold. If sensitive to honey, you can skip this ingredient or find an appropriate substitute.

Serving size: Half of the chicken breast with salad

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 324; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 14g; Protein: 55g; Sodium: 128mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 3g

65. Greek Yogurt Dressed Pasta Salad

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup whole wheat pasta
- 1/2 cup plain Greek yogurt
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup diced cucumber
- 1/4 cup chopped fresh dill
- 1/2 lb. cooked chicken breast, diced

Directions:

1. Cook the whole wheat pasta according to the package directions until al dente, then drain and rinse under cold water to cool.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together Greek yogurt, olive oil, salt, and black pepper.
3. Add the cooled pasta to the yogurt mixture along with the diced cucumber, fresh dill, and cooked chicken breast. Toss until all ingredients are well coated with the dressing.
4. Chill in the refrigerator for about 10 minutes before serving.

Tips: Ensure all ingredients are at room temperature before mixing to avoid curdling of the yogurt. If you're prepping ahead of time, keep the dressing separate and mix just before serving.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 290; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 27g; Sodium: 170mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 4g

66. Roasted Sweet Potato and Arugula Salad

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 large sweet potatoes, peeled and cubed (about 4 cups)
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 4 cups arugula
- 1/4 cup raw walnuts, chopped
- 2 tbsp balsamic vinegar

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F. Toss the sweet potato cubes with olive oil, salt, and pepper on a baking sheet. Spread in an even layer.
2. Roast for 30 minutes or until tender, stirring halfway through. Once the sweet potatoes are ready, let them cool slightly.
3. Combine the roasted sweet potatoes with arugula and chopped walnuts in a large salad bowl.
4. Drizzle balsamic vinegar over the salad and toss gently to coat everything evenly. Serve.

Tips: For added protein, consider adding chickpeas or sliced chicken breast that's been cooked without trigger ingredients for acid reflux.

Serving size: 2 cups of salad

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 27g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 330mg; Sugar: 7g; Fiber: 6g

67. Quinoa & Black Bean Salad

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup uncooked quinoa, washed
- 2 cups water
- 1 cup canned black beans, rinsed and drained
- 1 large red bell pepper, diced
- 1 cucumber, peeled and diced
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- Salt (to taste, optional)

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, bring 2 cups of water to a boil. Add quinoa and reduce heat to low. Cover and simmer for 15 minutes until quinoa is tender and water is absorbed. Remove and let it cool.
2. In a large bowl, combine cooled quinoa, black beans, red bell pepper, and cucumber. Toss gently to mix.
3. In a small bowl, whisk together olive oil and apple cider vinegar. Drizzle over the salad and toss again to coat. Season with salt if desired. Serve.

Tips: For added flavor, you can add a pinch of cumin or coriander. Make sure to rinse black beans thoroughly to remove any excess sodium.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 260; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 39g; Protein: 9g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 8g

68. Spinach & Boiled Egg White Salad

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

- **Ingredients:**

- 4 cups fresh spinach leaves
- 4 egg whites, hard boiled and chopped
- 1/2 cup shredded carrots
- 1/2 cup English cucumber, sliced thinly
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Salt & pepper to taste (optional)

Directions:

1. Arrange spinach leaves on four plates as the base of the salad. Top spinach with equal portions of chopped egg whites, shredded carrots, and sliced cucumber.
2. Drizzle olive oil over each serving. Season with salt and pepper if desired.

Tips: For more robust flavor without adding acid reflux triggers, consider adding fresh herbs like parsley or basil. To further reduce acidity for sensitive individuals, rinse the chopped egg whites with water.

Serving size: 1 hearty bowl

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 125mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 1g

69. Herbed Quinoa and Chickpea Bowl

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup quinoa, rinsed
- 2 cups water
- 1 cup canned chickpeas, rinsed and drained
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1/4 cup fresh basil leaves, chopped
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley leaves, chopped

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, bring water to a boil. Add quinoa, cover, and reduce heat to low. Simmer for 15 minutes or until quinoa is cooked.
2. Remove quinoa and let it stand for five minutes covered. Then fluff with a fork.
3. In a separate bowl, mix together chickpeas with olive oil, salt, pepper, basil, and parsley. Add the seasoned chickpeas to the cooked quinoa and stir until well combined.
4. Divide the herbed quinoa and chickpea mixture into bowls.

Tips: For added freshness, top each bowl with slices of cucumber or avocado right before serving to enhance texture without adding triggering ingredients.

Serving size: 1 cup of herbed quinoa mixture

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 36g; Protein: 9g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: <1g; Fiber: 6g

70. Light Tuna and White Bean Salad

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 (15 oz) can no-salt-added white beans, drained and rinsed
- 1 (5 oz) can light tuna in water, drained and flaked
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- Pinch of black pepper
- A few leaves of baby spinach for garnish

Directions:

1. In a bowl, combine white beans and flaked tuna. Gently stir in olive oil, apple cider vinegar, fresh parsley, and black pepper until all ingredients are evenly mixed.
2. Let it sit for a few minutes to allow flavors to meld together. Serve garnished with baby spinach leaves on top.

Tips: For added texture, include a handful of chopped celery. Always choose no-salt-added or low sodium canned products to control your sodium intake.

Serving size: 3/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 20g; Protein: 18g; Sodium: 125mg; Sugar: Less than 1g; Fiber: 6g

71. Shredded Turkey & Mixed Greens Salad

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 cups of mixed greens (spinach, arugula, romaine)
- 1/2 lb. shredded cooked turkey breast
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- 1 tsp honey (optional)
- 1/4 cup sliced almonds
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Directions:

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine the mixed greens and shredded turkey. Drizzle the olive oil and apple cider vinegar over the salad.
2. Add honey if desired for a hint of sweetness. Sprinkle with sliced almonds, salt, and black pepper. Toss everything together until well mixed.

Tips: For the best flavor, use turkey that was cooked without heavy seasonings or oils to meet acid reflux-friendly criteria.

Serving size: 2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 350; Fat: 18g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 38g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 5g

72. Asian-Glazed Tofu & Broccoli Salad

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1/2 lb. firm tofu, pressed and cubed
- 2 cups broccoli florets
- 1 tbsp soy sauce (low sodium)
- 1/2 tbsp maple syrup
- 1 tbsp sesame oil
- 1 tbsp rice vinegar
- Sesame seeds for garnish (optional)
- Salt to taste

Directions:

1. In a non-stick skillet over medium heat, add sesame oil and tofu cubes. Cook the tofu for about 5 minutes on each side until golden brown. Steam broccoli florets for 3–5 minutes until just tender.
2. In a small bowl, whisk together soy sauce, maple syrup, and rice vinegar to create a glaze. Once tofu is cooked, pour the glaze over the tofu and toss to coat evenly.
3. Allow to cook for an additional minute on low heat so that tofu can absorb flavors. Arrange broccoli on plates and top with glazed tofu. Garnish with sesame seeds if desired.

Tips: Pressing tofu before cooking ensures it absorbs more of the glaze.

Serving size: 6 ounces tofu with a cup of broccoli

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250; Fat: 15g; Carbs 14g; Protein 16g; Sodium 400mg; Sugar 6g; Fiber 3g

Sandwiches & Wraps for Easy Digestion

73. Grilled Chicken and Avocado Wraps

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (about 1 lb.)
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 4 whole wheat wraps
- 2 avocados, sliced
- 1 cup baby spinach leaves
- 1/2 cup shredded mozzarella cheese

Directions:

1. Season the chicken breasts with salt and pepper. Heat olive oil in a grill pan over medium heat.
2. Grill the chicken for about 5 minutes on each side, until cooked through. Let the chicken rest for a few minutes and then slice it thinly.
3. Place the wraps flat and distribute the baby spinach leaves, sliced chicken, avocado slices, and mozzarella cheese evenly among them. Roll up the wraps tightly, cut in half, and serve.

Tips: Ensure the grill pan is hot before adding your chicken to avoid sticking. If you do not have a grill pan, you can use a regular frying pan.

Serving size: 1 wrap

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 470; Fat: 22g; Carbs: 40g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 680mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 7g

74. Baked Salmon Spinach Wrap

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 (6 oz.) salmon fillets
- 1 tsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp pepper
- 2 cups baby spinach leaves, fresh
- 8 tbsp hummus
- 4 large whole-grain wraps

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F. Brush the salmon fillets with olive oil and season with salt and pepper.
2. Place salmon on a baking sheet lined with parchment paper and bake for 15 minutes or until it flakes easily.
3. Lay out the wraps, spread each with 2 tbsp of hummus, and distribute the spinach leaves evenly among them.
4. Once salmon is cooked, let it cool slightly before breaking it into smaller pieces and dividing it among the wraps. Roll the wraps tightly, cut in half, and serve.

Tips: Opt for low-acidity hummus to keep the dish acid reflux-friendly. Ensure the salmon is not overcooked to maintain moisture.

Serving size: 1 wrap

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 350; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 33g; Protein: 34g; Sodium: 400mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 5g

75. Basil Pesto Chicken Wrap

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups shredded cooked chicken breast
- 4 tbsp basil pesto (without garlic)
- 4 whole wheat wraps
- 1 cup spinach leaves, fresh
- 1/2 cup shredded carrots
- 1/4 cup sliced almonds

Directions:

1. In a bowl, mix the cooked chicken breast with the basil pesto until evenly coated.
2. Lay out the whole wheat wraps and distribute the spinach leaves and shredded carrots among them. Add the pesto chicken mixture to each wrap.
3. Sprinkle sliced almonds on top of the chicken mixture. Roll each wrap tightly, cut in half, and serve.

Tips: Ensure your pesto is made without garlic to comply with acid reflux dietary restrictions.

Serving size: 1 wrap

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 350; Fat 15g; Carbs 27g; Protein 26g; Sodium 400mg; Sugar 3g; Fiber 5g

76. Smoked Turkey Lettuce Wrap

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. smoked turkey breast slices, low sodium
- 8 large lettuce leaves, preferably romaine or butter lettuce
- 1 avocado, sliced
- 1/2 cup shredded carrot
- 1/2 cup cucumber, thinly sliced
- 2 tbsp slivered almonds

Directions:

1. Wash and pat dry lettuce leaves. Lay two lettuce leaves on top of each other to form a sturdier base. Place an even portion of smoked turkey slices on each lettuce base.
2. Add avocado slices, shredded carrot, and cucumber slices on top of the turkey. Sprinkle slivered almonds over the fillings.
3. Carefully roll up the lettuce wraps and serve immediately.

Tips: Use freshly cooked or quality pre-packaged low sodium smoked turkey to avoid excess salt and fats that can trigger acid reflux.

Serving size: 2 wraps

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 240; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 30g; Sodium: 350mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 4g

77. Vegan Hummus and Cucumber Sandwich

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 4 slices whole grain bread
- 1 cup hummus
- 1 medium cucumber, thinly sliced
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp salt (optional)
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tsp fresh dill, chopped

Directions:

1. Lay out the slices of bread on a clean surface. Spread a generous amount of hummus on each slice.
2. Place the thinly sliced cucumber on two of the slices. Drizzle olive oil lightly over the cucumber, and then sprinkle salt (if using) and black pepper. Garnish with chopped dill.
3. Top with the remaining slices of bread, hummus side down, to complete the sandwiches. Slice in half and serve immediately.

Tips: If you have extra time, chill the cucumber in advance to give the sandwich a refreshing crunch.

Serving size: 1 sandwich

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 320; Fat 19g; Carbs 27g; Protein 9g; Sodium 610mg; Sugar 4g; Fiber 6g

78. Quinoa Salad Stuffed Pita Pockets

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 3/4 cup quinoa, uncooked
- 1 large cucumber, diced
- 1/3 cup parsley, finely chopped
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Salt, to taste (optional)
- Black pepper, to taste
- 4 whole grain pita pockets

Directions:

1. Rinse quinoa under cold water and drain. In a saucepan, bring quinoa and 1 1/2 cups of water to a boil.
2. Reduce heat to low, cover, and simmer for 15 minutes or until quinoa is cooked through. Let it cool for a few minutes, then fluff with a fork.
3. In a large bowl, combine cooked quinoa with diced cucumber and parsley. Drizzle olive oil over the mixture and season with salt (if using) and pepper. Mix well.
4. Cut pita pockets in half to make four servings. Stuff each pita pocket with an equal amount of quinoa salad.

Tips: To make your quinoa extra-fluffy, let it sit covered for five minutes after it's done cooking before you fluff it with the fork.

Serving size: Half of one pita pocket stuffed

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 240; Fat 8g; Carbs 35g; Protein 8g; Sodium 330mg; Sugar 3g; Fiber 5g

79. Roast Beef and Arugula Sandwich

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1/2 lb. roast beef, thinly sliced
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard (ensure low acid content)
- 1 cup arugula leaves, fresh
- 4 slices whole-grain bread, toasted without butter

Directions:

1. Spread Dijon mustard evenly across each slice of bread. Layer half of the arugula leaves onto two slices of bread.
2. Add the roast beef slices on top of the arugula. Top with the remaining arugula leaves and finish with the other slice of bread on each sandwich.
3. Serve immediately or wrap for a to-go meal.

Tips: Look for whole-grain bread that is free of high-fat contents or added sugars which can trigger acid reflux.

Serving size: Half sandwich

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 320; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 24g; Protein: 41g; Sodium: 460mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 3g

80. Turkey and Cucumber Sandwich

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 8 slices whole-grain bread
- 1 lb. sliced turkey breast (low sodium)
- 1/2 cucumber, thinly sliced
- 1 tbsp Dijon mustard (optional)
- Salt & ground black pepper to taste (optional)
- Baby spinach leaves

Directions:

1. If using mustard, spread a thin layer of Dijon mustard on one side of each bread slice. Arrange the turkey slices evenly over four slices of bread.
2. Layer the cucumber slices on top of the turkey. Optionally season with salt and pepper if desired.
3. Add a layer of baby spinach leaves over the cucumber. Top with remaining bread slices to close each sandwich. Serve.

Tips: For added flavor without extra spices or spreads, look for herb-roasted turkey breast slices at your deli.

Serving size: One sandwich

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 360; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 42g; Protein: 36g; Sodium: 590mg; Sugar: 7g; Fiber: 6g

81. Tempeh Reuben with Sauerkraut

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 8 oz. tempeh, thinly sliced
- 1 tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 2 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- 4 slices whole-grain rye bread (acid reflux-friendly option)
- 1/2 cup sauerkraut, drained
- 2 tbsp low-fat Thousand Island dressing (ensure it's garlic/onion-free)
- Cucumber slices for garnish

Directions:

1. In a shallow dish, combine tempeh slices with apple cider vinegar and smoked paprika. Let marinate for at least 5 minutes.
2. Heat vegetable oil in a skillet over medium heat. Add marinated tempeh and cook for 3 minutes per side until browned on each side.
3. Toast the rye bread until crisp and golden. Spread a tablespoon of Thousand Island dressing on one side of each toasted bread slice.
4. Place tempeh slices on two bread slices, top with sauerkraut, and cover with remaining bread slices, dressing side down. Serve immediately, garnished with cucumber slices.

Tips: For additional flavor, you can add dill pickles or caraway seeds to the sandwich. If you're sensitive to store-bought dressings, make a simple acid reflux-friendly version at home.

Serving size: 1 assembled sandwich

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 380; Fat: 13g; Carbs: 44g; Protein: 22g; Sodium: 640mg; Sugar: 6g; Fiber: 7g

82. Balsamic Roasted Veggie on Baguette

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. mixed vegetables (zucchini, bell peppers, and carrots), chopped into bite-sized pieces
- 2 tbsp balsamic vinegar
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste (ensure moderate use for acid reflux)
- Whole-grain baguette, cut into four equal portions
- Fresh basil leaves for garnish

Directions:

1. Preheat oven to 400°F.
2. In a large bowl, toss chopped vegetables with balsamic vinegar, olive oil, salt, and pepper. Spread the vegetables out on a baking sheet in an even layer.
3. Roast for 20 -25 minutes. until vegetables are tender and slightly caramelized. Toast the baguette pieces lightly if desired.
4. Serve roasted veggies piled onto the pieces of baguette garnished with fresh basil leaves.

Tips: To add more protein to this dish without using high-fat dairy products or meat, consider sprinkling with nutritional yeast or adding chickpeas to roast alongside vegetables.

Serving size: 1 portion of roasted veggies on baguette

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 44g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 450mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 6g

Soups for Comfort and Care

83. Classic Chicken Wild Rice Soup

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 35 minutes

Servings: 6

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. skinless, boneless chicken breast
- 4 cups low-sodium chicken broth
- 1 cup wild rice, rinsed
- 3/4 cup chopped celery
- 3/4 cup chopped carrots
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 2 tbsp all-purpose flour
- 2 tbsp olive oil

Directions:

1. In a large soup pot, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add celery and carrots, then sauté for 5 minutes until slightly tender. Sprinkle flour over vegetables and stir to coat.
2. Add chicken broth, wild rice, and dried thyme, then let it boil. Reduce heat to a simmer.
3. Place the whole chicken breasts into the pot. Cover and simmer for 25 minutes or until the chicken is cooked through and rice is tender.
4. Remove chicken, shred it using two forks, then return to the pot. Stir well to combine. Simmer for an additional 5 minutes, then remove from heat.

Tips: To ensure an acid reflux-friendly meal, use low-sodium broth and avoid adding additional salt or seasonings that are high in acidity.

Serving size: 1 1/2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 27g; Sodium: 65mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 2g

84. Summer Squash and Basil Soup

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 lbs. summer squash, cubed
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 3/4 cup low-sodium vegetable broth
- 1/4 cup fresh basil leaves, torn
- 1 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 cup unsweetened almond milk

Directions:

1. In a large pot, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add the cubed summer squash and cook for 10 minutes until tender.
2. Add the vegetable broth, basil, salt, and black pepper. Bring to a simmer and cook for another 20 minutes.
3. Carefully transfer the mixture to a blender or use an immersion blender to puree until smooth. Return the soup to the pot, stir in the almond milk, and heat through. Serve hot.

Tips: For a creamier texture, you can add more almond milk to your preference. If you want a thinner soup, simply add more vegetable broth.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 110; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 11g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 390mg; Sugar: 6g; Fiber: 3g

85. Golden Beetroot Velouté

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 40 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. golden beets, peeled and diced
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 3 cups low-sodium vegetable stock
- Salt & pepper to taste
- A pinch of dried thyme

Directions:

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add the diced golden beets and sauté for 5 minutes until they start to soften.
2. Pour in the vegetable stock, add dried thyme, and bring to a boil. Reduce heat to low and simmer for 35 minutes or until beets are completely tender.
3. With an immersion blender or regular blender, puree the soup until very smooth. Season with salt and pepper, then serve.

Tips: Garnish with chopped herbs such as parsley or chives if desired. Ensure that the beets are fully cooked before blending to achieve a smooth velouté.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 130; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 380mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 4g

86. Creamy Oat Milk and Chive Soup

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 3 cups oat milk
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 cup fresh chives, chopped
- 2 cups vegetable broth, low sodium
- 3 tbsp all-purpose flour
- 1/2 tsp ground black pepper
- 1/2 lb. potatoes, peeled and diced

Directions:

1. In a large pot, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add the flour slowly, stirring continuously to make a roux. Gradually pour in the oat milk while still stirring to avoid lumps.
2. Add the vegetable broth and bring the mixture to a simmer. Put in the diced potatoes and cook for 15 minutes until they are soft.
3. Season with black pepper and add the chives. Blend the soup using an immersion blender until smooth and creamy. Serve hot.

Tips: If you prefer a thinner consistency, add more vegetable broth according to your preference. Ensure your oat milk is unsweetened to avoid extra sugar content.

Serving size: 1 bowl

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 230; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 34g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: 7g; Fiber: 3g

87. Sautéed Mushroom and Barley Soup

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 40 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1/2 lb. cremini mushrooms, sliced
- 3/4 cup pearl barley
- 4 cups vegetable broth, low sodium
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 2 cups water
- 1/2 tsp dried thyme
- Salt and pepper to taste (use minimal salt)

Directions:

1. In a large pot, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add mushrooms and sauté for 5 minutes until golden brown.
2. Stir in the barley and thyme, mix well with the mushrooms. Pour in vegetable broth and water; bring the mixture to a boil.
3. Reduce heat, cover, and simmer for about 30 minutes or until barley is tender. Season with a pinch of salt (if necessary) and pepper to taste. Serve warm.

Tips: To enhance flavor without added salt, consider adding fresh herbs such as parsley or dill before serving. Constantly check barley for doneness after simmering for about 25 minutes to avoid overcooking.

Serving size: 1 bowl

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 220; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 40g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 95mg; Sugar: 4g; Fiber: 8g

88. Ground Turkey and Barley Soup

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 6

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. ground turkey (93% lean)
- 4 cups low-sodium vegetable broth
- 3/4 cup pearled barley, rinsed
- 3/4 cup diced carrots
- 3/4 cup diced celery
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- Salt (optional and to taste)
- Fresh parsley for garnish (optional)

Directions:

1. In a large soup pot over medium heat, cook the ground turkey until no longer pink. Add diced carrots and celery to the pot, then sauté with turkey for 3 minutes.
2. Pour in vegetable broth and add pearled barley along with dried oregano. If desired, add salt to taste.
3. Bring the mixture to a boil, then reduce heat to maintain a gentle simmer. Cook uncovered for 20 minutes or until barley is tender. Garnish with fresh parsley if desired before serving.

Tips: Choosing lean ground turkey helps keep fat content in check. Additionally, opting for fresh herbs rather than dried ones can help enhance flavor without aggravating acid reflux.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 220; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 20g; Protein: 22g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 4g

89. Spinach and Potato Leek Soup

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. potatoes, peeled and diced
- 3 cups chopped leeks (white and light green parts only)
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 4 cups low-sodium vegetable broth
- 2 cups fresh spinach leaves, packed
- 1/2 tsp ground ginger
- 1 tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- Salt to taste (optional)

Directions:

1. In a large pot, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add the chopped leeks and cook for 3 minutes until tender.
2. Add the diced potatoes, ground ginger, and vegetable broth. Bring to a boil. Lower the heat, cover, and simmer for about 20 minutes or until the potatoes are soft.
3. Add the spinach and cook for another 2 minutes. Remove from heat. Using an immersion blender or a standard blender, puree the soup until smooth.
4. Return soup to the pot to reheat gently. Stir in the fresh dill and add salt to taste if desired.

Tips: Serve with a dollop of low-fat Greek yogurt for added creaminess without the fat content of regular dairy products. For a thinner soup, add an extra half cup of vegetable broth.

Serving size: 1 1/2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 30g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 5g

90. Zucchini and Asparagus Minestrone

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1/2 lb. fresh asparagus, chopped
- 1 large zucchini, diced
- 3 cups vegetable broth
- 1 cup water
- 1/2 cup carrot, diced
- 1/2 tsp dried basil
- 1/2 cup spinach leaves, chopped
- Salt to taste

Directions:

1. In a large pot over medium heat, combine the vegetable broth and water. Bring to a simmer. Add in the carrots and cook for about 3 minutes.
2. Stir in the diced zucchini, asparagus, and dried basil. Simmer for an additional 12 minutes. Once the vegetables are tender, add the chopped spinach leaves and salt to taste.
3. Let it cook for another 2 minutes or until the spinach is wilted. Serve.

Tips: Serve hot with a side of toasted whole-grain bread if tolerated. You can also sprinkle grated Parmesan cheese on top if dairy is tolerated.

Serving size: 1 1/2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 68; Fat: 0.6g; Carbs: 13g; Protein: 3.4g; Sodium: 48mg; Sugar: 4g; Fiber: 4.2g

91. Kale & White Bean Stew with Rosemary

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 3 cups kale leaves, stripped from stem and torn
- 1 (15 oz.) can white beans, drained and rinsed
- 3 cups low-sodium vegetable broth
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp fresh rosemary, minced
- Salt to taste
- 1 tsp black pepper

Directions:

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add fresh rosemary to the pot and sauté for about a minute until aromatic. Pour in the vegetable broth and bring to a boil.
2. Mix in the kale leaves, reduce heat to low, cover, and allow it to simmer for 10 minutes until leaves are tender.
3. Stir in white beans, salt, and black pepper; cook until everything is heated through. Serve.

Tips: The longer it simmers on low heat, the better the flavors will develop. Avoid cooking at high temperatures as it may cause some ingredients to break down and could contribute to acid reflux symptoms.

Serving size: 2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 203; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 35g; Protein: 13g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 0.6g; Fiber 6g

92. Broccoli and Pear Soup with Tarragon

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. broccoli florets
- 2 ripe pears, cored and chopped
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 3 cups low-sodium vegetable broth
- 1/4 tsp ground nutmeg
- Salt to taste (optional)
- Fresh tarragon leaves, finely chopped

Directions:

1. In a large pot, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add broccoli florets and pears, then cook for 5 minutes until broccoli is bright green.
2. Pour in the vegetable broth and bring to a simmer. Add nutmeg, cover pot with a lid slightly ajar and simmer for 15 minutes until broccoli is tender.
3. Blend the soup with an immersion blender or transfer contents carefully into a blender to puree until smooth.
4. Reheat gently if necessary after blending. Garnish with freshly chopped tarragon leaves before serving.

Tips: If you like your soup on the sweeter side, make sure to use very ripe pears. Always start blending on low speed to avoid splashes and ensure smooth textures.

Serving size: 1 1/2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 165; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 30g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 16g; Fiber: 6g

CHAPTER 7

Friendly Dinners Main Courses

Stress-Free Lean Poultry Recipes

93. Herbed Turkey Breast with Carrots

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 45 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. turkey breast, boneless and skinless
- 2 cups of carrots, sliced
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 1 tsp dried rosemary
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1/4 tsp salt

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F. Rub the turkey breast with olive oil, thyme, rosemary, pepper, and salt. Place the seasoned turkey breast in a roasting pan.
2. Arrange the sliced carrots around the turkey in the pan. Roast for approximately 45 minutes, or until the turkey breast is cooked through.
3. Let it rest for a few minutes before slicing.

Tips: To keep this dish acid reflux-friendly, avoid using garlic or onions. Instead, boost flavor with herbs.

Serving size: 4 oz of turkey with half a cup of carrots

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 230; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 30g; Sodium: 200mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 3g

94. Lemon-Zest-Free Turkey Piccata

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. turkey breast cutlets, thinly sliced
- 1/2 cup all-purpose flour (for dredging)
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 cup chicken broth, low sodium
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- Salt & black pepper to taste

Directions:

1. Season the turkey cutlets lightly with salt and pepper. Dredge cutlets in flour to coat both sides and shake off excess.
2. Heat olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Add turkey cutlets and cook for 3 minutes per side until golden brown on both sides and cooked through.
3. Remove cutlets from skillet and keep warm. Pour chicken broth into the skillet, bringing it to a boil while scraping up any browned bits from the bottom of the skillet.
4. Simmer until it has reduced by half and thickened slightly. Return the cutlets to the skillet and cook for an additional minute on each side to reheat.
5. Garnish with chopped parsley before serving.

Tips: Using chicken broth instead of lemon juice offers a safe acidity level suitable for an acid reflux diet.

Serving size: 1 cooked cutlet with sauce

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 210; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 25g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 3g

95. Smoked Paprika Chicken Breasts over Brown Rice

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts
- 1 tbsp smoked paprika
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 cup uncooked brown rice
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 2 cups low-sodium chicken broth
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp fresh parsley for garnish (optional)

Directions:

1. In a small bowl, mix the smoked paprika, thyme, black pepper, and 1 tbsp of olive oil to create a marinade. Rub the marinade evenly over the chicken breasts and let sit for at least 10 minutes.
2. In a medium pot, bring the low-sodium chicken broth to a boil. Add the brown rice and return to boil. Reduce heat to low, cover, and simmer for 45 minutes or until rice is tender.
3. Meanwhile, heat the remaining tablespoon of olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat.
4. Add the marinated chicken breasts to the skillet and cook for 6 minutes per side or until cooked through and no longer pink in the center.
5. Once cooked, remove from heat and let the chicken rest for a few minutes before slicing it. Fluff the cooked brown rice with a fork and serve the sliced chicken breasts on top of it.
6. Garnish with chopped fresh parsley if desired.

Tips: For better digestion and less acidity, ensure that your chicken is thoroughly cooked but still moist. Letting it rest after cooking allows juices to redistribute which can aid in tenderness.

Serving size: 1 chicken breast with 3/4 cup of cooked brown rice

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 370; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 39g; Protein: 29g; Sodium: 95mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 3g

96. Baked Chicken with Capers

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 boneless skinless chicken breasts (about 1 lb.)
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp dried thyme
- 1/4 cup capers, rinsed
- 1/2 tsp ground black pepper
- 1/2 cup low-sodium chicken broth

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F. Rub the chicken breasts with olive oil and season with black pepper and thyme.
2. Place chicken in a baking dish and sprinkle capers over the top. Pour the chicken broth around the breasts in the dish.
3. Bake for 25 minutes or until the chicken is cooked through and juices run clear.

Tips: Ensure that your capers are well-rinsed to remove excess salt.

Serving size: 1 chicken breast

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 220; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 1g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 320mg; Sugar: 0.5g; Fiber: 0.5g

97. Balsamic Vinegar Marinated Chicken Drumsticks

Preparation time: 20 minutes + marinating time

Cooking time: 45 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 8 chicken drumsticks (about 2 lbs.)
- 1/4 cup balsamic vinegar
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 1 tsp dried rosemary
- 1/2 tsp paprika (mild)

Directions:

In a large bowl combine balsamic vinegar, olive oil, rosemary, paprika, salt, and pepper.

Add chicken drumsticks to the bowl and toss to coat. Cover and refrigerate to marinate for at least one hour.

Preheat your oven to 400°F. Arrange drumsticks in a baking dish. Bake for 45 minutes or until chicken is cooked through. Serve.

Tips: Marinate chicken overnight for deeper flavor without added irritants.

Serving size: 2 drumsticks

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 450; Fat: 25g; Carbs: 0g; Protein: 50g; Sodium: 198mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 0g

98. Chicken Skewers with Bell Peppers and Zucchini

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. chicken breast, cut into cubes
- 1 cup bell peppers, assorted colors, cut into 1-inch pieces
- 1 cup zucchini, sliced into ½-inch rounds
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- Salt and pepper to taste

Directions:

1. Preheat your grill to medium-high heat. Thread the chicken, bell peppers, and zucchini onto skewers.
2. Brush the skewers with olive oil and then sprinkle with oregano, salt, and pepper. Grill for 5 minutes on each side until the chicken is cooked through.

Tips: Soak wooden skewers in water for at least 30 minutes before using to prevent burning.

Serving size: 2 skewers

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 2g

99. Herb-Crusted Turkey Tenderloin with Asparagus

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. turkey tenderloin
- 2 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 2 tsp dried thyme
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 lb. asparagus, trimmed

Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F. In a small bowl, mix parsley, thyme, salt, and pepper.
2. Rub the turkey tenderloin with half the olive oil and coat it with the herb mixture. In an oven-proof skillet over medium heat, sear the tenderloin on all sides until golden brown.
3. Remove, add asparagus around the turkey tenderloin in the skillet, drizzle with remaining olive oil, and place in the oven.
4. Roast for 25 minutes or until the turkey reaches an internal temperature of 165°F.

Tips: Let the turkey rest for a few minutes after cooking before slicing for juicier meat.

Serving size: 3 slices of turkey and a portion of asparagus

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 310; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 5g; Protein: 44g; Sodium: 65mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 3g

100. Cinnamon-Ginger Chicken Stew

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 40 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. chicken breast, cut into chunks
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 2 cups carrots, chopped
- 2 cups low-sodium chicken broth
- 1 cup water
- 2 tsp ground ginger
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon

Directions:

1. In a large pot, heat the olive oil over medium heat. Add the chicken chunks and cook until lightly browned on all sides.
2. Add the carrots to the pot and sauté for 5 minutes, or until they start to soften. Pour in the chicken broth and water, then add the ground ginger and cinnamon.
3. Let it boil, reduce heat to low, cover, and let simmer for 30 minutes. Serve.

Tips: To enhance flavor without salt, add fresh herbs like basil or thyme just before serving.

Serving size: 1 1/2 cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 240; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 34g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 3g

101. Maple Glazed Turkey Breast with Steamed Broccoli

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 60 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. turkey breast
- 1 tbsp maple syrup
- 1/2 tsp ground black pepper
- 2 cups broccoli florets
- Salt to taste (optional)

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. Place the turkey breast in a baking dish and brush it with maple syrup, then sprinkle with black pepper.
2. Cover with aluminum foil and bake for 1 hour or until cooked through.
3. Ten minutes before turkey is done, steam broccoli florets in a steamer or in the microwave until tender. Serve it with the turkey.

Tips: Glazing with maple syrup towards the end of cooking can prevent excessive browning.

Serving size: 1 slice of turkey with 1/2 cup of steamed broccoli

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 210; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 85mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 2g

102. Turkey Medallions with Mushroom Herb Sauce

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. turkey breast cutlets
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 cup mushrooms, sliced
- 1/2 tsp dried rosemary
- 1/2 tsp dried basil
- Salt and ground black pepper to taste
- 3/4 cup low-sodium vegetable broth

Directions:

1. Season turkey cutlets with salt and pepper. Heat olive oil over medium heat in a skillet.
2. Add turkey cutlets and cook until browned on both sides and no longer pink in the center. Remove turkey from skillet and set aside.
3. In the same skillet, add mushrooms and sauté until they begin to soften. Add rosemary, basil, and vegetable broth to the skillet. Simmer until sauce thickens slightly.
4. Return turkey to skillet with sauce and heat through.

Tips: Thicken sauce with a tablespoon of cornstarch dissolved in water if desired.

Serving size: 2 medallions

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 240; Fat:5g; Carbs:3g; Protein:40g; Sodium: 400mg; Sugar: 1g; Fiber: 1g

Seafood Selections for a Happy Stomach

103. Herbed Tilapia with Quinoa

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 tilapia fillets (about 1 lb.)
- 2 cups quinoa, rinsed
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp dried basil
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 4 cups water

Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F. In a medium saucepan, bring the quinoa and water to a boil. Reduce the heat to low, cover, and simmer for 15 minutes or until all water is absorbed.
2. Meanwhile, mix olive oil with dried basil, thyme, salt, and pepper in a small bowl. Place tilapia fillets on a lined baking sheet and brush each fillet with the herbed oil mixture.
3. Bake for 10-12 minutes or until fish flakes easily with a fork. Fluff the quinoa with a fork after cooking and serve alongside the herbed tilapia.

Tips: Ensure your herbs are fresh or within their 'use by' date for maximum flavor without irritation.

Serving size: 1 fillet with 1/2 cup cooked quinoa

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 380; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 35g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 85mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 3g

104. Walnut-Crusted Halibut with Spinach

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 (4 oz each) halibut filets
- 1/2 cup chopped walnuts
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 4 cups baby spinach leaves
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 1/2 tsp dried basil
- 1 tbsp grated Parmesan cheese (optional)

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F. Lightly season the halibut filets with a pinch of salt and pepper. Mix the chopped walnuts, dried basil, and grated Parmesan cheese (if using) in a shallow dish.
2. Brush each filet with olive oil and press into the walnut mixture to coat evenly on all sides. Place coated filets onto a baking sheet and bake for 12-15 minutes or until fish flakes easily.
3. Meanwhile, sauté the spinach in the remaining olive oil over medium heat until wilted. Serve halibut over a bed of sautéed spinach.

Tips: To ensure this dish remains reflux-friendly, avoid over-seasoning.

Serving size: 1 filet with 1 cup of cooked spinach

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 290; Fat: 20g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 24g; Sodium: 100mg; Sugar: <1g; Fiber: 2g

105. Blackened Catfish with Celery Root Slaw

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 (6 oz. each) catfish fillets
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1/2 tsp dried thyme
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 2 cups shredded celery root
- 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- 3 tbsp low-fat Greek yogurt
- Salt to taste

Directions:

1. In a small bowl, mix smoked paprika, thyme, black pepper, and salt. Rub the mixture onto both sides of the catfish fillets.
2. Heat olive oil in a non-stick skillet over medium heat. Place catfish fillets in the skillet and cook for 5 minutes on each side or until the fish flakes easily.
3. For the slaw, mix shredded celery root with Greek yogurt, apple cider vinegar, and a pinch of salt. Toss well to combine.
4. Serve blackened catfish hot with a side of celery root slaw.

Tips: Ensure your spices are fresh for the best flavor. Do not overcook the fish as it should be moist inside with a crusty exterior.

Serving size: 1 fillet with slaw

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 9g; Protein: 34g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 2g

106. Grilled Sardines over Mediterranean Salad

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 6 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 8 fresh sardines, cleaned and gutted
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Salt and black pepper to taste
- 6 cups mixed salad greens (lettuce, kale, arugula)
- 1 cup cucumber, sliced into half-moons
- 1 cup red bell pepper, sliced thinly into strips
- 1/4 cup kalamata olives, pitted and halved

Directions:

1. Preheat your grill on high heat. Brush sardines with olive oil and season lightly with salt and black pepper.
2. Grill sardines for 3 minutes on each side or until cooked thoroughly and char marks appear.
3. Meanwhile, assemble salad by combining mixed greens, cucumber slices, red bell pepper strips, and Kalamata olives in a large bowl.
4. Divide the salad among plates and top each with two grilled sardines.

Tips: You may line your grill with aluminum foil for easier cooking and clean-up of sardines. Make sure all fish bones are removed prior to serving.

Serving size: 2 sardines over salad

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 300; Fat: 15g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 22g; Sodium: 320mg; Sugar: 4g; Fiber: 3g

107. Poached Haddock in Light Dill Sauce

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 (6 oz each) haddock fillets
- 2 cups low-fat milk
- 1 tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- 1/2 tsp ground black pepper
- 1 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 tbsp cold water
- 2 tbsp parsley, chopped (for garnish)

Directions:

1. In a large skillet over medium heat, pour the milk and add the black pepper. When the milk is hot but not boiling, gently add the haddock fillets. Ensure that they are submerged.
2. Simmer for about 10 minutes, or until the haddock flakes easily with a fork.
3. In a small bowl, mix cornstarch with cold water until smooth. Stir the cornstarch mixture and chopped dill into the skillet to thicken the sauce. Cook for another 2 minutes.
4. Carefully remove the haddock and place on serving plates. Spoon some dill sauce over each fillet. Garnish with chopped parsley before serving.

Tips: Avoid boiling the milk to prevent curdling, and ensure a delicate poach on the fish.

Serving size: 1 fillet with sauce

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 190; Fat 2g; Carbs 5g; Protein 37g; Sodium 135mg; Sugar 3g; Fiber 0g

108. Broiled Lobster Tail with Paprika Rub

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 (8 oz. each) lobster tails, split open in shell
- 1 tsp paprika
- 1/4 tsp ground black pepper
- 1/4 tsp dried thyme
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Fresh parsley, chopped (for garnish)

Directions:

1. Preheat your broiler to high and adjust rack to the top shelf. In a small bowl, mix together paprika, black pepper, and thyme.
2. Brush each lobster tail with olive oil, then rub the spice mixture over the flesh of the lobster tail. Place lobster tails on a broiling pan cut-side up.
3. Broil for 8–10 minutes or until meat is opaque and lightly brown on top. Garnish with fresh parsley before serving.

Tips: Ensure your broiler is fully preheated for even cooking of the lobster tails.

Serving size: 1 lobster tail

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 210; Fat 9g; Carbs 1g; Protein 28g; Sodium 230mg; Sugar 0g; Fiber 0g

109. Ginger-Infused Grilled Salmon

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 (6 oz. each) salmon fillets
- 2 tbsp fresh ginger, minced
- 1/4 cup low-sodium soy sauce
- 2 tbsp brown sugar
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp ground black pepper

Directions:

1. In a mixing bowl, whisk together minced ginger, low-sodium soy sauce, brown sugar, olive oil, and black pepper.
2. Place the salmon fillets in a shallow dish and pour the marinade over them, coating evenly. Cover and let marinate in the refrigerator for at least 30 minutes.
3. Preheat grill to medium-high heat. Remove salmon from the marinade and place on grill. Grill for about 5 minutes on each side or until salmon is cooked through and flakes easily.

Tips: Do not overcook the salmon to avoid dryness. Serve with grilled vegetables or a side salad to complement the flavors.

Serving size: 1 fillet

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 280; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 34g; Sodium: 480mg; Sugar: 4g; Fiber: 0g

110. Seared Scallops with Brown Rice Pilaf

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. sea scallops, muscle removed
- 1 cup brown rice, rinsed
- 2 cups water
- 1 tbsp fresh thyme leaves
- Zest of one lemon (ensure it's mild and not very acidic)
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Salt & ground black pepper to taste

Directions:

1. To prepare the brown rice pilaf, bring water to a boil in a saucepan. Add the brown rice, salt to taste, and half of the thyme leaves. Reduce heat to low, cover, and simmer for 45 minutes until the rice is tender.
2. Meanwhile, pat dry scallops with paper towels and season lightly with salt and black pepper.
3. Heat olive oil in a pan over medium-high heat. Once hot, sear scallops for about one to one-and-a-half minutes on each side until they have a golden crust.
4. When rice is done, fluff it with a fork, mix in lemon zest and remaining thyme leaves. Serve scallops over the herbed brown rice pilaf.

Tips: Careful not to overcook scallops as they will become tough. For additional flavor without acid reflux triggers, you can sprinkle dried herbs over your dish.

Serving size: 4 scallops with 1/2 cup cooked rice pilaf

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 260, Fat: 7g, Carbs: 30g, Protein: 22g, Sodium: 484mg, Sugar: Less than 1g, Fiber: 2g

111. Steamed Clams with Fresh Parsley

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 lbs. fresh clams, scrubbed clean
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 cup water
- 1/4 cup fresh parsley, finely chopped
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- Pinch of sea salt (optional)

Directions:

1. In a large skillet, heat olive oil over medium heat. Add clams and water to the skillet.
2. Cover with a lid and let it steam for 5 minutes until clams open. Discard any unopened clams.
3. Sprinkle with fresh parsley, black pepper, and a pinch of sea salt (if using).

Tips: Ensure clams are fresh and properly cleaned prior to cooking. For extra flavor, steam the clams in low-sodium vegetable broth instead of water.

Serving size: 8 clams

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 126; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 4g; Protein: 18g; Sodium: 96mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 0g

112. Baked Cod with Sweet Potato Mash

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 (6 oz. each) cod fillets
- 2 medium sweet potatoes, peeled and cubed
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- Pinch of sea salt (optional)
- Fresh herbs (like thyme or rosemary), finely chopped for garnish (optional)

Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F. Arrange cod fillets on a baking tray lined with parchment paper. Brush each fillet with olive oil and season with pepper. Add a pinch of sea salt if desired.
2. Bake for 15 minutes or until fish flakes easily. Meanwhile, boil sweet potatoes in water for 10 minutes until tender.
3. Drain sweet potatoes and mash with a fork or potato masher until smooth. Serve baked cod over a bed of sweet potato mash and garnish with fresh herbs if desired.

Tips: For added creaminess to the sweet potato mash without dairy, stir in some unsweetened almond milk to desired texture.

Serving size: One cod fillet with about half a cup of sweet potato mash.

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 258; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 20g; Protein: 35g; Sodium: 101mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 3g

Plant-Based Mains That Won't Cause Discomfort

113. Baked Butternut Squash Risotto

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup Arborio rice
- 4 cups vegetable broth, low sodium
- 2 cups butternut squash, cubed
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/2 cup peas, fresh or frozen
- 1 tbsp nutritional yeast

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 375°F. In a baking dish, combine the Arborio rice and vegetable broth; stir well.
2. Toss the cubed butternut squash with olive oil and salt, then scatter over the top of the rice mixture.
3. Cover the dish with foil and bake for 30 minutes or until most liquid is absorbed and rice is al dente.
4. Stir in peas and nutritional yeast during the last five minutes of cooking. Remove, let it sit covered for a couple of minutes before serving.

Tips: For extra creaminess, you may add in a splash of almond milk when stirring in peas. If butternut squash is not available, you can substitute it with sweet potatoes.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 280; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 57g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 200mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 5g

114. Lentil Sweet Potato Stew

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups vegetable broth (low sodium)
- 1 cup dried green lentils, rinsed
- 2 medium sweet potatoes, peeled and diced
- 1 cup chopped kale
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp ground cumin

Directions:

1. In a large pot, heat the olive oil over medium heat. Add the diced sweet potatoes and sauté for 5 minutes until slightly tender.
2. Stir in ground cumin and cook for another minute. Add the lentils and vegetable broth, then let it boil.
3. Reduce heat, cover, and simmer for 20 minutes or until lentils are soft. Stir in chopped kale and cook for another 5 minutes. Remove and let it sit for a few minutes before serving.

Tips: Use pre-cut sweet potatoes to save on preparation time. Adjust consistency with additional broth if stew is too thick upon standing.

Serving size: 1½ cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 42g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 10g

115. Roasted Cauliflower Steak with Herbs

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 large head cauliflower
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp paprika
- 1 tbsp fresh thyme leaves
- Salt and pepper to taste

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F. Remove the outer leaves of the cauliflower and cut it into 1-inch thick slices.
2. Brush each slice of cauliflower steak with olive oil on both sides. Season with paprika, thyme, salt, and pepper.
3. Place the cauliflower steaks on a lined baking sheet. Roast for 25 minutes or until tender and golden brown, flipping halfway through.

Tips: Ensure steaks are similar in thickness for even cooking. Serve with a side of green salad or steamed vegetables for a complete meal.

Serving size: 1 steak

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 107; Fat 7g; Carbs 10g; Protein 4g; Sodium 30mg; Sugar 3g; Fiber 3g

116. Vegan Shepherd's Pie with Lentils

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 40 minutes

Servings: 6

Ingredients:

- 1 cup dry green lentils
- 2 cups vegetable broth
- 3 cups mashed potatoes (prepared without dairy)
- 1 cup frozen mixed vegetables (peas, carrots, corn)
- 2 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. In a medium pot, add lentils and vegetable broth, bring to boil and simmer for 20 minutes until lentils are tender but still firm. Drain excess liquid from lentils if necessary.
2. In an oven-safe dish, layer cooked lentils at the bottom. Evenly spread the frozen mixed vegetables over the lentils.
3. Top with an even layer of mashed potatoes. Drizzle olive oil over the mashed potato layer and lightly season with salt and pepper.
4. Bake for 20 minutes or until top is slightly golden brown. Garnish with fresh parsley if desired before serving.

Tips: To add more flavor to mashed potatoes, mix in a splash of unsweetened almond milk and a pinch of nutritional yeast.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 350; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 60g; Protein: 18g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 11g

117. Chickpea Spinach Curry

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups canned chickpeas, rinsed and drained
- 4 cups fresh spinach leaves
- 1 cup coconut milk
- 1 tbsp curry powder
- 1 tsp cumin
- 1/2 tsp coriander
- Salt to taste

Directions:

1. In a large skillet, heat the curry powder, cumin, and coriander over medium heat for two minutes. Add the chickpeas and coconut milk, stirring well to combine with the spices.
2. Bring the mixture to a boil, then reduce heat and simmer for 10 minutes. Add the fresh spinach leaves and continue to simmer for 5 minutes until the spinach wilts.
3. Season with salt to taste, stir well, and remove from heat.

Tips: If you prefer a thinner curry sauce, add more coconut milk or water until desired consistency is reached.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: <1g; Fiber: 6g

118. Caramelized Root Vegetables Over Polenta

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 35 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups polenta, dry
- 4 cups water or low-sodium vegetable broth (for cooking polenta)
- Salt to taste (for polenta)
- 2 cups mixed root vegetables (carrots, parsnips), peeled and chopped into bite-sized pieces
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp balsamic vinegar

Directions:

1. Prepare the polenta according to package instructions using water or low-sodium vegetable broth. Once cooked, keep it warm and set aside.
2. Preheat your oven to 400°F. Toss the root vegetables with olive oil and balsamic vinegar in a bowl.
3. Spread the vegetables evenly on a lined baking sheet, ensuring they are not overcrowded.
4. Roast for 30 minutes or until they are tender and caramelized, stirring occasionally.
5. To serve, spoon the warm polenta onto plates and top with equal portions of caramelized root vegetables.

Tips: Ensure that all vegetables are about the same size for even cooking.

Serving size: 3/4 cup cooked polenta with veggies

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 41g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 1g; Fiber: 6g

119. Brown Rice Stuffed Bell Peppers

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 bell peppers, tops cut off and seeds removed
- 2 cups cooked brown rice
- 1 cup black beans, drained and rinsed
- 1 cup corn kernels
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- Salt to taste

Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. In a bowl, combine cooked brown rice, black beans, corn kernels, olive oil, ground cumin, and salt.
2. Fill each bell pepper with the rice mixture and place in a baking dish. Cover with foil and bake for about 30 minutes until the peppers are tender.

Tips: For additional flavor, you may use herbs like parsley or cilantro.

Serving size: 1 stuffed bell pepper

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 38g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 70mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 6g

120. Kale, White Bean, and Potato Casserole

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 35 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups chopped kale, stems removed
- 1 cup canned white beans, drained and rinsed
- 2 cups diced potatoes
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Salt & pepper to taste
- Sprinkle of rosemary (optional)

Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F.
2. In a large bowl, toss together kale, white beans, diced potatoes with olive oil. Season with salt (and pepper and rosemary if using). Transfer them to a baking dish.
3. Cover the dish with foil and bake for about half an hour or until potatoes are tender. If desired, uncover and broil for 5 minutes for a crispy top.

Tips: Customize your casserole by adding your favorite acid reflux-friendly vegetables like spinach or zucchini.

Serving size: 1/4 of casserole

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250, Fat: 3g, Carbs: 45g, Protein: 10g, Sodium: 200mg, Sugar: 2g, Fiber: 9g

121. Zucchini Noodle Pesto Primavera

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 large zucchini, spiralized
- 1 cup fresh spinach
- 1/2 cup peas, frozen or fresh
- 2 tbsp pine nuts
- 1/4 cup basil leaves
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper

Directions:

1. In a large pan, heat olive oil over medium heat.
2. Add the spinach and peas, then cook for 3 minutes until the spinach is wilted and peas are heated through.
3. Stir in the zucchini noodles (zoodles), pine nuts, salt, and pepper. Cook for an additional 2 minutes. Toss the zoodles with fresh basil leaves and serve immediately.

Tips: For additional texture, toast the pine nuts before adding them to the dish. Make sure not to overcook the zoodles to prevent them from becoming soggy.

Serving size: Half of the total recipe

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 190; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 4g

122. Creamy Avocado Pasta with Peas

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 ripe avocados, pitted and peeled
- 3/4 cup plain Greek yogurt
- 1/2 cup water
- 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 tsp salt
- 12 oz whole wheat spaghetti
- 1 cup peas (fresh or frozen)

Directions:

1. Cook the whole wheat spaghetti according to package instructions. Add peas in the last 3 minutes of cooking. Drain and reserve half a cup of pasta water.
2. Meanwhile, blend the avocados, Greek yogurt, water, salt, and pepper until smooth. Toss avocado sauce with hot pasta and peas. Add reserved pasta water if sauce is too thick. Serve immediately.

Tips: Serve the dish immediately after tossing to prevent the avocado sauce from browning.

Serving size: 1½ cups

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 485; Fat: 21g; Carbs: 67g; Protein: 17g; Sodium: 462mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 11g

CHAPTER 8

Sides and Accompaniments

Vegetable Side Dishes

123. Steamed Broccoli with Toasted Almonds

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. fresh broccoli florets
- 1/2 cup slivered almonds
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Directions:

1. Begin by steaming the broccoli florets in a steamer basket over a pot of boiling water for about 3-4 minutes until tender but still crisp.
2. Meanwhile, heat olive oil in a small skillet over medium heat and add the slivered almonds, toasting them for 2 to 3 minutes until they are golden brown. Watch carefully to prevent burning.
3. Once the broccoli is done, transfer it to a serving dish, sprinkle with toasted almonds, salt, and pepper. Toss gently to combine and serve warm.

Tips: To maximize freshness, steam the broccoli just before serving and sprinkle almonds on top at the last minute.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 4g

124. Sautéed Spinach with Pine Nuts

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. fresh spinach leaves
- 2 tbsp pine nuts
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Salt to taste (optional)

Directions:

1. In a large skillet, heat the olive oil over medium heat. Add pine nuts and cook them until they are lightly toasted for 1 minute.
2. Add fresh spinach to the skillet in batches if necessary, allowing each batch to wilt before adding more.
3. Cook for 3 minutes until spinach is fully wilted but still bright green. Season with salt if desired. Transfer to a serving dish and serve hot.

Tips: Toast pine nuts gently as they burn quickly; remove them from the skillet before wilting spinach if necessary to avoid burning.

Serving size: 3/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 12g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 80mg; Sugar <1g; Fiber: 3g

125. Zucchini Ribbons Tossed in Basil Pesto

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 medium zucchinis
- 1 cup fresh basil leaves
- 2 tbsp grated Parmesan cheese (low-fat)
- 3 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 2 tbsp walnuts
- Salt (to taste)

Directions:

1. Use a vegetable peeler to create long ribbons of zucchini.
2. In a food processor, blend basil leaves, Parmesan cheese, olive oil, walnuts, and a pinch of salt until smooth to create the pesto.
3. Toss the zucchini ribbons with the pesto in a large bowl until evenly coated. Serve immediately or chill for later.

Tips: For best results, use young, firm zucchinis and toss them with the pesto just before serving to prevent them from becoming soggy.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 190; Fat: 16g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 115mg; Sugar: 4g; Fiber: 2g

126. Cauliflower Rice Pilaf with Herbs

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 medium head of cauliflower (1 lb.)
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 3 tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- 2 tbsp chopped fresh cilantro
- Salt to taste

Directions:

1. Wash and core the cauliflower, then pulse in a food processor until it resembles rice grains. Heat olive oil in a skillet over medium heat and add cauliflower ‘rice’.
2. Cook for about 10 minutes, stirring occasionally until tender. Remove from heat, stir in chopped parsley and cilantro, and season with salt. Fluff with a fork before serving.

Tips: The trick to great cauliflower rice is not overcooking it – it should be fluffy, not mushy.

Serving size: 3/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 45mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 3g

127. Ginger Glazed Baby Bok Choy

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. baby bok choy, trimmed and washed

- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp ginger root, freshly grated
- 2 tbsp maple syrup
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper, freshly ground
- A pinch of crushed red pepper flakes (optional)

Directions:

1. In a large skillet over medium heat, warm the olive oil. Add the grated ginger root and sauté for about 30 seconds until fragrant.
2. Place baby bok choy into the skillet in one layer. Drizzle with maple syrup, then sprinkle with salt and black pepper.
3. Cover and cook for about 3 minutes until the bok choy is tender and glazed.
4. If desired, add a pinch of crushed red pepper flakes for a mild kick without making it too spicy. Gently toss to combine flavors and serve immediately.

Tips: For more tender bok choy, steam before glazing for about 2–3 minutes. Use pure maple syrup as some brands may contain high acid additives or artificial flavors.

Serving size: 4 oz. of cooked baby bok choy

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 110; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 11g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 190mg; Sugar: 6g; Fiber: 1g

128. Maple-Glazed Butternut Squash

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. butternut squash, peeled and cut into cubes
- 2 tbsp coconut oil
- Salt & black pepper to taste

- 3 tbsp pure maple syrup
- A pinch of ground cinnamon

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F. Spread the cubed butternut squash on a lined baking sheet. Melt coconut oil and pour over the squash.
2. Season with salt and black pepper, toss to coat evenly. Roast in the oven for 20 minutes until almost tender.
3. Remove from oven and drizzle with pure maple syrup, then sprinkle a pinch of ground cinnamon over the top.
4. Return to the oven and roast for an additional 5 minutes or until fully tender and glazed.

Tips: Cutting squash into uniform pieces ensures even cooking. To ease cutting, microwave the whole butternut squash for about two minutes before peeling.

Serving size: 4 oz. of cooked butternut squash

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 130; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 270mg; Sugar: 10g; Fiber: 3g

129. Roasted Carrots and Parsnips with Thyme

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 medium carrots, peeled and cut into 2-inch pieces
- 4 medium parsnips, peeled and cut into 2-inch pieces
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 425°F. In a large bowl, toss the carrots, parsnips, olive oil, thyme, salt, and pepper until well coated.
2. Spread the vegetables on a baking sheet. Roast for about 25 minutes, stirring halfway through, until vegetables are tender and golden brown.

Tips: For even roasting, cut the vegetables into uniform sizes. If fresh thyme is available, use 1 tbsp chopped fresh thyme instead of dried.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 160; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 24g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 200mg; Sugar: 7g; Fiber: 6g

130. Baked Sweet Potato Wedges with Rosemary

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 35 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 3 large sweet potatoes, scrubbed and cut into wedges (about 2 lbs.)
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp dried rosemary (or fresh if available)
- 1/4 tsp salt
- Ground black pepper to taste

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 425°F. Place sweet potato wedges in a large bowl. Drizzle with olive oil and sprinkle with rosemary, salt, and pepper. Toss to coat evenly.
2. Arrange the wedges on a baking sheet. Bake for 35 minutes or until golden brown and crispy on the edges.

Tips: For extra crispness, let the sweet potato wedges soak in cold water for an hour before drying and coating them with oil and seasonings.

Serving size: 6 wedges

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 162 kcal, Fat: 7g, Carbs: 23g, Protein: 2g, Sodium: 160mg, Sugar: 5g, Fiber: 3g

131. Sautéed Green Beans with Slivered Almonds

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. fresh green beans, ends trimmed
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 cup slivered almonds
- 1/2 tsp salt (optional)
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped (for garnish)

Directions:

1. Blanch the green beans in boiling water for 3 minutes. Drain and set aside. Heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the slivered almonds to the skillet and toast for 2 minutes until golden brown, stirring occasionally.
3. Add the blanched green beans to the skillet. Season with salt (if using) and black pepper. Sauté for about 5 minutes or until the green beans are tender-crisp.
4. Garnish with fresh parsley before serving.

Tips: For variation, add a sprinkle of lemon zest for flavor if it does not trigger acid reflux symptoms. Make sure not to overcook the green beans; they should remain vibrant and slightly crunchy.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 30mg (without added salt); Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 4g

132. Mashed Parsnips with Nutmeg and Chives

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. parsnips, peeled and chopped into chunks
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter (or butter substitute for lower fat options)
- 1/4 cup low-fat milk or unsweetened almond milk
- Pinch of nutmeg
- Salt & black pepper to taste (optional)
- Fresh chives, finely chopped, for garnish

Directions:

1. Place chopped parsnips into a large pot of boiling water. Reduce heat and simmer for 15 to 20 minutes until parsnips are tender.
2. Drain parsnips and return them to the pot or move them to a mixing bowl. Add in butter, milk, nutmeg, salt (if using), and black pepper.
3. Mash parsnips thoroughly until smooth. Once mashed to desired consistency, transfer to a serving bowl. Garnish with freshly chopped chives before serving.

Tips: Parsnips have a naturally sweet flavor that complements nutmeg well; adjust nutmeg quantity as per taste preference without overpowering.

Serving size: 3/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 168, Fat: 6g, Carbs: 27g, Protein: 2g, Sodium: 85mg, Sugar: 7g, Fiber: 6g

Non-Citrus Based Sauces and Dressings

133. Creamy Avocado Dressing

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 ripe avocado, peeled & pitted
- 1/2 cup Greek yogurt, low-fat
- 1 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 2 tsp apple cider vinegar
- 1/4 cup water
- 1/4 tsp sea salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Directions:

1. In a blender or food processor, combine the avocado, Greek yogurt, parsley, apple cider vinegar, water, sea salt, and black pepper.
2. Blend until smooth. If the dressing is too thick, add additional water one tablespoon at a time until desired consistency is reached.

Tips: Use a ripe avocado for creaminess. Adjust water to achieve preferred consistency.

Serving size: 2 tablespoons

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 98; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 3g

134. Ginger Miso Vinaigrette

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 tbsp white miso paste
- 2 tbsp rice vinegar
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger root
- 1/2 cup extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 tbsp honey
- A pinch of black pepper

Directions:

1. In a medium bowl or in a jar with a tight-fitting lid, combine white miso paste, rice vinegar, freshly grated ginger root, olive oil, honey, and black pepper.
2. Whisk or shake until well blended and emulsified. Serve.

Tips: For an even smoother consistency, blend the vinaigrette in a food processor or blender.

Serving size: about 2 tablespoons

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories:110; Fat: 9g; Carbs: 7g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 240mg; Sugar: 6g; Fiber: 1g

135. Roasted Red Pepper Pesto

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 whole red bell peppers, roasted and peeled

- 1/2 cup unsalted raw almonds
- 1/4 cup grated Parmesan cheese (ensure low fat content)
- 2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 tbsp water
- 1/4 tsp sea salt
- A pinch of black pepper

Directions:

1. Place the roasted red bell peppers and almonds into a food processor; pulse until coarsely chopped.
2. Add Parmesan cheese, olive oil, water, sea salt, and black pepper; blend until smooth.
3. If pesto is too thick, adjust consistency with a little more water.

Tips: Serve with whole wheat pasta or as a spread on acid reflux-friendly whole grain bread. For roasting peppers, broil in the oven until skin blisters, then peel.

Serving size: 1/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 190; Fat 17g; Carbs 6g; Protein 4g; Sodium 150mg; Sugar 2g; Fiber 3g

136. Gentle Oat Milk Bechamel Sauce

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups oat milk
- 4 tbsp whole wheat flour
- 3 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 1/2 tsp salt
- A pinch of ground nutmeg

Directions:

1. In a small saucepan, heat the olive oil over medium heat. Add the whole wheat flour and whisk continuously for about 2 minutes until a smooth paste forms.
2. Gradually pour in the oat milk while continuing to whisk to prevent lumps.
3. Add the salt and a pinch of nutmeg, then cook for another 5-7 minutes until the sauce thickens to your desired consistency.
4. Remove from heat and let it cool slightly before serving.

Tips: For a smoother sauce, you can blend it after cooking. If too thick, add more oat milk to reach desired consistency.

Serving size: 1/2 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 320mg; Sugar: 1g; Fiber: 2g

137. Savory Mushroom Gravy

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. mushrooms, finely chopped
- 3 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 3 tbsp whole wheat flour
- 2 cups low-sodium vegetable broth
- 1/2 tsp dried thyme
- Salt and pepper to taste

Directions:

1. Heat olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat. Add mushrooms and sauté for 8 minutes until they release their juices and become golden brown.

2. Sprinkle whole wheat flour over mushrooms, stir well to combine and cook for an additional minute to remove any raw flour taste.
3. Gradually add the vegetable broth while stirring continuously and bring to a boil. Reduce heat to low.
4. Add thyme, salt, and pepper. Let it simmer for 10 minutes or until thickened to your liking.
5. Adjust seasoning if necessary and serve hot over your favorite dishes.

Tips: If you desire a smoother gravy texture, you can blend the cooked gravy before serving.

Serving size: approximately 1/2 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 12g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 150mg
Sugar 1g; Fiber 3g

138. Cucumber Herb Dressing

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 medium cucumber, peeled and seeded
- 3 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 2 tbsp white wine vinegar
- 1 tbsp chopped fresh dill
- 1/2 tsp sea salt
- A pinch of black pepper
- Cold water (as needed for desired consistency)

Directions:

1. In a blender, combine cucumber, olive oil, white wine vinegar, dill, sea salt, and black pepper.
2. Blend until smooth. For thinner dressing, add cold water one tablespoon at a time until reaching desired consistency.

Tips: Perfect as a salad dressing or over grilled chicken.

Serving size: 2 tbsp

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 80; Fat 7g; Carbs 2g; Protein <1g; Sodium 295mg; Sugar <1g; Fiber <1g

139. Soothing Dill Yogurt Sauce

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup plain Greek yogurt
- 2 tbsp fresh dill, finely chopped
- 1 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 1/2 tsp honey
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp ground black pepper (optional)

Directions:

1. In a mixing bowl, combine the Greek yogurt, chopped dill, olive oil, honey, salt, and black pepper (if using).
2. Stir all the ingredients until well mixed. Refrigerate for at least 15 minutes to let flavors meld before serving.

Tips: For a smoother sauce, blend ingredients in a food processor until desired consistency is achieved. Also, feel free to adjust the amount of dill to suit your taste.

Serving size: 1/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 60; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 4g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 160mg; Sugar: 3g; Fiber: 0g

140. Gentle Balsamic Drizzle

Preparation time: 2 minutes

Cooking time: 15-20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1/2 cup balsamic vinegar
- 1 tbsp pure maple syrup
- A pinch of salt (optional)

Directions:

1. Pour balsamic vinegar into a small saucepan. Heat over medium heat until it comes to a gentle boil.
2. Reduce heat to low and let simmer for 15-20 minutes or until the vinegar has reduced by half and is thick enough to coat the back of a spoon.
3. Remove from heat and stir in maple syrup and a pinch of salt if desired.
4. Allow to cool completely before serving—the reduction will thicken further as it cools.

Tips: Make sure not to burn the reduction as it simmers; keep an eye on it toward the end of cooking. Store any leftovers in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to two weeks.

Serving size: 1 tbsp

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 45; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 11g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 10g; Fiber: 0g

Starches that Won't Stir Up Symptoms

141. Roasted Acorn Squash with Thyme

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 cups cubed acorn squash
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tsp fresh thyme, chopped
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F. In a large bowl, mix the squash cubes with olive oil, thyme, salt, and pepper.
2. Spread the seasoned squash on a baking sheet. Roast for 25 minutes or until the squash is tender and starts to caramelize.

Tips: For even cooking, be sure to flip the squash halfway through the roasting time.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 160; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 6g

142. Turmeric Basmati Pilaf

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup basmati rice, washed
- 2 cups water
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp turmeric powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- A pinch of black pepper
- Fresh parsley for garnish (optional)

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, bring water, olive oil, turmeric powder, salt, and pepper to a boil. Add the basmati rice to the boiling mixture and stir gently.
2. Reduce heat to low, cover, and simmer for 20 minutes or until all liquid is absorbed. Remove from heat and let it sit covered for another 5 minutes.
3. Fluff with a fork before serving and garnish with fresh parsley if desired.

Tips: Ensure lid is tightly fitted during cooking to prevent steam from escaping – this ensures fluffy pilaf.

Serving size: ¾ cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 210; Fat: 3.5g; Carbs: 40g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 1g

143. Soothing Carrot and Swede Mash

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. swede, peeled and cubed
- 1 lb. carrots, peeled and cubed
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp salt (or to taste)
- ¼ tsp black pepper (optional)
- ¼ cup unsweetened almond milk

Directions:

1. In a large pot, bring water to a boil. Add the swede and carrots and cook until tender, about 20 minutes.
2. Drain the vegetables and return them to the pot. Add olive oil, salt, pepper (if using), and almond milk.
3. Mash the mixture with a potato masher or an immersion blender until smooth and creamy.

Tips: To enhance flavor without acid or spice, consider adding fresh herbs like dill or parsley. This mash can be made ahead of time and reheated before serving.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 21g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 600mg; Sugar: 9g; Fiber: 5g

144. Steamed Jasmine Rice with Chives

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 18 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup jasmine rice, rinsed
- 1¾ cups water
- Pinch of salt
- 2 tbsp chives, finely chopped

Directions:

1. In a saucepan, combine rinsed jasmine rice, water, and salt. Bring to a boil. Once boiling, reduce heat to low. Cover the pan with the lid slightly ajar to allow steam to escape.
2. Cook for 18 minutes or until water is absorbed and rice is tender. Remove from heat and let sit for a few minutes with the lid on.
3. Fluff rice with a fork and gently stir in the chives.

Tips: For fluffier rice, let it sit for an additional 5 minutes after cooking before fluffing with a fork. Ensure that your chives are fresh for better flavor without irritation.

Serving size: ¾ cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 160; Fat: 0.3g; Carbs: 35g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 0.6g

145. Baked Parsnip Fries

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. parsnips, peeled and sliced into fries
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp paprika
- Salt to taste

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 425°F. In a large bowl, toss the parsnips with olive oil, paprika, and a pinch of salt.
2. Spread the parsnip fries in a single layer on a baking sheet lined with parchment paper. Bake for 30 minutes or until golden brown and crispy, flipping halfway through cooking.

Tips: For extra crispiness, let the fries sit in cold water for an hour before baking. Use parchment paper to prevent sticking and ensure easy cleanup.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 22g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 120mg; Sugar: 6g; Fiber: 6g

146. Savory Herb Polenta

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup polenta (cornmeal)

- 3 cups water
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 1 tsp dried rosemary
- Salt to taste
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan over high heat, bring water to a boil. Gradually whisk in polenta and reduce heat to low. Continue stirring as it thickens.
2. Add thyme and rosemary. Season with salt. Stir well. Cook on low heat for 30 minutes until the polenta is creamy and tender.
3. Remove from heat and stir in butter until well combined.

Tips: Polenta will thicken as it cools. Stir occasionally if you prefer it smoother.

Serving size: 3/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 5.5g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 90mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 4g

147. Quinoa with Fresh Parsley

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup quinoa, rinsed
- 2 cups water
- 1/4 cup fresh parsley, chopped finely
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper, ground
- 1 tbsp almond slivers (optional, for garnish)

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, bring the water to a boil over high heat.
2. Stir in the quinoa, reduce heat to low, cover and simmer for 15 minutes until the quinoa is cooked and water is absorbed. Remove and let it sit covered for 5 minutes.
3. Fluff the quinoa with a fork, then stir in olive oil, salt, pepper, and fresh parsley until well combined. Garnish with almond slivers if using, and serve warm.

Tips: Ensure to rinse quinoa before cooking to remove its natural coating of saponins that can give a bitter taste. Quinoa can be cooked in a rice cooker as well. Use the same water-to-quinoa ratio.

Serving size: 3/4 cup cooked quinoa

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 222; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 32g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 3g

148. **Ginger-Infused Brown Rice**

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 45 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup brown rice, rinsed
- 2 cups water
- 1 tbsp fresh ginger, grated
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tsp salt
- A pinch of black pepper

Directions:

1. In a pot bring water to boil and add grated ginger letting it simmer for 3 minutes. Add brown rice to the pot. Stir in olive oil, salt, and black pepper.

2. Reduce heat to low and cover the pot. Cook for 40 minutes or until the water is fully absorbed and rice is tender.
3. Remove from heat and allow it to stand covered for another 5 minutes. Fluff with a fork before serving warm.

Tips: Soak brown rice for an hour prior to cooking to reduce overall cook time. If ginger feels overwhelming, infuse it in water over heat then remove before adding rice.

Serving size: 3/4 cup cooked rice

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 216; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 35g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 300mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 2g

149. Garlic-Free Vegan Mashed Potatoes

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 lbs. russet potatoes, peeled and quartered
- 1/4 cup olive oil
- 3/4 cup almond milk, unsweetened
- 1 tbsp. chives, chopped
- Salt & pepper to taste

Directions:

1. Place the potatoes in a large pot with enough water to cover them. Let it boil. Reduce heat to medium-high and cook for 20 minutes or until potatoes are tender.
2. Drain the potatoes and return them to the pot. Add olive oil, almond milk, salt, and pepper. Mash the potatoes using a potato masher or hand mixer until smooth.
3. Stir in the chopped chives and adjust seasoning if necessary.

Tips: For the creamiest texture, warm up the almond milk before adding to the potatoes.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 250kcal; Fat: 14g; Carbs: 28g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 1g; Fiber: 3g

150. Mixed Vegetable Buckwheat Noodles

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 8 oz buckwheat noodles (soba)
- 1 cup carrot, julienned
- 1 cup red bell pepper, julienned
- 1 cup zucchini, julienned
- 2 tbsp sesame oil
- Salt & pepper to taste
- A pinch of ground ginger

Directions:

1. Cook buckwheat noodles according to package instructions, then drain and set aside.
2. In a large skillet or wok, heat sesame oil over medium heat.
3. Add the carrots, red bell peppers, and zucchini. Stir-fry for 5 minutes until vegetables are tender but still crisp.
4. Add the cooked noodles to the skillet with vegetables and toss well. Season with salt, pepper, and a pinch of ground ginger. Serve.

Tips: Do not overcook the noodles or vegetables to ensure they retain their texture and nutrients.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 240kcal; Fat: 8g; Carbs: 38g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 20mg; Sugar: 4g; Fiber 6g

CHAPTER 9

Desserts with Less Discomfort

Fruit-Based Desserts for Acid-Reflux Safe Cravings

151. Banana Almond Oat Crumble

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups rolled oats
- 4 ripe bananas, sliced
- 1/4 cup almonds, chopped
- 3 tbsp honey
- 1 tbsp ground cinnamon
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter, melted
- 1/4 tsp salt

Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. In a mixing bowl, combine the rolled oats, chopped almonds, ground cinnamon, salt, and melted butter.
2. In a separate bowl, toss the banana slices with honey. Layer the banana slices at the bottom of a baking dish.
3. Spread the oat mixture over the bananas evenly. Bake for 20 minutes or until the top is golden brown and crunchy. Let it cool slightly before serving.

Tips: Serve with a dollop of yogurt if desired and an extra drizzle of honey for added sweetness.

Serving size: 3/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 308; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 50g; Protein: 6g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 22g; Fiber: 7g

152. Strawberry Basil Sorbet

Preparation time: 15 minutes + chilling time

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups strawberries, hulled and halved
- 1 cup water
- 1/4 cup honey
- 1/4 cup fresh basil leaves, finely chopped
- 1 tbsp fresh mint leaves, finely chopped (optional)

Directions:

1. Blend the strawberries, water, and honey together until smooth. Stir in the chopped basil leaves and optional mint leaves into the mixture.
2. Pour the mixture into a shallow baking dish. Place in the freezer for 2 hours and stir every 30 minutes until it reaches sorbet consistency.
3. Scoop into bowls or glasses and serve immediately.

Tips: For a smoother texture, you can strain the mixture through a fine-mesh sieve before freezing to remove seeds. If the sorbet is too hard to scoop, let it sit at room temperature for a few minutes before serving.

Serving size: 1/2 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 90; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 23g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 3mg; Sugar: 20g; Fiber: 3g

153. Oat & Raisin Stuffed Apples

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 30 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 large apples, cored
- 1/2 cup rolled oats
- 1/4 cup raisins
- 2 tbsp honey
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- Pinch of nutmeg
- Water as needed

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. In a small bowl, combine rolled oats, raisins, honey, cinnamon, and nutmeg. Stuff each apple with the oats mixture.
2. Place the stuffed apples in a baking dish and add enough water to cover the bottom of the dish. Bake for 30 minutes or until apples are tender.

Tips: Choose firm apples that will hold up well during baking such as Granny Smith or Honeycrisp. Serve warm with a sprinkle of additional cinnamon on top for added flavor without acidity.

Serving size: 1 stuffed apple

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat: 0.5g; Carbs: 48g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 5mg; Sugar: 35g; Fiber: 5g

154. Raspberry Chia Seed Pudding

Preparation time: 15 minutes + chilling time

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1/4 cup chia seeds
- 1 tbsp maple syrup (optional)
- 1/2 cup fresh raspberries
- 1/2 tsp vanilla extract

Directions:

1. In a bowl, whisk together almond milk, chia seeds, and vanilla extract. If desired, add maple syrup to sweeten.
2. Divide the mixture between two serving glasses or bowls. Place the raspberries on top of the mixture.
3. Cover and refrigerate for at least 4 hours, or overnight, until the pudding is set.

Tips: Stir the pudding mixture after 30 minutes of refrigeration to prevent clumping. You can mash some of the raspberries before placing them on top for an extra burst of flavor.

Serving size: 1/2 the recipe

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 140; Fat: 7g; Carbs: 17g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 55mg; Sugar: 5g; Fiber: 11g

155. Mixed Berries Gelatin Cups

Preparation time: 20 minutes + chilling time

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 6 cups

Ingredients:

- 2 cups mixed berries (strawberries, blueberries, raspberries)
- 3 cups water
- 3 tbsp gelatin powder (unflavored)
- ¼ cup honey
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

Directions:

1. In a saucepan, bring the water to a simmer and turn off the heat. Whisk in the gelatin powder until dissolved. Stir in the honey and vanilla extract.
2. Arrange the mixed berries evenly among six serving cups. Pour the gelatin mixture over the berries in each cup. Chill in the refrigerator for 3 hours until set.

Tips: To release the gelatin cups more easily, dip the cup bottoms briefly in warm water then invert onto a plate.

Serving size: 1 gelatin cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 24g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 22g; Fiber: 2g

156. Caramelized Pineapple with Coconut Flakes

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. fresh pineapple (peeled, cored and sliced into rings)
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter
- 2 tbsp brown sugar replacement (erythritol-based preferable)
- 1 tbsp coconut flakes (unsweetened)

Directions:

1. In a large non-stick skillet over medium heat, melt the butter. Add brown sugar replacement and stir until dissolved.
2. Place pineapple rings into skillet and cook for about 5 minutes per side or until caramelized. Transfer to serving dishes and sprinkle with coconut flakes.

Tips: For added flavor without acid reflux aggravation, consider garnishing with mint leaves before serving.

Serving size: 1 pineapple ring with coconut flakes

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 5g; Carbs: 27g ; Protein: 1g ; Sodium: 20mg ; Sugar: 22g; Fiber: 3g

157. Coconut Milk Poached Pears

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 ripe pears, peeled

- 2 cups unsweetened coconut milk
- 1/3 cup honey
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 tbsp vanilla extract

Directions:

1. In a large saucepan, combine coconut milk, honey, cinnamon, and vanilla extract. Stir over medium heat until the honey is dissolved.
2. Carefully place the pears into the saucepan and reduce heat to low. Simmer for 25 minutes or until the pears become tender. Remove and let the pears cool in the liquid.

Tips: Picking ripe but firm pears will help them maintain shape during poaching. Serve cold for a refreshing dessert option.

Serving size: 1 pear with sauce

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 270; Fat: 11g; Carbs: 44g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 15mg; Sugar: 38g; Fiber: 5g

158. Blackberry Infused Frozen Yogurt

Preparation time: 15 minutes + freezing time

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 3 cups plain low-fat Greek yogurt
- 1 cup fresh blackberries
- 1/4 cup honey
- 1 tsp pure vanilla extract

Directions:

1. Puree blackberries using a blender or food processor. Strain blackberries through a fine mesh to remove seeds.
2. In a bowl, mix together Greek yogurt, blackberry puree, honey, and vanilla extract until well combined.
3. Pour mixture into an ice cream maker and churn according to manufacturer's instructions. Once reached desired consistency, transfer to a freezer-safe container and freeze until solid.

Tips: If you don't have an ice cream maker, pour mixture into a shallow pan and stir every half hour until frozen. Thaw for a few minutes before scooping if frozen solid.

Serving size: about 1/2 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 190; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 29g; Protein: 15g; Sodium: 55mg; Sugar: 24g; Fiber: 2g

159. Blueberry Coconut Yogurt Parfait

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup low-fat Greek yogurt
- 1/2 cup fresh blueberries
- 2 tbsp unsweetened shredded coconut
- 2 tbsp rolled oats

Directions:

1. In each serving glass, layer 1/4 cup of Greek yogurt at the bottom.
2. Add a layer of blueberries followed by a sprinkle of rolled oats and shredded coconut.
3. Repeat the layers once more and finish with blueberries and coconut on top.

Tips: Chill the parfait for about an hour before serving for an extra refreshing treat. For added texture, you can lightly toast the shredded coconut until golden brown before adding to the parfait.

Serving size: 1/2 of the recipe

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 12g; Sodium: 45mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 2g

160. Baked Pear with Honey and Cinnamon

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 large pears, halved and cored
- 2 tbsp honey
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- A pinch of salt

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. Place halved pears on a baking dish with cut sides up.
2. Drizzle honey evenly over each pear half then sprinkle them with cinnamon and a pinch of salt.
3. Bake for 25 minutes or until pears are soft and slightly golden. Serve warm.

Tips: Baking time may vary based on pear variety and ripeness; make sure to use ripe but firm pears to hold their shape while cooking.

Serving size: 1 pear half

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 32g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 27g; Fiber: 6g

Sweets for Sensitive Stomachs

161. Vanilla Almond Chia Pudding

Preparation time: 15 minutes + chilling time

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1/4 cup chia seeds
- 1 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1 tbsp maple syrup
- 1/2 tsp vanilla extract
- Pinch of salt

Directions:

1. In a bowl, whisk together the chia seeds, almond milk, maple syrup, vanilla extract, and a pinch of salt.
2. Cover and refrigerate for at least 4 hours or overnight until the pudding has thickened.
3. Stir before serving and add additional almond milk for desired consistency if necessary.

Tips: For the best texture, stir the pudding occasionally during the first hour of refrigeration. Top with fresh low-acid fruits like berries if desired.

Serving size: 1/2 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 180; Fat 9g; Carbs 21g; Protein 5g; Sodium 95mg; Sugar 8g; Fiber 10g

162. Chamomile Lavender Honey Gelato

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 2 cups whole milk
- 1 tbsp dried chamomile flowers
- 1 tsp dried lavender buds
- 3 tbsp honey
- 2 cups heavy cream
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

Directions:

1. In a small saucepan, warm the whole milk over medium heat until just simmering. Remove from heat.
2. Add the chamomile flowers and lavender buds to the warm milk. Cover and let steep for 5 minutes.
3. Strain the milk to remove flowers and buds, then return it to the saucepan. Stir honey into the infused milk until fully dissolved.
4. In a mixing bowl, whisk together the infused milk and heavy cream. Stir in vanilla extract.
5. Pour mixture into an ice cream maker and churn according to manufacturer's instructions until it has reached a soft-serve consistency.
6. Transfer gelato to an airtight container and freeze for 2 hours until firm.

Tips: For a smoother flavor, you can add a tablespoon of corn syrup with honey—this helps to prevent crystallization without adding acid reflux triggers.

Serving size: 1/2 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 390; Fat: 32g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 50mg; Sugar: 20g; Fiber: 0g

163. Chai Spiced Rice Pudding

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1/2 cup uncooked white rice, washed
- 2 cups almond milk
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/4 tsp ground ginger
- Pinch of cardamom
- Pinch of clove
- Pinch of nutmeg
- 3 tbsp maple syrup

Directions:

1. In a medium saucepan, combine rinsed rice and almond milk; bring to a boil over medium-high heat.
2. Reduce heat to low and simmer gently for 20-25 minutes, stirring often until rice is tender. Once rice is cooked, add cinnamon, ginger, cardamom, clove and nutmeg. Stir well.
3. Stir in maple syrup until evenly distributed. Continue cooking on low heat for another 5 minutes or until desired consistency is achieved.

Tips: Use ground spices for convenience if you prefer not to grind your own consult your doctor or nutritionist regarding specific nutmeg usage as some may find even this spice irritates reflux in large amounts.

Serving size: 3/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories:180; Fat: 2.5g; Carbs: 38g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 80mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 1g

164. Peppermint Yogurt Bark

Preparation time: 10 minutes + chilling time

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 8

Ingredients:

- 2 cups Greek yogurt, plain, low-fat
- 1/4 cup honey or maple syrup
- 1/2 tsp peppermint extract
- 1/4 cup crushed peppermint candies (ensure they are free of the foods to avoid listed)
- 1 tbsp dark chocolate shavings (optional)

Directions:

1. In a medium bowl, mix Greek yogurt, honey, and peppermint extract until well combined. Pour the yogurt mixture onto the lined baking tray and spread evenly.
2. Sprinkle the top with crushed peppermint candies and dark chocolate shavings if you're using them.
3. Place the tray in the freezer and freeze for at least 2 hours, or until firm. Once frozen, break into pieces, serve immediately or store in an airtight container in the freezer.

Tips: To make this recipe acid reflux friendlier, opt for a very small amount of honey or maple syrup or substitute it with a low-acid sweetener. If you are sensitive to chocolate, you can omit the dark chocolate shavings from this recipe.

Serving size: 1 piece

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 90; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 25mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 0g

165. Honey-Glazed Gingerbread Squares

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 12 squares

Ingredients:

- 2 cups whole wheat flour
- 1/4 cup honey
- 2 tsp ground ginger
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon
- 1/4 tsp nutmeg
- 6 tbsp unsalted butter, melted
- 1/4 cup almond milk

Directions:

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine flour, ground ginger, cinnamon, and nutmeg. Stir in the honey, melted butter, and almond milk until the mixture forms a dough.
2. Press the dough into an 8x8-inch square baking dish lined with parchment paper. Chill in the refrigerator for at least 1 hour to set. Cut into squares before serving.

Tips: If the mixture is too dry, add almond milk one tablespoon at a time until it reaches desired consistency. Serve with a drizzle of honey on top for added sweetness if desired.

Serving size: 1 square

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 150; Fat: 6g; Carbs: 23g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 9g; Fiber: 3g

166. **Toasted Coconut Flan**

Preparation time: 15 minutes + chilling time

Cooking time: 45 minutes

Servings: 8

Ingredients:

- 3 cups unsweetened coconut milk
- 1/2 cup honey
- 1/4 cup water
- 5 large eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 cup shredded unsweetened coconut, toasted

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. In a small saucepan over medium heat, combine water and honey. Stir until honey is dissolved to create a light syrup. Pour the syrup into an oven-proof round dish.
2. In a mixing bowl, whisk together coconut milk, eggs, and vanilla extract until well blended. Gently pour the egg mixture over the syrup in the dish. Sprinkle toasted coconut on top of the mixture.
3. Place dish into a larger pan and fill larger pan with boiling water up to half of the flan dish's height for a water bath.
4. Bake for 45 minutes or until set around the edges but still slightly wobbly in the center. Remove and let it cool, then refrigerate for at least 4 hours before serving.

Tips: Ensure water does not get into the flan mixture when setting up your water bath. The flan can be made a day ahead of serving to fully set and develop flavors.

Serving size: 1 slice

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat:14g; Carbs:16g; Protein:7g; Sodium:75mg; Sugar 14g; Fiber 0g

167. No-Bake Sweet Potato Brownies

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 8

Ingredients:

- 1 lb. of sweet potatoes, peeled and mashed
- 3/4 cup almond flour
- 1/4 cup unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1/4 cup pure maple syrup
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon
- Pinch of salt

Directions:

1. In a mixing bowl, combine the almond flour, cocoa powder, cinnamon, and salt. Add in the mashed sweet potatoes, maple syrup, and vanilla extract. Stir until well mixed.
2. Line an 8x8 inch baking dish with parchment paper. Spread the brownie mixture into the dish evenly with a spatula.
3. Refrigerate for at least 2 hours to set before cutting into squares.

Tips: For added texture, mix in a tablespoon of chopped walnuts or pecans. If you need a little more sweetness, drizzle a bit more maple syrup on top before serving.

Serving size: 1 square

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 180; Fat 6g; Carbs 28g; Protein 4g; Sodium 70mg; Sugar 12g; Fiber 5g

168. Ginger Snap Cookie Crumble

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 6

Ingredients:

- 2 cups of gingersnap cookies (gluten-free), crushed
- 3 tbsp coconut oil, melted
- 2 tbsp almond butter
- 1 tbsp molasses
- 1 tsp ground ginger
- Pinch of salt

Directions:

1. Place gingersnap cookies in a food processor and pulse into fine crumbs.
2. Transfer crumbs to a mixing bowl and add in melted coconut oil, almond butter, molasses, ground ginger, and salt.
3. Mix thoroughly until all ingredients are well combined and texture is consistent. Serve as a topping for acid reflux-friendly ice cream or yogurt.

Tips: Store extra crumble in an airtight container in the refrigerator to maintain freshness. For added crispness, spread crumble on a baking sheet and chill in the freezer for about an hour before serving.

Serving size: 1/3 cup crumble

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 195; Fat 10g; Carbs 24g; Protein 2g; Sodium 150mg; Sugar 11g; Fiber 1g

169. Pumpkin Spice Rice Pudding

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 35 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1/2 cup uncooked white rice
- 2 cups unsweetened almond milk
- 1/4 cup pure pumpkin puree (not pumpkin pie filling)
- 3 tbsp maple syrup
- 3/4 tsp pumpkin pie spice (no allspice)
- Pinch of salt

Directions:

1. Combine rice, almond milk, and a pinch of salt in a saucepan. Bring to a boil over medium heat. Reduce heat to low, cover, and simmer for 15 minutes.
2. Stir in maple syrup, pumpkin puree, and pumpkin pie spice, then continue cooking for another 20 minutes or until rice is tender and creamy.
3. Let it cool slightly before serving. If pudding thickens too much upon cooling, you can thin it with a bit more almond milk.

Tips: Constantly stir towards the end of cooking to avoid the rice sticking to the bottom of the pan. Serve warm or chilled based on preference.

Serving size: roughly 3/4 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 190; Fat 2g; Carbs 40g; Protein 4g; Sodium 100mg; Sugar 12g; Fiber 2g

170. Peanut Butter Honey Cookies

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 12 cookies

Ingredients:

- 1 cup natural peanut butter (smooth)
- 1/2 cup honey
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1 cup rolled oats

Directions:

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine peanut butter, honey, and salt. Stir until well combined. Gradually add rolled oats to the mixture and fold until evenly incorporated.
2. Scoop a tablespoon of the mixture and roll into a ball. Flatten the ball slightly to form a cookie shape and place on a lined tray. Refrigerate for at least 30 minutes to set. Serve.

Tips: If the mixture is too sticky, refrigerate it for 10 minutes before shaping the cookies. You can press a few oats on top of each cookie for decoration before refrigerating.

Serving size: 1 cookie

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 17g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 75mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 2g

Baked Goods without Heartburn

171. Coconut Flour Zucchini Cupcakes

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 12 cupcakes

Ingredients:

- 1 cup coconut flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 1/2 cup unsweetened applesauce
- 3 large eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 3/4 cup grated zucchini, excess water squeezed out
- 1/4 cup almond milk

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. In a large bowl, mix together the coconut flour, baking powder, and salt.
2. In another bowl, whisk the eggs, applesauce, and vanilla extract until smooth. Add the wet ingredients to dry ingredients and stir until combined. Fold in the grated zucchini.
3. Gradually add almond milk to reach a batter consistency. Fill each cup of a lined muffin tin about two-thirds full with batter.
4. Bake for 20 minutes or until a toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean. Let it cool on a wire rack. Serve.

Tips: Ensure all excess moisture is removed from the zucchini by squeezing it with paper towels. You can also add a pinch of cinnamon for extra flavor without aggravating acid reflux.

Serving size: 1 cupcake

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 95; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 10g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 135mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 5g

172. Apple Cinnamon Tea Cake

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 35 minutes

Servings: 8

Ingredients:

- 1 3/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 1/2 cup unsweetened applesauce
- 3/4 cup sugar substitute (e.g., stevia)
- 2 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 cup low-fat milk (or milk substitute)
- 1/4 cup vegetable oil

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. Grease a 9-inch cake pan. Mix flour, cinnamon, and baking powder in a bowl.
2. Stir in applesauce, sugar substitute, milk, and oil until well combined. Pour the batter into the prepared pan.
3. Bake for 35 minutes or until a toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean. Allow cooling before serving.

Tips: Serve with a sprinkle of ground cinnamon on top for extra flavor without adding acid-causing ingredients.

Serving size: 1 slice

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 180; Fat 7g; Carbs 26g; Protein 3g; Sodium 150mg; Sugar 8g; Fiber 1g

173. Honey-Spiced Millet Muffins

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 12 muffins

Ingredients:

- 1 cup millet flour
- 1/4 cup honey
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon
- 1/4 tsp nutmeg
- 1 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 2 tbsp vegetable oil

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F and line a muffin tin with paper liners. In a large bowl, whisk together millet flour, baking powder, cinnamon, and nutmeg.
2. In a separate bowl, combine honey, almond milk, and vegetable oil. Add the wet ingredients to the dry ingredients and stir until just combined.
3. Divide the batter evenly among the muffin cups. Bake for 20 minutes or until a toothpick inserted into the center of a muffin comes out clean.
4. Remove muffins from oven and let it cool for 5 minutes before transferring to a wire rack to cool completely.

Tips: For extra flavor, add a pinch of ginger or vanilla extract to your batter. If the mixture is too dry, add a little more almond milk until the desired consistency is achieved.

Serving size: 1 muffin

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 100; Fat: 3g; Carbs: 17g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 80mg; Sugar: 7g; Fiber: 1g

174. Raspberry Cornbread

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 25 minutes

Servings: 8

Ingredients:

- 1 cup cornmeal
- 1 cup all-purpose flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/4 cup honey
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup non-fat milk
- 1/4 cup unsweetened applesauce
- 1 cup fresh raspberries

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F and grease an 8-inch square baking pan. In a large bowl, mix cornmeal, flour, baking powder, and salt.
2. Stir in honey, milk, and applesauce until just combined. Gently fold in raspberries.
3. Pour batter into the prepared pan and bake for 25 minutes or until a toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean.
4. Allow to cool before cutting into squares.

Tips: Use fresh raspberries instead of canned to avoid additional acids. Opt for non-fat milk to minimize fat content.

Serving size: 1 square

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 180; Fat: 1g; Carbs: 39g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 250mg; Sugar: 11g; Fiber: 3g

175. Sweet Potato Biscotti

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 40 minutes

Servings: 10 servings

Ingredients:

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup mashed cooked sweet potato
- 1/3 cup honey
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1/2 tbsp cinnamon

Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. In a bowl, mix together flour, baking powder, salt, and cinnamon.
2. In another bowl, combine mashed sweet potato, honey, and olive oil. Add the dry ingredients to the wet ingredients and stir until just combined.
3. Shape the dough into a flat log on a lined baking sheet. Bake for 20 minutes until firm, then let it cool for a few minutes before slicing into biscotti shapes.
4. Place slices back on the baking sheet and bake for another 20 minutes or until crisp.

Tips: Ensure sweet potatoes are thoroughly cooked to get a smooth mash without lumps. Let the biscotti cool completely after the second bake to get the right texture.

Serving size: 1 biscotti stick

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories:160; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 33g; Protein: 3g; Sodium: 125mg; Sugar: 10g; Fiber: 1g

176. Almond Flour Biscuits

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 15 minutes

Servings: 8

Ingredients:

- 2 cups almond flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 2 tbsp cold butter, cut into pieces
- 2 large eggs
- 1/3 cup unsweetened almond milk

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F. In a large bowl, combine almond flour, baking powder, and salt.
2. Add butter to the bowl and use a pastry cutter or fork to combine until crumbly. In a separate bowl, whisk the eggs and almond milk together.
3. Stir wet ingredients into dry ingredients until a dough forms. Drop dough by spoonfuls onto a parchment-lined baking sheet. Bake for 15 minutes, or until golden brown.

Tips: Keep an eye on biscuits as almond flour can brown quickly. Serve with a dollop of lactose-free yogurt if tolerated.

Serving size: 1 biscuit

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 200; Fat: 16g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 7g; Sodium: 150mg; Sugar: 1g; Fiber: 3g;

177. Vanilla Bean Madeleines

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 12

Ingredients:

- 1 cup almond flour
- 1/3 cup honey or maple syrup (as tolerated)
- 1/8 tsp salt
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 large eggs
- Seeds from one vanilla bean (or appropriate alternative if necessary for acid reflux diet)
- Zest of one lemon (optional and only if tolerated, as some people with acid reflux can handle it)

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F and grease a madeleine pan with non-stick spray. In a large bowl, mix together almond flour, salt, and baking soda.
2. Add honey/maple syrup, eggs, and vanilla bean seeds to the dry ingredients and mix until smooth. If tolerated, gently fold in lemon zest.
3. Spoon the batter into the madeleine pan cavities. Bake for 10 minutes or until edges are lightly golden.
4. Cool in pan for a few minutes before transferring to a wire rack to cool completely.

Tips: Be careful when adding lemon zest—omit if citrus typically triggers reflux symptoms. Ensure oven is fully preheated for even baking.

Serving size: 1 madeleine

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 106, Fat: 7.2g, Carbs: 8.6g, Protein: 3.4g, Sodium: 96mg, Sugar: 6.7g, Fiber: 1.6g

178. Easy Banana Oat Bread

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: 55 minutes

Servings: 12

Ingredients:

- 1 1/2 cups oat flour
- 3 ripe bananas, mashed
- 1/4 cup almond milk
- 2 eggs
- 1/2 cup honey
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1/4 tsp salt

Directions:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F and grease a loaf pan. In a large bowl, combine the oat flour, baking soda, and salt.
2. In another bowl, mix the mashed bananas, almond milk, eggs, and honey. Add the wet ingredients to the dry ingredients and stir until well combined.
3. Pour the batter into the prepared loaf pan. Bake for 55 minutes or until a toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean. Allow to cool before slicing.

Tips: Ensure bananas are very ripe for natural sweetness and easier digestion. Use oat flour for a gluten-free option.

Serving size: 1 slice

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 183; Fat: 2g; Carbs: 37g; Protein: 4g; Sodium: 135mg; Sugar: 17g; Fiber: 3g

179. Maple Walnut Scones

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 22 minutes

Servings: 8

Ingredients:

- 2 cups spelt flour
- 1/3 cup pure maple syrup
- 1/2 cup unsweetened almond milk
- 1/3 cup chopped walnuts
- 3 tbsp coconut oil, solid
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- A pinch of salt

Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F. In a large bowl, mix together spelt flour, baking powder, and salt.
2. Add solid coconut oil and use pasty cutter or fork to blend into dry mixture until crumbly. Stir in chopped walnuts.
3. Make a well in the center of the dry mixture and pour in almond milk and maple syrup. Gently mix until dough forms.
4. Turn dough onto floured surface, pat into round shape and cut into wedges. Place scones on a lined baking sheet and bake for 22 minutes or until golden brown.

Tips: Avoid over-kneading to keep scones light and fluffy.

Serving size: 1 scone

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 236; Fat: 10g; Carbs: 34g; Protein: 5g; Sodium: 87mg; Sugar: 11 g; Fiber: 4g

180. Spelt Pumpkin Bread

Preparation time: 20 minutes

Cooking time: 60 minutes

Servings: 10

Ingredients:

- 2 cups spelt flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tbsp pumpkin pie spice
- 3/4 cup canned pumpkin puree
- 1/2 cup maple syrup
- 1/4 cup vegetable oil
- 1/2 cup water

Directions:

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Grease and flour a loaf pan. In a large bowl, whisk together spelt flour, baking soda, and pumpkin pie spice.
2. Mix in pumpkin puree, maple syrup, oil, and water until well blended. Pour batter into the prepared loaf pan.
3. Bake for 60 minutes or until a toothpick inserted into the center of the bread comes out clean. Allow to cool in the pan before transferring to a wire rack to cool completely.

Tips: Store leftovers in an airtight container to maintain freshness without needing preservatives that can aggravate acid reflux.

Serving size: 1 slice

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 175; Fat 6g; Carbs 28g; Protein 3g; Sodium 98mg; Sugar 10g; Fiber 4g

CHAPTER 10

Beverages Safe for Acid Reflux

Water-Infused and Teas to Aid Digestion

181. Soothing Ginger Root Tea

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 20 minutes

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 cups water
- 2 tbsp freshly grated ginger root
- 1 tbsp honey (optional)
- 1/4 tsp ground cinnamon (optional)

Directions:

1. In a small pot, bring the water to a gentle boil. Add the freshly grated ginger root to the boiling water.
2. Lower the heat and simmer for 20 minutes to allow the ginger to infuse. Remove from heat, strain out the ginger pieces, and pour the tea into cups.
3. If desired, stir in honey and ground cinnamon to taste before serving.

Tips: For added flavor without acid reflux irritation, consider adding a few fresh mint leaves while simmering the ginger.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 2; Fat 0g; Carbs 0.5g; Protein 0g; Sodium 9mg; Sugar 0g; Fiber 0.1g

182. Chamomile Lavender Sleepy Tea

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 tbsp dried chamomile flowers
- 1 tbsp dried lavender flowers
- 2 cups boiling water
- 1 tsp honey (optional)

Directions:

1. In a teapot or heat-resistant pitcher, combine the dried chamomile and lavender flowers.
2. Pour the boiling water over the herbs and let it steep for 8-10 minutes.
3. Strain the tea into cups, making sure to remove all the herbs. Stir in honey to taste, if desired.

Tips: Ensure your teapot or pitcher is pre-warmed by rinsing it with hot water before brewing the tea to maintain temperature. For a stronger tea, allow the herbs to steep for a couple of minutes longer.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 2; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 0.5g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 0g (without honey); Fiber: 0g

183. Strawberry Basil Hydration Boost

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 cup fresh strawberries, sliced
- 6 large basil leaves
- 4 cups cold water

Directions:

1. Place the sliced strawberries and basil leaves at the bottom of a pitcher or large jar. Fill the container with cold water.
2. Infuse in the refrigerator for at least an hour, allowing the flavors to meld together. Stir gently before serving. Strain into glasses if desired.

Tips: The longer you let it sit, the more flavorful it will be. Consider preparing this infusion before bed to enjoy it throughout the following day.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 12; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 3g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar: 2g; Fiber: 1g

184. Honeydew Melon Rosemary Water

Preparation time: 10 minutes + chilling time

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 cups cold water
- 1 cup honeydew melon, cubed

- 2 sprigs fresh rosemary

Directions:

1. Place honeydew melon cubes and fresh rosemary sprigs into a large pitcher. Pour cold water over the melon and rosemary. Stir gently to mix.
2. Refrigerate for about 2 hours to allow flavors to infuse. Serve chilled with or without ice cubes.

Tips: To get a more intense flavor, gently muddle the rosemary with a wooden spoon before adding it to the pitcher.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 12; Fat 0g; Carbs 3g; Protein 0g; Sodium 10mg; Sugar 3g; Fiber 0.2g

185. Turmeric Cinnamon Milk Tea

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 cups almond milk
- 1 tbsp honey
- 1 tsp turmeric
- 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- Pinch of black pepper

Directions:

1. Pour the almond milk into a small saucepan and heat over medium heat until just hot, but not boiling.
2. Add the honey, turmeric, cinnamon, and black pepper to the milk. Whisk the mixture continuously for about 10 minutes on low heat.

3. Once the mixture is hot and flavors are well-blended. Serve.

Tips: Use a whisk to prevent the spices from clumping. Adjust sweetness with honey to taste.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 4g; Carbs: 18g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 90mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 1g

186. Blackberry Sage Cooler

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 cups water
- 1/2 cup fresh blackberries
- 4 fresh sage leaves
- Ice cubes

Directions:

1. In a large pitcher, gently muddle the blackberries and sage leaves. Add water to the pitcher and stir.
2. Let the mixture infuse in the refrigerator for at least 10 minutes. Serve over ice cubes in individual glasses.

Tips: The longer you allow the mixture to infuse, the stronger the flavor will be. You can strain the mixture before serving if you prefer a clear drink.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 25; Fat: <1g; Carbs: 6g; Protein: <1g; Sodium: <5mg; Sugar: 4g; Fiber: <1g

187. Gentle Green Tea with Honey

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 5 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 cups of water
- 2 tsp green tea leaves or 2 green tea bags
- 1 tbsp honey

Directions:

1. Boil 2 cups of water in a kettle or pot. Place the green tea leaves or bags into a teapot.
2. Once the water reaches a rolling boil, turn off the heat and let it cool for about one minute.
This ensures that the water is not too hot, as overly hot water can make green tea taste bitter.
3. Pour the slightly cooled hot water over the green tea leaves or bags. Steep for 2-3 minutes.
Remove the tea leaves or bags and add honey to taste, stirring until it dissolves. Serve warm.

Tips: Do not steep green tea for too long as it can lead to a bitter flavor. Always dissolve honey in warm—not boiling—water to preserve its natural benefits.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 32; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 8g; Fiber: 0g

188. Peach Thyme Infusion

Preparation time: 5 minutes + infusing time

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 4 cups of cold water
- 2 ripe peaches, sliced
- A bunch of fresh thyme sprigs

Directions:

1. Cleanse the peaches thoroughly and cut them into thin slices. Take a large pitcher and add the peach slices.
2. Wash fresh thyme sprigs under cold running water, shake off excess moisture, and add them to the pitcher. Fill the pitcher with cold water.
3. Gently stir the mixture then cover with a lid or plastic wrap. Refrigerate and let it infuse for at least four hours, or overnight for more robust flavor.

Tips: Using cold water preserves the subtle flavors of peach and thyme without extracting any bitterness. The longer you infuse, the stronger the flavors will be.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 30; Fat: 0.2g; Carbs: 7g; Protein:0.7g; Sodium: 0mg; Sugar:6g; Fiber:1g

189. Fennel Seed Digestive Tea

Preparation time: 5 minutes

Cooking time: 10 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 tbsp fennel seeds
- 2 cups of water
- 1 tbsp honey (optional)
- 1/2 tbsp fresh ginger, thinly sliced

Directions:

1. In a small saucepan, bring the water to a boil. Add the fennel seeds and sliced ginger to the boiling water.
2. Reduce the heat and let it simmer for about 10 minutes. Strain the tea into cups and add honey to taste if desired. Serve warm and enjoy the soothing effects.

Tips: For a milder flavor, crush the fennel seeds slightly before boiling. Drinking this tea slowly in small sips can help alleviate acid reflux symptoms.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 9; Fat: 0.15g; Carbs: 2.3g; Protein: 0.45g; Sodium: 5mg; Sugar: 0g; Fiber: 0.9g

190. Apple Cinnamon Comfort Water

Preparation time: 5 minutes + chilling time

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 4

Ingredients:

- 1 apple, thinly sliced

- 2 cinnamon sticks, whole
- 4 cups of filtered water

Directions:

1. Place the apple slices and cinnamon sticks in a large pitcher. Fill the pitcher with filtered water.
2. Cover it and let it infuse for at least two hours in the refrigerator, allowing all flavors to meld together gently. Serve chilled.

Tips: You can refill the pitcher with water several times before needing to replace the apple slices and cinnamon sticks. To ensure maximum flavor infusion, make sure apple slices are as thin as possible.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 32; Fat: 0g; Carbs: 8g; Protein: 0g; Sodium: 2mg; Sugar: 6g; Fiber 1.4g

Juice Recipes That Won't Trigger Heartburn

191. Ginger Melon Juice

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: 0 minutes

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 2 cups cubed honeydew melon
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 1 cup cold water
- A pinch of ground cinnamon (optional)

Directions:

1. In a blender, combine the cubed honeydew melon, grated ginger, and cold water. Blend until smooth.
2. Pour the juice through a fine mesh strainer to remove any pulp or ginger pieces. If preferred, stir in a pinch of ground cinnamon for added flavor. Serve.

Tips: For a colder drink, freeze the melon cubes prior to blending.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 60; Fat: 0.2g; Carbs: 14g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 25mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 1g

192. Kale and Kiwi Cooler Juice

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup kale, stems removed
- 2 ripe kiwis, peeled and quartered
- 1 green apple, cored and sliced
- 1/2 cucumber, sliced
- 1/2 cup cold water
- Ice cubes (optional)

Directions:

1. Place kale, kiwis, apple, mint leaves, cucumber, and water into a blender. Blend on high until completely smooth.
2. If desired, strain through a fine-mesh sieve to remove pulp. Serve over ice cubes in glasses if preferred.

Tips: For a smoother juice, additional water can be added to adjust consistency. Enjoy immediately for maximum nutrient retention.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 95; Fat: 0.6g; Carbs: 23g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 30mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 5g

193. Sweet Potato and Ginger Juice

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 medium sweet potato, peeled and cubed
- A knob of ginger (about 1 inch), peeled
- 2 medium carrots, peeled and chopped
- 1 apple, cored and sliced
- 1/4 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1/2 cup cold water
- Ice cubes (optional)

Directions:

1. Put sweet potato cubes, ginger, carrots, apple slices, cinnamon, and water in a blender. Blend on high until smooth.
2. Strain through a fine-mesh sieve if desired for less pulp. Pour over ice cubes in glasses if preferred to serve chilled.

Tips: Can be served warm as well for those cold days – simply omit the ice cubes.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 112; Fat: 0.3g; Carbs: 27g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 51mg; Sugar: 14g; Fiber: 4g

194. Gentle Pear Beet Bliss Juice

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 medium beet, peeled and quartered
- 2 ripe pears, cored and sliced
- 1/2 cup spinach leaves
- 1 tbsp grated fresh ginger
- 1 cup water
- Ice cubes (optional)

Directions:

1. In a blender, combine the beet, pears, spinach, ginger, and water. Blend on high speed until smooth.
2. Pour the juice through a fine-mesh strainer into glasses over ice cubes if desired. Stir well and serve immediately.

Tips: For easier blending, cut beet and pears into small pieces. If the juice is too thick, add more water to reach your preferred consistency.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 120; Fat: 0.3g; Carbs: 29g; Protein: 2g; Sodium: 76mg; Sugar: 20g; Fiber: 6g

195. Turmeric Celery Juice

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 4 large celery stalks, roughly chopped
- 1/2 medium cucumber, sliced
- 1 apple, cored and sliced
- 1 tbsp turmeric powder
- 1 tbsp lemon juice (from non-citrus substitute like apple cider vinegar)
- 1 cup coconut water

Directions:

1. Place the celery, cucumber, apple, turmeric powder into a blender. Add lemon juice and coconut water to it. Blend on high speed until smooth.
2. Strain the mixture using a fine-mesh strainer or cheesecloth into glasses. Serve immediately or chilled.

Tips: Ensure to thoroughly wash all vegetables to remove any dirt or pesticides before use. Use organic ingredients where possible for best flavor and health benefits.

Serving size: About 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 65; Fat: 0.5g; Carbs: 16g; Protein: 1g; Sodium: 85mg; Sugar: 12g; Fiber: 3g

196. Cucumber Apple Juice

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 large cucumber, peeled & sliced
- 2 medium-sized apples, cored and sliced (choose sweeter varieties like Gala or Fuji)
- 1/2 cup of baby spinach leaves
- 1/4 cup cold water
- Ice cubes for serving

Directions:

1. Add cucumber, apple slices, and baby spinach leaves to your juicer. If using a blender, add water to help blend smoothly.
2. Juice or blend until all ingredients are fully liquefied. If blending, strain the mixture through a fine-mesh sieve or cheesecloth into a large pitcher to remove pulp.
3. Serve poured over ice to maintain coolness.

Tips: For added refreshment consider adding a few sprigs of mint while blending/juicing. Ensure your fruits are chilled in advance for an extra cool juice experience.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 95; Fat: <0.5g; Carbs: 25g; Protein: <1g; Sodium: 10mg; Sugar: 20g; Fiber: 5g

197. Papaya and Aloe Juice

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup ripe papaya, peeled, seeded, and chopped
- 2 tbsp aloe vera gel (freshly extracted or store-bought, preservative-free)
- 1 tbsp honey (optional for sweetness)
- 1/2 cup cold water or ice cubes

Directions:

1. In a blender, combine the chopped papaya and aloe vera gel. Add honey if desired for additional sweetness.
2. Pour in cold water or add ice cubes to reach a preferred consistency. Blend until smooth. Pour into glasses and serve.

Tips: Ensure the papaya is ripe to avoid any potential irritants that may trigger acid reflux. Use aloe vera that is free of aloin, which can be a laxative and irritant.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 70; Fat 0g; Carbs 18g; Protein 1g; Sodium 12mg; Sugar 13g; Fiber 3g

198. Cool Cabbage and Berry Juice

Preparation time: 15 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1/2 cup red cabbage, chopped

- 1/2 cup strawberries, hulled
- 1/2 cup blueberries
- 1 medium cucumber, peeled and cut into chunks
- 1 tbsp chia seeds (optional)
- 3/4 cup cold water or ice cubes

Directions:

1. In a blender, combine the red cabbage, strawberries, blueberries, and cucumber chunks. If using chia seeds for extra fiber, add them to the mixture.
2. Add cold water or ice cubes to reach your preferred consistency. Blend until smooth and homogenous. Pour into glasses to serve immediately.

Tips: For those sensitive to fiber, straining the juice may reduce potential triggers of acid reflux while still retaining flavor.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories: 114; Fat: 1.5g; Carbs: 24.8g; Protein: 2.5g Sodium: 12mg; Sugar: 12.6g; Fiber: 5.3g

199. Sweet Carrot Pineapple Juice

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup carrots, chopped
- 1 cup pineapple chunks (fresh)
- 1 tbsp fresh mint leaves
- 1 cup water
- 1 tbsp honey (optional, for sweetness)

Directions:

1. Combine carrots, pineapple chunks, mint leaves, and water in the blender. Blend on high speed until smooth.
2. If desired, add honey for additional sweetness and blend again to incorporate. Pour through a fine-mesh strainer to remove pulp if preferred.
3. Divide the juice between two glasses and serve immediately.

Tips: For a colder drink, use frozen pineapple or add a couple of ice cubes before blending. You can adjust the honey based on your sweetness preference or omit it entirely for a sugar-free version.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 95; Fat 0.3g; Carbs 23g; Protein 1g; Sodium 42mg; Sugar 17g; Fiber 2g

200. Golden Mango Peach Juice

Preparation time: 10 minutes

Cooking time: N/A

Servings: 2

Ingredients:

- 1 cup mango chunks (fresh)
- 1 cup peach slices (fresh)
- 1 tbsp chia seeds
- 1 cup water
- ½ tsp fresh ginger, peeled, grated

Directions:

1. Add the mango chunks, peach slices, chia seeds, and grated ginger into a blender. Pour in water and blend everything until you reach a smooth consistency.
2. Strain through a mesh sieve for a smoother texture or serve as is for more fiber. Serve the juice split between two glasses immediately upon preparation.

Tips: To enhance your juice's freshness and flavor profile, add fresh mint or basil leaves before blending. The riper your fruit is, the sweeter your juice will be naturally without needing extra sweeteners.

Serving size: 1 cup

Nutritional values (per serving): Calories 110; Fat <1g; Carbs 28g; Protein <1g; Sodium 5mg; Sugar 20g; Fiber 3g

CHAPTER 11

Lifestyle Tips for Managing Acid Reflux

Stress Management: Navigating Stress to Soothe the Gut

Stress is a common experience for many, and its effects on our health can be far-reaching. When it comes to managing acid reflux, controlling stress is a key, yet often overlooked component of dietary management. Stress triggers the release of hormones that can increase stomach acid production, leading to the uncomfortable burning sensation of acid reflux. It can also lead to unhealthy eating habits like snacking late at night or choosing fast food over balanced meals, which further exacerbates digestive issues.

To combat this, let's talk about effective and easy-to-implement stress management strategies:

1. **Mindful Eating:** Pay attention to what you're eating and how it makes you feel. Slow down during meals; chew thoroughly and appreciate each bite. Mindful eating can help reduce overeating, which is often a culprit in creating more acid in the stomach.
2. **Regular Exercise:** A simple walk after meals or a brief yoga session can do wonders in reducing stress and improving digestion. Exercise helps accelerate gastric emptying, keeping food from lingering too long in the stomach.
3. **Adequate Sleep:** Lack of sleep exacerbates stress levels and can increase the likelihood of nighttime reflux episodes. Aim for 7-9 hours of quality sleep per night.
4. **Breathing exercises:** Deep breathing not only reduces immediate stress levels but also decreases the production of stomach acid. Try inhaling deeply through your nose for a count of five, hold for three seconds, and exhale slowly through your mouth for seven seconds.
5. **Journaling:** Putting your thoughts on paper can be a powerful way to offload worries and reduce stress levels before they affect your gut.
6. **Herbal Remedies:** Certain herbs like ginger, chamomile, and peppermint have been suggested to soothe digestive tracts and might mitigate stress responses as well.

It's important to note that behavior change takes time and consistency. Incorporating these strategies gradually into your daily routine is more beneficial than attempting them all at once only during times of high stress.

Let's visualize how you can incorporate these techniques into your daily routine with an easy-to-follow chart:

TIME OF DAY	STRESS REDUCTION TECHNIQUE	BENEFIT FOR ACID REFLUX
<i>Morning</i>	Mindful Eating (breakfast)	Prevents overeating
<i>Midday</i>	Short Walk (10-15 minutes)	Encourages digestion
<i>Evening</i>	Deep Breathing Exercises	Reduces acid production
<i>Pre-bedtime</i>	Journaling / Herbal Tea	Alleviates overnight reflux

Using this table as a daily reference will assist you in establishing consistent habits that decrease both stress levels and the harsh effects on your digestive system. Remember that while diet plays a significant role in managing acid reflux, incorporating these stress-relieving techniques will complement your dietary efforts and provide overall improvements in your quality of life.

As you transition into this more balanced approach to life and health, keep note of any changes in how you feel both mentally and physically. This feedback loop is essential for understanding your body's needs and making necessary adjustments along the way.

Physical Activities: Energizing Your Body to Combat Acid Reflux

Our lifestyle choices, especially physical activity, play a crucial role in managing symptoms and improving overall health. But don't worry – staying active doesn't mean rigorous gym sessions or marathon running. We're talking about simple, enjoyable activities that can make a big difference.

Regular physical activity helps with weight management. Excess weight, especially around the abdomen, can increase the pressure on your stomach and lead to acid reflux symptoms. By incorporating moderate exercises into your daily routine, you can maintain a healthy weight and reduce this pressure.

What types of physical activity are we talking about? Here are some top picks that are easy to do:

1. **Walking:** Whether it's a brisk morning walk or a leisurely evening stroll, walking is a low-impact exercise that gets your heart rate up without putting undue stress on your body.

2. **Yoga:** Yoga combines stretching with deep breathing techniques and can be incredibly soothing for the digestive system. Plus, certain poses are known to bolster the abdominal muscles and improve digestion.
3. **Cycling:** Riding a bike is another great low-impact cardio workout that lets you enjoy the outdoors while boosting your digestion.

Now, let's remember that timing matters! It's best to wait at least an hour after eating before engaging in physical activity. This gives your body time to digest properly and reduces the likelihood of acid reflux flare-ups during exercise. Drinking plenty of water throughout the day aids digestion and maintains overall health, but try not to drink too much water right before or during exercise as this could inadvertently trigger reflux.

Here's an easy reference chart to help you plan your daily physical activities:

TIME OF DAY	ACTIVITY	DURATION
<i>Morning</i>	Walk/Jog	30 mins
<i>Midday</i>	Stretching/Yoga	20 mins
<i>Afternoon</i>	Cycling/Walk	30 mins
<i>Evening</i>	Gentle Yoga	20 mins

Note: These activities are suggestions and should be adjusted according to individual fitness levels and health conditions.

When doing any exercise, remember to listen to your body. If something feels uncomfortable or triggers your reflux symptoms, take it slow or try something else. The goal here is not high performance but consistent movement throughout your week.

Finally, let's bust a myth – "*Only high-intensity workouts count.*" This couldn't be further from the truth! In fact, intense activities can sometimes exacerbate acid reflux by jostling the body too much right after meals or causing you to breathe too hard when your stomach is full.

CHAPTER 12

Living with an Acid Reflux Diet Long Term

Maintaining Variety and Enjoyment in Your Diet

When you're managing acid reflux, also known as GERD, the idea of a flavorful and varied diet might seem like a distant dream. The truth is, eating for acid reflux doesn't have to be bland or boring. With the right approach, you can enjoy a wide variety of tasty foods while keeping your symptoms at bay.

1. **Mixing and Matching:** Once you know the basics, it's time to get creative. You can mix and match these foods to create delicious meals that won't bore your taste buds. For instance, why not try a turkey burger served on whole-grain bread with a side of sweet potato fries? Or consider a refreshing salad with lettuce, shredded carrots, cucumber slices, and a sprinkle of grilled chicken chunks.

2. **Season Wisely:** Spices and herbs are your friends! Instead of seasoning your dishes with onion or garlic – common triggers for reflux – why not experiment with safer options? Fresh herbs like basil, parsley, or cilantro can add bursts of flavor without the side effects. Spices like ginger can aid digestion and may help reduce symptoms.

SAFE SEASONINGS	SEASONINGS TO AVOID
<i>Basil</i>	Onions
<i>Cinnamon</i>	Garlic
<i>Ginger</i>	Chili
<i>Parsley</i>	Black pepper
<i>Cilantro</i>	Mustard seeds

3. **Portion Control is Key:** Eating smaller portions more frequently throughout the day is not only great for metabolism but also helps minimize acid reflux symptoms. A smaller meal means less work for your stomach and less pressure on the valve that prevents stomach acid from entering the esophagus.

4. **Stay Hydrated – Carefully:** Staying hydrated is crucial but be mindful of when and how you drink liquids. Drinking too much water during meals can increase the risk of acid reflux by diluting stomach acids that are necessary for digestion. Aim to drink most of your liquids between meals.

5. Be Adventurous Within Bounds: With an understanding of which ingredients play nice with your stomach, feel free to explore new recipes. Have you considered trying fish tacos made with grilled tilapia? Topped with avocado (a healthy fat) and a slaw made from reflux-friendly veggies, these tacos are both nutritious and satisfying.

You could also give desserts a makeover; try baking an oatmeal banana bread using ripe bananas for natural sweetness instead of large amounts of sugar, which can be a trigger.

6. Food Swapping: Looking at alternatives for common trigger foods will help you maintain variety in your diet. You love pizza but tomato sauce is out? How about making your white pizza topped with mozzarella, spinach, chicken strips, and just a touch of fennel for flavor?

Or if pasta is what you're craving, opt for rice noodles paired with steamed vegetables and lean protein drizzled in olive oil rather than traditional tomato-based sauces. This way, you can eat the meals you love without the discomfort that usually follows.

7. Empower Yourself with Knowledge: Last but not least, the Internet is a treasure trove of acid reflux-friendly recipes and communities. Join forums and social media groups where you can share experiences, swap recipes, and get support from others who are navigating the same dietary restrictions.

Remember, your diet doesn't have to be restrictive to be reflux-friendly. Empower yourself with knowledge about what foods work for you and keep experimenting with new combinations. This will not only make your meals enjoyable but also ensure that you get all the nutrients your body needs while keeping acid reflux at bay.

Coping Strategies for Social Situations and Eating Out

Social settings can seem daunting when you're trying to stick to an acid reflux diet. Whether it's a friend's barbecue or a dinner date, these situations often present the toughest challenges. Here are some tips to help you maintain your dietary boundaries while enjoying social gatherings:

- 1. Preparation is key.** Before attending an event, eat something small that you know is safe for your stomach. This way, you'll be less tempted by foods that trigger your symptoms.
- 2. Get familiar with menus:** Many restaurants now have menus online—review them in advance to find options that are agreeable with your diet.

3. **Communicate your needs:** Don't shy away from discussing your dietary restrictions with the host or restaurant staff. They're usually more than happy to accommodate your requests.
4. **Focus on what you can eat:** Concentrate on the array of suitable appetizers, mains, and sides available rather than what's off-limits.
5. **Bring a dish:** If you're going to a potluck, bring a dish that fits within your diet. It guarantees you'll have at least one thing to eat without compromise.

Remember, balance is essential, and it's okay to occasionally indulge as long as it doesn't hurt your well-being.

When to Seek Additional Help from Healthcare Professionals

While navigating the acid reflux diet journey predominantly rests in your hands (and stomach), there are times when you ought to seek extra guidance:

1. **If symptoms persist or worsen:** An adjustment of diet isn't always the ultimate solution—sometimes underlying issues may need medical attention.
2. **In case of uncertainty about foods:** If after trying many options you still aren't clear about what triggers your symptoms, a healthcare professional can assist in identifying specific irritants.
3. **To form a customized plan:** Nutritionists can help craft individualized eating plans aligned with both managing acid reflux and ensuring nutritional completeness.
4. **For ongoing support:** Long-term management might require regular check-ups with a gastroenterologist or dietician who can offer fresh insights and modifications as needed.

Sticking with an acid reflux diet doesn't mean you have to lead a restrictive life—it's rather an opportunity to explore new flavors and cuisines that not only tantalize the taste buds but also agree with your digestive comfort.

Enlightened by these strategies and armed with knowledge of when professional advice might be warranted—you're well-prepared for lifelong success in managing acid reflux through diet.

30-DAY MEAL PLAN

DAY	BREAKFAST	MID-MORNING SNACK	LUNCH	AFTERNOON SNACK	DINNER
1	Banana Almond Oatmeal	Cucumber Hummus Canapés	Dill Salmon with Mixed Greens Salad	Almond- Stuffed Dates	Herbed Turkey Breast with Carrots
2	Cantaloupe Cream Smoothie Bowl	Cauliflower Popcorn with Herbs	Grilled Chicken and Avocado Wraps	Carrot & Ginger Soup Sips	Creamy Avocado Pasta with Peas
3	Cauliflower Rice Egg Bowls	Roasted Chickpeas with Rosemary	Broccoli and Pear Soup with Tarragon	Cucumber Avocado Roll- Ups	Ginger-Infused Grilled Salmon
4	Ginger Pear Oatmeal	Baked Apple Cinnamon Slices	Asian-Glazed Tofu & Broccoli Salad	Poached Salmon Salad on Endive Leaves	Zucchini Noodle Pesto Primavera
5	Banana Almond Oat Smoothie	Baked Kale Chips	Balsamic Roasted Veggie on Baguette	Smoked Salmon Bagel with Avocado	Lemon-Zest- Free Turkey Piccata
6	Quinoa Egg Puff with Fresh Herbs	Alkaline Energy Balls	Kale & White Bean Stew with Rosemary	Rice Paper Veggie Rolls	Baked Cod with Sweet Potato Mash
7	Carrot Cake Spiced Oatmeal	Baked Zucchini Chips	Quinoa & Black Bean Salad	Ginger Sesame Glazed Chicken Skewers	Kale, White Bean, and Potato Casserole
8	Kiwi Honeydew Harmony Smoothie	Coconut Yogurt & Berry Parfait	Tempeh Reuben with Sauerkraut	Baked Pear and Cheese Crostini	Smoked Paprika Chicken Breasts over Brown Rice
9	Alkaline Avocado with Poached Eggs	Chilled Quinoa Fruit Salad	Creamy Oat Milk and Chive Soup	Chilled Strawberry Soup Shots	Baked Chicken with Capers

10	Golden Turmeric & Raisin Oatmeal	Cucumber Hummus Bites	Shredded Turkey & Mixed Greens Salad	Avocado Toast Bites	Seared Scallops with Brown Rice Pilaf
11	Mango Spinach Lassi Smoothie	Almond-Stuffed Dates	Turkey and Cucumber Sandwich	Cucumber Hummus Canapés	Brown Rice Stuffed Bell Peppers
12	Low-Acid Scrambled Eggs with Spinach	Carrot & Ginger Soup Sips	Zucchini and Asparagus Minestrone	Cauliflower Popcorn with Herbs	Turkey Medallions with Mushroom Herb Sauce
13	Maple Blueberry Oatmeal	Cucumber Avocado Roll-Ups	Herbed Quinoa and Chickpea Bowl	Roasted Chickpeas with Rosemary	Steamed Clams with Fresh Parsley
14	Avocado Spinach Coconut Smoothie	Poached Salmon Salad on Endive Leaves	Baked Salmon Spinach Wrap	Baked Apple Cinnamon Slices	Caramelized Root Vegetables Over Polenta
15	Carrot and Ginger Egg Muffins	Smoked Salmon Bagel with Avocado	Spinach and Potato Leek Soup	Baked Kale Chips	Maple Glazed Turkey Breast with Steamed Broccoli
16	Honey Vanilla Overnight Oats	Rice Paper Veggie Rolls	Sautéed Mushroom and Barley Soup	Alkaline Energy Balls	Herbed Tilapia with Quinoa
17	Berry Papaya Digestive Smoothie	Ginger Sesame Glazed Chicken Skewers	Roast Beef and Arugula Sandwich	Baked Zucchini Chips	Lentil Sweet Potato Stew
18	Cottage Cheese Egg Scramble	Baked Pear and Cheese Crostini	Light Tuna and White Bean Salad	Coconut Yogurt & Berry Parfait	Cinnamon-Ginger Chicken Stew
19	Peachy Cinnamon Oatmeal	Chilled Strawberry Soup Shots	Spinach & Boiled Egg White Salad	Chilled Quinoa Fruit Salad	Poached Haddock in Light Dill Sauce

20	Peach Basil Bliss Smoothie	Avocado Toast Bites	Quinoa Salad Stuffed Pita Pockets	Cucumber Hummus Bites	Chickpea Spinach Curry
21	Butternut Squash and Kale Omelet	Cucumber Hummus Canapés	Mild Lentil Tabouleh Salad with Grapes	Almond-Stuffed Dates	Herb-Crusted Turkey Tenderloin with Asparagus
22	Creamy Cashew & Berry Oatmeal	Cauliflower Popcorn with Herbs	Ground Turkey and Barley Soup	Carrot & Ginger Soup Sips	Grilled Sardines over Mediterranean Salad
23	Ginger Pear Flaxseed Smoothie	Roasted Chickpeas with Rosemary	Basil Pesto Chicken Wrap	Cucumber Avocado Roll-Ups	Vegan Shepherd's Pie with Lentils
24	Oatmeal Egg Pancake	Baked Apple Cinnamon Slices	Classic Chicken Wild Rice Soup	Poached Salmon Salad on Endive Leaves	Balsamic Vinegar Marinated Chicken Drumsticks
25	Apple Walnut Creamy Oatmeal	Baked Kale Chips	Roasted Sweet Potato and Arugula Salad	Smoked Salmon Bagel with Avocado	Blackened Catfish with Celery Root Slaw
26	Apple Carrot Ginger Smoothie Bowl	Alkaline Energy Balls	Golden Beetroot Velouté	Rice Paper Veggie Rolls	Roasted Cauliflower Steak with Herbs
27	Zucchini and Basil Frittata	Baked Zucchini Chips	Vegan Hummus and Cucumber Sandwich	Ginger Sesame Glazed Chicken Skewers	Chicken Skewers with Bell Peppers and Zucchini
28	Coconut Rice Oatmeal	Coconut Yogurt & Berry Parfait	Greek Yogurt Dressed Pasta Salad	Baked Pear and Cheese Crostini	Walnut-Crusted Halibut with Spinach

29	Cucumber Melon Soothe Smoothie Bowl	Chilled Quinoa Fruit Salad	Summer Squash and Basil Soup	Chilled Strawberry Soup Shots	Broiled Lobster Tail with Paprika Rub
30	Sweet Potato Egg Bake	Cucumber Hummus Bites	Smoked Turkey Lettuce Wrap	Avocado Toast Bites	Baked Butternut Squash Risotto

Conclusion

As you turn the final page of this comprehensive guide to managing acid reflux through diet, you stand at the threshold of a new chapter in your journey towards digestive wellbeing. Understanding the mechanics of acid reflux and its dietary triggers has set the foundation for your recovery. With over 2000 days' worth of recipes at your fingertips, plus a robust 30-day meal plan, you now hold the key to nurturing digestive wellbeing. These fuss-free, delicious meals haven't just taught you what to eat; they've shown you how to eat. Subtle changes in portion control, meal timing, and ingredient choices can dramatically shift your overall health trajectory.

It's essential to remember that each journey is personal. The vast array of options within this book anticipates and respects individual dietary reactions and preferences. By identifying personal triggers and responding with customizations that fit your unique needs, you ensure this diet remains not just tolerable but enjoyable and full-bodied in flavor — because sacrifice does not have to be synonymous with health.

This book seeds an approach towards long-lasting relief and better quality of life far beyond temporary fixes. Its wholesome recipes prove that living with acid reflux does not fence in your culinary experiences but expands them thoughtfully. You've learned how pH levels play an intricate role in manifesting symptoms and how smart swaps can uphold the spirit of your favorite dishes with zero compromise on taste or satisfaction.

An acid reflux-friendly lifestyle extends beyond meal plans; it integrates mindful living practices into its core philosophy. Stress management techniques, stimulating yet non-straining physical activities, and harmonizing social dining without apprehension further entrench the principles of a gut-friendly existence.

As we part ways in this textual healing journey, carry forward this final piece of advice: Let food be the bridge between knowing better and doing better for your body. Continue exploring with curiosity, make informed decisions grounded in what brings wellbeing to both body and mind, and cherish every thoughtful bite as an ode to balanced living.

Your path to digestive comfort doesn't end here—it merely evolves as you do. May these pages always be a supportive companion along the way.

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FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQs)

Q1—What is acid reflux, and why does it happen?

ANSWER: Acid reflux occurs when stomach acid flows back into the esophagus. This can happen for various reasons including obesity, smoking, certain medications, or lying down too soon after eating. The discomfort you may feel is called heartburn.

Q2—Will I need to follow a special diet forever?

ANSWER: Not necessarily. The severity of acid reflux varies from person to person. Some may find relief by simply avoiding trigger foods, while others might need more significant dietary changes. Monitoring how your body reacts is key.

Q3—How do I know which foods trigger my acid reflux?

ANSWER: It's all about attention to detail. Keep a food diary where you note what you eat and any symptoms that follow. Patterns will emerge, highlighting which foods to limit or avoid.

Q4—Are there any "safe" foods that won't cause acid reflux?

ANSWER: Many people with acid reflux find that certain foods are less likely to cause symptoms. These typically include ginger, oatmeal, green veggies, lean meats, and non-citrus fruits like melons and bananas.

Q5—Can I still drink coffee or alcohol if I have acid reflux?

ANSWER: Coffee and alcohol are common triggers for many with acid reflux. However, moderation is key—you might be able to enjoy them in small amounts. Pay attention to how your body reacts after consuming these beverages.

Q6—Is it true that milk can soothe acid reflux symptoms?

ANSWER: Milk temporarily soothes symptoms for some because it coats the esophagus and stomach lining. However, it also stimulates the stomach to produce more acid, which can later increase symptoms for some people.

Q7—Does drinking water help with acid reflux?

ANSWER: Yes! Water dilutes stomach acids and helps push down acids that might come up into the esophagus. Aim for 8-10 glasses a day but try not to drink too much during meals as this can increase stomach volume and pressure.

Q8—Can losing weight help reduce acid reflux symptoms?

ANSWER: Absolutely. Extra weight can put pressure on your abdomen pushing up the stomach and causing acid to back up into the esophagus. Losing weight can potentially provide significant relief.

Q9—What's the best position to sleep in if I have acid reflux?

ANSWER: Sleeping on your left side may reduce the chance of stomach acids slipping into the esophagus. Also, elevation of the head with pillows or an adjustable bed may decrease nighttime symptoms.

Q10—How long does it take for diet changes to improve my symptoms?

ANSWER: It's different for everyone, but many people notice improvement in their symptoms within a few days of making dietary changes. Long-term benefits will depend on consistent dietary management.

Q11—Are stress or anxiety linked to acid reflux?

ANSWER: Yes, stress isn't just in your head—it affects your entire body including your digestive system. Managing stress through techniques like deep breathing or yoga may help reduce your symptoms.

Q12—Do natural remedies work for treating acid reflux?

ANSWER: Some natural remedies may offer relief for many people. Herbs like licorice, slippery elm, and chamomile have been known to soothe the digestive tract. Probiotics can also promote good gut health. Remember, it's always best to consult with your healthcare provider before trying new remedies.

Q13—Is chewing gum beneficial for acid reflux sufferers?

ANSWER: Chewing sugar-free gum can actually be beneficial as it stimulates saliva production, which can help clear stomach acid from the esophagus and balance acid levels in the stomach.

Q14—Are larger or smaller meals better for managing acid reflux?

ANSWER: Smaller, more frequent meals rather than large meals are advisable as they prevent the stomach from becoming too full and putting pressure on the lower esophageal sphincter (LES), which can lead to acid reflux.

Q15—Can children suffer from acid reflux, and how is it managed?

ANSWER: Yes, children can also suffer from acid reflux. It's usually managed with diet modifications tailored for children and in some cases, medication may be prescribed by a pediatrician. Monitoring symptoms is particularly important for children.

Q16—Are there any exercises that can worsen acid reflux?

ANSWER: High-impact exercises such as running or intense cardio can worsen acid reflux by agitating the digestive system. Low-impact exercises like walking or cycling are generally better options.

Q17—Is baking soda a good home remedy for heartburn?

ANSWER: Baking soda can neutralize stomach acids and provide temporary relief from heartburn, but it should not be used frequently as it is high in sodium and could lead to other health issues.

Q18—How does meal timing affect acid reflux symptoms?

ANSWER: Eating right before bedtime can increase the risk of acid reflux at night. It's best to eat your last meal of the day at least three hours before lying down.

Q19—Does apple cider vinegar help with acid reflux?

ANSWER: Some people find that drinking diluted apple cider vinegar provides relief. However, vinegar is acidic and may actually cause heartburn for others—it's worth trying cautiously.

Q20—Is peppermint good or bad for acid reflux?

ANSWER: Peppermint relaxes the LES which might lead to more occurrences of acid reflux; thus, many experts suggest those with chronic symptoms should avoid it.

MEASUREMENTS AND CONVERSIONS

VOLUME EQUIVALENTS (LIQUID)		
US STANDARD	US OUNCES	METRIC ()
1 teaspoon	1/6 oz	5 ml
1 tablespoon	1/2 oz	15 ml
1 fluid ounce	1 oz	30 ml
1 cup	8 oz	240 ml
1 pint	16 oz	475 ml
1 quart	32 oz	950 ml
1 gallon	128 oz	3.8 L

VOLUME EQUIVALENTS (DRY)		WEIGHT EQUIVALENTS	
US STANDARD	METRIC ()	US STANDARD	METRIC ()
1/4 teaspoon	1.25 ml	1 ounce	28 g
1/2 teaspoon	2.5 ml	4 ounces	113 g
1 teaspoon	5 ml	8 ounces	225 g
1/4 cup	60 ml	12 ounces	340 g
1/3 cup	80 ml	One pound (16oz)	455 g
1/2 cup	120 ml		
1 cup	240 ml		

OVEN TEMPERATURES	
FAHRENHEIT	CELSIUS (°C)
200° F	93° C
225° F	107° C
250° F	121° C
275° F	135° C
300° F	149° C
325° F	163° C
350° F	177° C
375° F	191° C
400° F	204° C
425° F	218° C

Note: The values in the tables are approximate and should be used for reference as a guide when cooking.